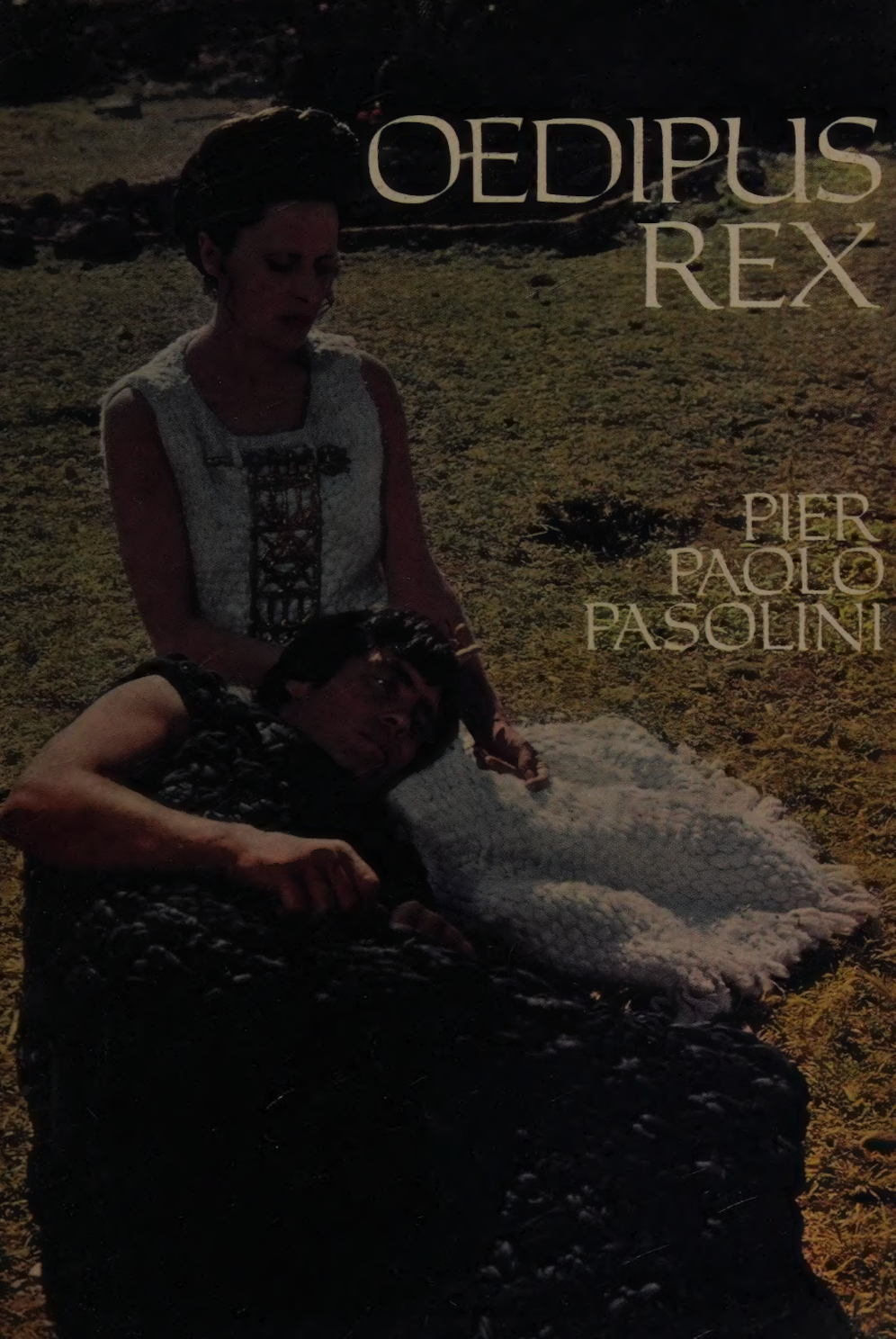




OEDIPUS REX

PIER
PAOLO
PASOLINI

MODERN FILM SCRIPTS

OEDIPUS REX

a film by Pier Paolo Pasolini

Based on two plays by Sophocles, *Oedipus Rex* and *Oedipus at Colonus*, Pier Paolo Pasolini's film is one of the finest renderings of a classical Greek subject that the cinema has produced. By taking as his subject the Oedipus myth, Pasolini confronts some of the most profound insights arrived at by man on the human condition, and uses them to create a film which is thoroughly contemporary in spirit. He unravels the intricate Sophoclean plot, stretching it out in simple chronological order, while at the same time he adds a modern prologue and epilogue which are brilliantly lyrical and charged with a great intensity of personal feeling.

The director is well served by his actors, particularly in the tortured performance of Franco Citti as Oedipus and the luminous beauty of Silvana Mangano as Jocasta. Above all, however, the film is an expression of man's pain and bewilderment before the mystery of life, and in this respect it is a worthy successor to Sophocles' own treatment of this timeless theme.

This edition of *Oedipus Rex* comprises Pasolini's original literary script, accompanied by a cutting continuity which gives a shot-by-shot breakdown of the actual film. There is a long introduction by Pasolini himself, and the book is illustrated with over a hundred frame and production stills, carefully keyed to the text.

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OEDIPUS REX

a film by

Pier Paolo Pasolini

translated from the Italian

by John Mathews

Lorrimer Publishing, London

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A NOTE ON THIS EDITION

The main text of this edition of *Oedipus Rex* consists of Pier Paolo Pasolini's original script, translated into English by John Mathews. Since the original script was written before shooting began, it contains scenes and dialogue which do not appear in the film, and certain sequences were changed considerably during shooting. For this reason, and also because the original script contains no technical details, we have included a shot-by-shot cutting continuity (see page 105). It is hoped that for the student of film, the inclusion of the continuity will help to show the changes which can occur in the transition from script to film, while the literary quality of the main script will be of interest to the general reader and student alike.

To keep the continuity as brief as possible, dialogue is only included if it does not appear in the original script. Instead, the dialogue is marked by a small number which refers back to the numbered dialogue in the main script. The camera positions have also been abbreviated and are indicated by initials: CU for close-up; MCU for medium close-up; MS for medium shot; MLS for medium long shot; LS for long shot.

Acknowledgments and thanks are due to Arco Film Srl, Rome, for providing the colour still for the cover, to Garzanti Editore and *L'Avant-Scène du Cinéma* for providing black and white stills, and to *L'Avant-Scène du Cinéma* also for providing facilities for viewing the film.

WHY THAT OF OEDIPUS IS A STORY

Pier Paolo Pasolini

So it seems that the cinema must be naturalistic.

In fact I go so far as to say: 'If I wish to express a dustman through the medium of cinema, I take a real dustman and reproduce him: body and voice.'

Moravia laughs at that: 'Yes the cinema is naturalistic, of course. So it's naturalistic. But the cinema is images. And it's only when you represent a dustman without words (and thus with elegance) that you can produce a cinema which is somehow not naturalistic.'

'Not at all,' I reply. 'The cinema is "semiologically" an audio-visual technique. Thus the dustman is there in flesh, bone and voice.'

'Ah, ah, neorealism!' exclaims Moravia.

'Yes, when I am producing cinema — not one of my films in particular — but when I am producing cinema in general, if I have to express a dustman I express him by taking a real dustman, with his real facial expressions, his body, and the language he uses.'

'Ah no, that's where you make your mistake,' butts in Bernardo Bertolucci. 'Why make a dustman say what he would come out with himself? You use his mouth, but you have to put philosophy into it (following Godard's lead, of course).'

Here the discussion comes to an end. No one could ever dissuade Moravia from believing that 'the cinema is images' while being at the same time, in itself, naturalistic; and no one could even try to argue against Bernardo Bertolucci when he says that dustmen have to speak like philosophers.

But let us suppose that the audience is shown a silent dustman: a dustman *in a particular film*. A silent, magnificently photographed dustman — and thus an image. How does the audience recognize him? Because he is a dustman in reality. Reproduced. It's the man in person that I have to use if I wish to express him, even in the form of images.

Now then, let us suppose that this dustman talks like Hegel.

Okay, he's a dustman who talks like Hegel. Why not? In reality — no matter how unusual the case — couldn't there be a dustman who talks like Hegel? A dustman who says 'Thesis and antithesis', like the dustman who says 'Fuck you', is a character in real life, and the cinema reproduces both of them just as they are. In this sense the cinema is inevitably naturalistic.

But where does all this fear of naturalism come from? What does this fear hide, if not reality itself? And isn't it bourgeois intellectuals who are afraid of reality?

By reality I mean the physical and social world in which each of us lives. Whoever expresses himself, through whatever system of signs, can in the last analysis interpret this reality (either through sign-symbols or figurative symbols) only historically, and thus realistically.

What is this pure image of a silent dustman? It is the aesthetic idea of a dustman in the mind of a bourgeois who in reality has nothing to do with that dustman. The other dustman who talks dialectics is apocryphal and exemplary: he too is at the service of a bourgeois who has nothing in common with him. That is, between a bourgeois and a dustman there can only be a link of mutual sympathy, as might exist between a man and his dog. We bourgeois are all racists. Except that I don't wish to be. And I want a dustman to be a dustman, not an *a priori* image which I find pleasing, nor a vehicle for the philosophy I find interesting.

The dustman *in the cinema* is thus the same as a dustman in reality: and since the cinema is an audio-visual technique, the dustman in the cinema projects himself and talks just as in reality.

But what of the dustman *in a particular film*? The cinema is an endless sequence of frames (I must have said this dozens of times); it is reproduction on an infinite scale in ideal or virtual terms; an invisible apparatus reproduces in their entirety the gestures, acts and words of a man from the moment he is born to the moment he dies.

The dustman *in a particular film* is a dead dustman — as distinct from the dustman *in the cinema*, who is alive. The moment he dies, in fact, there occurs a lightning synthesis of the span of his life. Thousands of actions, expressions, sounds, voices, words are lost forever, and no more than a few tens or hundreds survive. The enormous number of words he said every morning, noon and night

of his life are lost in an infinite and silent abyss. But some of these words linger on, miraculously; they are inscribed in the memory like epigrams. They hang forever in the light of a morning, or in the sweet shadows of an evening: his wife, his friends, when they remember them, shed a tear. *In a particular film*, it is these words which stay behind. Of course it is naturalistic to choose a dustman in flesh and blood, as real as anyone of us is real in this moment that we are alive, with his own words, his own language, his own pronunciation. But our task is *to select* the relevant words, the ones which by chance survived the disaster.

Oedipus is dead. Death has sanctified a perfect and by now unalterable version of what he once was. Death is the necessary condition *to make a story from his life*. As much as to 'compile' a film of his life.

What criteria did I use to select the telling moments in the life of Oedipus, a death figure who was never alive?

I too, like Moravia and Bertolucci, am a bourgeois, in fact a petit-bourgeois, a turd, convinced that my stench is not only scented perfume, but is in fact the only perfume in the world. I too am thus endowed with the characteristics of aestheticism and humour, the typical characteristics of a petit-bourgeois intellectual. This is not a run-of-the-mill confession, but purely and simply a statement of fact, not entirely unprompted, if you like, by my aestheticism and humour. On the other hand it must be admitted that the petit-bourgeois is no more, no less than a man: and from man he has inherited the idea of time. It's a myth, this idea of time, on which he bases not only his life — his thrift, foresight, respectability, morality, etc etc — but his art as well. Christ was wasting his time when he preached that there was no need to think of tomorrow. The ideas of tomorrow and of yesterday are the only fixed points in the heads of us bourgeois. Tomorrow figures as the realization of all our dreams of success (for which we are so sensible, parsimonious, uncompromising, prudent, calculating, judicious and contemptible); yesterday figures as the basis of the institutions, traditions — the whole Establishment — which we use as a starting point to reach our fine goals. (All of this happens in times of peace, for which we poor pacifists are always fighting.) But let's get back to the cinema. The cinema — an infinite sequence reproducing from one particular point of view the whole of reality — is thus

based squarely on the concept of time. It thus conforms to the same laws as life itself: the laws of an illusion. Put in words it sounds strange, but we have to accept this illusion. Because whoever (as man and poet, not as saint) does not accept it, in place of moving onto a plane of higher reality, loses the sense of reality altogether. Thus reality is constituted by nothing other than its illusion.

Aestheticism and humour have thus presided over the choice of the typical moments in Oedipus' life, those which are enhanced in value after the protagonist's death. They follow one another, almost of their own accord, in the same temporal order as in his life, but over a disproportionately shorter time — or rather, through the artist's reflections and the editing procedures available — in a synthesized totality of experience.

In this case I composed the frames in a much more cinematic way than usual (I don't know whether they turned out beautiful or ugly, but what I was trying to do was make them beautiful, to come up with 'beautiful compositions'); and I used as well the technique of detachment from the events portrayed (take for example Angelo's eyes as he watches the Sphinx, smiling and desecrating it in an almost comical fashion; but at the same time his eyes make us incredulous, and effectively deny us any feeling of involvement in the elements of the myth etc etc). We were born of Cervantes and Ariosto (as well as Manzoni). And tragedy? Didn't I want to bring Oedipus' tragedy to life? A totally overwhelming tragedy? There is the quality of tragedy in it, in spite of everything, since the common denominator of both aestheticism and humour is the fear of death. Thus the bourgeoisie can always illegitimately call themselves Christians even when they forget Christ and think of nothing but tomorrow.

How I managed to keep the state of mind necessary for aestheticism (the contemplative and slightly lazy taste for beauty) and for humour (the desire to go on smiling, no matter what, though our eyes be full of anguish) in Morocco, when shooting in the way we had to shoot, I just don't know. . .

The other reason why the film was shot with 'aestheticism and humour' is that I am no longer terribly interested in the subject of the researches of Freud and Marx. I'm no longer at all seriously involved in that academic bog which turns Oedipus into a whipping post for Freudian or Marxist theories. It's true that at the end of

the film Freud would seem to have come out with more points than Marx, while Oedipus goes off to lose himself in the green fields of poppies and the waters where he was suckled as a child. But more than Freud it is *Oedipus at Colonus* which suggests a similar idea : or at least, in the arbitrary mish-mash of Freudian and Sophoclean suggestion, the latter emerges as the stronger. Let's be clear on this point : I consider *Oedipus at Colonus* the least graceful of Sophocles' tragedies; in fact I think it's decidedly ungraceful. And yet it contains two or three fragments which can only be described as sublime. It is these I was referring to. As far as Freud is concerned, he carries no more weight in the film than an amateur would have given him. For example Oedipus : he knows Tiresias beforehand, when guided by that *anghelos* (messenger) who will later appear as Angelo (his role, incidentally, is precisely that of intermediary between Tiresias and Oedipus-the-novice-Tiresias). This is the point at which the Marxist and Freudian moments meet, soiled and childish as I believe them to be. Then again Freud triumphs in the sequence with the Sphinx, the only one I radically changed (apart from replacing Antigone with Angelo); in fact the Sphinx does not set a riddle, but asks Oedipus directly to clarify on his own the enigma he contains within himself. Oedipus refuses, and pushes the Sphinx back into the abyss it originally came out of — a little comically, to tell the truth. He knew that by pushing it back into the abyss he would be able to marry his mother : we thus have here an audio-visual case of displacement.

I want to stress the fact that now, at forty-five years of age, I have emerged from the wilderness of Freudian and Marxist dogma. *But where have I got to?* I have certainly never dreamt that I was making love to my mother. Perhaps I should refer the two or three readers who have stayed with me as far as this to a couple of lines from the *Usignolo della Chiesa Cattolica* (The nightingale of the Catholic Church) :

. . . *il sogno in cui mia madre
s'infla i miei calzoni.*

(. . . the dream in which my mother
slips into my trousers.)

If anything, I have dreamt rather of making love to my father

(against the chest of drawers in the wretched little bedroom my brothers and I shared) and perhaps to my brother as well. And I have dreamt of making love to women of stone. Of course I'm not counting the dreams that have recurred several times throughout my life, where I climb endless, dreary flights of stairs in dreary homes. I am looking for my mother who has disappeared.

But after all it is some time since I have had such dreams. Sylvana Mangano might have the same scent of primroses about her that my mother had when young, but Franco Citti certainly has nothing in common with me — save his slightly raised cheek bones.

It is because he is so different from me — even with his monstrous inferiority and guilt complexes — that I chose him as protagonist. What he plays in is not an intimate drama but a tragedy. The events are thus dynamized by external forces: on the stage of a mysterious but real world. Citti is in total ignorance of this as he lives out his tragedy *en plein air*: he is an innocent but aggressive victim.

We can now say that *the cinema* is a mechanical medium which gathers or harvests reality, qua reality, and stores it (as it were, in a bag). *In a particular film*, on the other hand, reality is dead and thrown back upon the past, where it is gathered or collected into an idea: into a synthesis. In creating such a synthesis, I first of all shot 70,000 metres (227,000 feet) of film stock — though in fact I should have shot 70 billion. Then before cutting this down to about 2,800 metres (9,100 feet), I left the tragedy free to run its course. But there was an ambiguous element to my position: the aestheticism and humour which I allowed to guide me were inauthentic and shameful, because they are typical of a bourgeois intellectual. But at the same time they were in fact authentic and real because they belonged to a man who is relating things already deep in the past.

But let us get back to the problems we were discussing as amateur linguists and semiologists.

Let us suppose that Moravia might want to describe, as a character in one of his novels, Sylvana Mangano — as Arbasino did with Domietta Ercolani. Moravia would certainly effect Mangano's transformation into fiction with much more delicacy, objectivity and clarity than Arbasino. Yet Moravia could do no more than

other writers. He would have to use a system of written/spoken symbols (our beloved Italian), adapting them to his own personal ideology. He would have to fashion them into a style system, wouldn't he? The symbols Moravia uses are signs by nature. What is the relationship between the real experience Moravia has of Mangano (and Mangano herself in reality) and such a system of sign-symbols? That is the great problem, and there is only one thing I can say about it which I'm sure of: that the reader of Moravia's work participates in a sort of chemical operation (these always coming in handy when an illustration is needed). He resolves the sign quality of the symbols and reconstructs in his imagination — that is through his experience of reality — the living reality of Mangano. Thus the sequence is: Mangano in reality — transformation of this reality into sign-symbols — reconstruction of Mangano in reality. Is language then nothing but an intermediary? Moravia will describe Mangano's eyes, her pale cheeks, her pencilled eyebrows, her heaving throat, her scent of primroses (and he will do it magnificently): but is all this nothing but a magician's act to transpose his own experience of the reality of Mangano into the reader's experience of this same reality? Of course we shouldn't lose sight of the fact that the only important element in this sequence is Mangano herself: through language one can pass only from reality to reality. One would have to be a Brahma to use the mirrored experiences of mankind as an aid for self-contemplation.

Then again let us suppose that it is Mekas, or anyone else from the New Cinema (for which I provisionally had so much sympathy) who is describing Mangano. It would make no difference whatsoever. And I am saying this to refute the arguments of this neo-avant garde, one which has promised so many new developments. Imagine trying to take in the images on the separate sheets of a calendar as they are rapidly torn off one by one. The same would apply with Mekas: through dead branches against a blue sky, I should catch a glimpse of children throwing snowballs at each other, of carefree young lovers strolling arm in arm down Fifth Avenue, of a handsome black going down into the Subway, of a few Venetian gondoliers, as well as of Mangano's features. The difference would be one of quality: Moravia would perhaps give Mangano too much reality and meaning as a character, while Mekas would treat her with no more respect than a character in a

schoolgirl's novel.

But apart from the effects of the author's particular approach, there must be a difference between Mangano's possible transformation into a character in Moravia and her transformation in Mekas. I've said this many times before, but it's worth repeating. Moravia reconsigns Mangano's reality to me as a reader within the framework of a linguistic-stylistic system composed of signs; Mekas on the other hand consigns Mangano to me within the framework of her reality itself. In simple terms, Mekas reproduces her audio-visually. *The audio-visual reproduction of Mangano is thus nothing else than her figurative symbolization.*

Never has a semiologist — I've said this before, and Christian Metz has politely called it a dream, while Cesare Segre, in his capacity as a university professor, would call it a con — described a person, for example Sylvana Mangano, as reality with a voice of its own: *the real Mangano as language*. Semiology has ranged over the whole of reality in its researches on specific languages, but it has not yet considered *the whole of reality as language*; thus it has not yet become a philosophy.

Let us suppose that Professor Morris had this idea (a dream for Metz, a con for Segre and his assistants), and wanted to 'describe in semiological terms the reality of Mangano as language'. How would such a description of the reality of Mangano as language differ if, instead of being observed in life, she were observed on the screen, that is *as a figurative symbol of herself*? There would certainly be some differences (the scent of primroses, for example), but in substance the semiology of the real Mangano as language and the semiology of Mangano as a figurative linguistic symbol would not differ very much.

Mangano lives in time. Unconscious, even contemptuous of her beauty, she dedicates herself, like Cincinnatus, to humble everyday tasks, to her children and her family, to the things that are important for a woman. Each one of these activities, however, *has duration*, in terms of seconds, minutes or days: what comes to mind is the slow, irrevocable progress that characterizes the path towards tuberculosis. If we really wish to come to terms with the reality of Mangano, we have to come to terms with the physical time in which she lives like anyone else. It's true that we could deny all this, as the various avant-gardes have committed themselves to do. This

implies above all an elementary desecration of the idea we all have of time. In reality there is no better way of not compromising oneself and living peacefully, *thinking only of tomorrow*, than by using words to destroy time.

You couldn't call me one of those layabouts or court jesters. I go on undaunted to confront the problem of time as Flaubert did, or la Delly. Writing the scenario as a *pasticheur*, I spread Jocasta through time, even though she is a timeless character: she has nothing but sensuality and the will not to know. But what richness and diversity we find in creatures whose life span lasts but a moment! And what incredible, incoherent and obsessive apparitions in time these take on! Their ideal is a death which will prune their life to a series of 'supreme moments'; it will turn them into enigmas which, in time, will meander and multiply without evolving, like medusas in water. These shift and change their shape in incredible ways until death (but how is it possible that these things can die? I want to make it clear that I don't believe creatures like these can be mortal) freezes them into a definitive form.

It's at this point that — having posed the problem of the relationship between Mangano's reality as language in life and her reality as a non-sign language *in the cinema* — we should have to begin to compare her reality as language in life and her reality as a non-sign language *in a particular film*: that is the reality, as far as I'm concerned, of Mangano-Jocasta . . . But there is already too much talk of characters in films . . . and of the sublime ways in which directors deal with them!

1967.

CREDITS:

Scenario and dialogue by	Pier Paolo Pasolini, inspired by Sophocles' <i>Oedipus Rex</i> and <i>Oedipus at Colonus</i>
Directed by	Pier Paolo Pasolini
Produced by	Alfredo Bini
Production company	Arco Film S.r.l., Rome
Music	Quartet in C Major by Mozart; Rumanian folk-songs; ancient Japanese music; co-ordinated by Pier Paolo Pasolini
Director of photography	Giuseppe Ruzzolini
Cameraman	Otello Spila
Art director	Andrea Fantacci
Sound	Carlo Tarchi
Editor	Nino Baragli
Production manager	Eliseo Boschi
Production supervisor	Mario Coccioletti
Production secretary	Walter Fabrizio
Continuity	Lina D'Amico
Assistant director	Jean-Claude Biette
Assistant cameraman	Sergio Rubini (C.S.C.)
Assistant art director	Dante Ferretti
Costumes	Danilo Donati
Wardrobe assistant	Piero Cicoletti
Make-up	Giulio Natalucci, Goffredo Rocchetti
Hairdressing	Ernesta Cesetti, Maria Teresa Corridoni
Hairstyles	Rocchetti
Stills photographer	Bruno Bruni
Negatives and positives, optical effects	Technicolor Italiana S.p.A.
Stock	Kodak Eastmancolor
Sound recording	NIS Films
Studios	Dino de Laurentiis Cinematografica S.p.A.

Locations	Northern Italy, Morocco and Bologna
Length	2,849 metres
Running time	110 minutes*

CAST:

Oedipus	Franco Citti
Jocasta	Sylvana Mangano
Merope	Alida Valli
Creon	Carmelo Bene
Tiresias	Julian Beck (courtesy of the Living Theatre)
Laius	Luciano Bartoli
Laius' slave	Francesco Leonetti
Polybus	Ahmed Bellachmi
Polybus' shepherd	Giandomenico Davoli
Angelo, the boy-messenger	Ninetto Davoli
The priest	Pier Paolo Pasolini

* 104 minutes for the version shown in Britain.

OEDIPUS REX

Scene 1. A street in Sacile. Exterior. Day.

A street, a house, and the late afternoon sun. Those long afternoons deep in the provinces. Only the silence, the emptiness — and the flies — of that time of day.

The countryside is just beyond the houses. Humble dwellings, for the lower middle classes.

There are the characteristic porches, gutters and small lintels over the doors: tell-tale signs of the maritime nobility which has ruled this hinterland for centuries. Yes, there should be nothing but the sun, with maybe two children in primary school, and a soldier, passing by.

But the soldier should be wearing an infantryman's uniform of the nineteen-thirties.

Scene 2. A house in Sacile. Interior. Day.

Inside the house a woman has just given birth. She is out of view. Only the new-born child can be seen, in the midwife's hands.

The spectator will see the beginnings of this life as in a speeded-up documentary: the first actions, the first cries, the first experience of light (that provincial sunlight coming in through the blinds, through the unbleached canvas with its Idrian embroidery).

Scene 3. On the banks of the Livenza. Exterior. Day. (Stills on page 33)

A rug spread in a field. The child rejoicing in the sunshine. His little eyes are open: he's not hungry, or sleepy — just basking away the lazy hours.

If someone picks him up — and now two hands take hold of him — he lets himself be picked up. If he's taken across the field — now fast, now slow — he lets himself be taken. Round about him are legs and arms belonging to girls. No faces can be seen. They are playing ring-a-ring-o'-roses, a madcap, light-

hearted game, as seen by him, a child, for whom reality appears in bits and pieces : arms picking him up, legs skipping around him.

He is passed from one pair of arms to another, and is pressed to a woman's breast.

Perhaps trees will come spinning into view : ashes, sorghum, and willows — willows above all. Drooping with their long, weeping leaves over a terrible void, a darkness, something unearthly.

Now some hands are shaking leaves over the gay child's head, and the laughter and joking voices of girls around him can be heard. The game starts up again : hands, arms, hips, legs on all sides — everything seen from the child's own level. And the willows, drenched in that glorious afternoon sun deep in the provinces : a mysterious corner of the world ; no north, no south — just an immense hole where a new life is stirring.

The willow leaves brush against the water.

The legs clamber aboard a boat, arms pushing, other arms taking hold of an oar ; and all around the sound of laughter and happy voices.

Now the willows are moving against a background of sky and shining clouds. And the girls' faces, now still, and their shoulders and arms too, slipping past the silvery shadow of the willows.

In the midst of laughter, the child is calmly passed from one pair of girl's arms to another as the boat glides along, until he comes to the arms which press him to a woman's breast.

Over the child's smooth, serene head, a hand undoes the front of a light blouse, and a white breast emerges. The fastenings are Thirties-style toggles. Contentedly, the child begins to suck, as the boat goes gliding on through the green water, amongst the silver sheen of the willows.

Having drunk his fill, the child raises his clear, sparkling eyes, and sees, along with us :

his mother's face.

His mother's face leaning over him : a woman of queenly beauty, her Tartar eyes long and slanted, and welling with a cruel sweetness.

The child laughs : and together with his mother, for the first

time, he sees the world around him :
the river and the willows gleaming in the sun,
the boat filled with girls, the young mother's friends,
the bend in the river, where the boat comes ashore, and a
green field behind. In the distance a cutting — for the road,
and perhaps a railway, too.

*Scene 4. Threshing floor. Exterior. Day.**

The child is sitting on a bench : its little eyes are open.
What's going on?

A creature, a dog, comes up close and looks at him.

Immersed in a speechless sun, human beings are performing
strange tasks. Wheat is heaped in the middle of the floor : the
human beings are threshing it with flails.

The dog goes away, then comes back.

A little spastic boy is sitting near the child, laughing and
laughing. He goes away, then comes back, laughing all the
time.

The human beings who have been beating the grain and rais-
ing a cloud of dust now run off all together, and disappear
behind a few arches at the back of the threshing floor.

Then they come back in a gig : the horse comes up to within
a few yards of the child and, as soon as it stops, drops a couple
of turds of manure. The dog goes up to sniff them.

Far away in the distance is the mother, with the other human
beings thronging about her as around a queen; a loud, strong
voice is raised — a voice from dreamland.

SERVANT'S VOICE : *Yes my lady, yes my lady.*

The child starts crying.

The mother runs up and takes him in her arms; in his mother's
arms, the child is able to see other things :

two hens flapping their wings at something which must have
frightened them.

Scene 5. Barracks. Exterior. Day. (Stills on page 33)

The mother is wheeling a pram within a barracks courtyard.
A few infantrymen are walking through the whiteness of the

* As will be seen from the cutting continuity, this scene was not included in
the final version of the film.

courtyard, ringed with gloomy buildings.

The mother wheels the pram as far as the orderly room. She leaves the pram in a strip of shade, near an ugly window. She goes inside the orderly room.

A few scattered swallows call shrilly from the sky. In distant rooms mysterious voices can be heard, coming and going.

SOLDIER'S SONGS, OR A MILITARY BAND REHEARSING.

The mother comes back out of the orderly room with the father. He is a young officer, in full uniform, with a blue sash across his chest, silver pendants on his epaulettes, a tall hat with lieutenant's stripes, and a sabre hanging by his side.

He comes up close to the pram and looks in, smiling terribly. The child looks at him, his limpid little eyes devoid of expression: perhaps he is already *pretending* indifference.

The father looks at him, standing out in his petit-bourgeois soldier's uniform against the sky and the song of the swallows. He is listening to his own inner voice. It is loud and solemn, as in a tragic drama.

FATHER'S INNER VOICE: *Here he is, the child who is gradually going to take your place in the world. Yes, he will hound you away and take your rightful place. He will kill you. He is here for no other reasons. He knows it.^{1*} The first thing he will rob you of is your wife, your sweet wife who you believe lives only for you. While instead there is love between this fellow here and her; and you are well aware that she returns it, that she is betraying you. Through love of his mother, this fellow will murder his father. And you can do nothing about it. Nothing at all.²*

The child is still looking at the father, in silence: averting his gaze every so often, like a tender little animal, and then looking at him again, serious and intense. Do they understand each other? And are they silent because of this mysterious understanding?

The mother too, standing to one side, the sweet young wife, in her toggle fastenings, has probably understood. She smiles, but the smile freezes on her lips. She is staring hard and fixedly, as though trapped in the shadow of presentiment.

SOLDIER'S SONGS OR THE BAND.

* These small numbers in this text refer to dialogue which appears in the final version of the film, as well as here in Pasolini's original screenplay. (See Cutting Continuity, page 105.)

Scene 6. A house in Sacile. Interior. Night. (Stills on page 34)

The child is in its cot, in the dining room.

Its eyes are open, and it seems to be waiting and thinking.

The mother peeps in through the door from the other room.

The child closes its eyes: perhaps it is *pretending* to sleep.

MOTHER: *Sleep.*

She goes back into the other room: it is the parents' bedroom.

In the centre is the great bed; against one wall a wardrobe;

in the other wall a large window, which looks out over the last houses in the village and to the willows along the Livenza.

The mother still hasn't finished dressing, while the father is already immaculately uniformed, ready to go out.

He gives his boots a final polish.

The mother slips into her elegant evening gown; she lingers in front of the mirror finishing her make-up.

The father draws near her, and seeing her so beautiful, cannot resist embracing her: the long, sensual, intimate embrace of a married couple who no longer have anything to hide from one another.

In the background, the child's eyes are closed.

The parents tip-toe past, so as not to wake him up. They pause a moment to look at him, as they go out like two thieves.

The child lies there with its eyes closed. Dissolve.

The child's eyes are open, but he's not crying.

He's already more than a year old, perhaps nearly two.

In the distance, the music from a popular dance tune of the Thirties can be heard: 'A Santa Lucia'.

The child looks around, bewildered; but he's not crying.

Very slowly, as if guided by that distant music, he slips out of the sheets, and down from the little bed, and patters across to the french window. He opens it and ventures out amongst the geranium vases on the balcony, pressing his little face to the wrought iron bars, watching.

Down below is a courtyard: a childhood, a province, a single night of the year. A night with the moon and stars. The crickets and frogs are drowned by the notes of 'A Santa Lucia'. In the house across the courtyard, all the second floor lights are on. The evening breeze plays with the curtains, which shine white in the night. Behind them can be seen vague

shadows, some still, others moving, as though buffeted by a light wind.

At the bottom of the courtyard (but is it a courtyard? Or a little square?) is a fountain. Its sprinkle of water sparkles in the night. The more humble folk — old women — are at their doorsteps, on strawless stools and benches. Children too, perhaps only a little older than Oedipus; but children of the working class, and hence freer, already used to staying up late, on this night of nights. Their necks craning upwards, they gaze at the well-off people enjoying themselves.

Silhouetted against a curtain billowing in the breeze and lit from inside by the strong, naked light, two shadows pause: their clothes gave them away as the mother and father, standing close together, in profile.

They are in each other's arms, talking softly. Then they embrace, and begin to dance.

Below, in the courtyard, there is shouting and laughter.

Two little children, a boy and a girl, no more than four or five years old, are dancing in imitation of the grown-ups.

Then all of a sudden it's the end of the world. A terrible, earth-shaking explosion. And a blinding flash of light, casting an eerie whiteness over the plaster houses, abruptly cuts off individuals and things from the darkness.

And everywhere shouting and talking, voices of alarm and of merriment.

New explosions, new blinding flashes of light.

The people in the courtyard are straining their eyes up at the sky.

The people in the party on the second floor rush to the windows, nearly trampling down the curtains; they crowd onto the small terrace. Everyone is laughing and shouting, pointing up into the sky.

The child cannot see the fireworks: perhaps he might be able to see just the odd falling star drop out of the sky in front of him. But he sees nothing, because the uproar has terrified him. His eyes are shut tight and blinded by tears. He cries and doesn't move, clinging to the balcony, as desperate as a little calf which can do nothing to harm its persecutors.

While on the other side of the courtyard, such laughter, such

gaiety; the mother and father too, arm in arm, are watching the spectacle, happy and smiling. The blinding flashes light them up in turn, making them white as chalk, fixing forever their youthful smiles of that evening. Dissolve.

The child — now that peace is restored — drags himself back, with the resignation of an adult, to his little bed, climbs in, stretches out, closes his eyes. But the night, that night of nights, is not yet over.

Gently the door is opened, and the parents come in from the party.

They cross in front of their child, and, allies in each other's arms, they gaze at him.

The mother adjusts the covers, and straightens the bed — she holds back a moment, but impatiently the father pulls her away.

They come into the bedroom arm in arm, embrace, and start undressing in silence and in haste.

In the background, the child's eyes are open.

Now that the music has finished, the desperate insistence of the crickets and frogs makes itself heard. The summer is deep-rooted. The heat is etched in the air. In through the open window comes that symphony; and the spectacle of the moon on the willows along the Livenza, on the roads, on the peaceful fields. In their great marriage bed, the mother and father are making love: they kiss and embrace, their bodies fused in ignorance of shame or spite.

In the background, the child's eyes are open. The sighs of the mother and father mingle with the groaning of the crickets and frogs.

In the great bed, the parents' love-making is long and tranquil, with the sultry and familiar moon shining down on them. When it is over the father rises, and as if his duty is, at that moment, of greater stature and importance than the mother's, he goes to see his child.

The child, in his cradle, has his eyes closed: he is sleeping.

The father leans over and gazes long at him. Then suddenly he puts out his hands and squeezes the child's tiny bare feet in

his fists, as if he wanted to crush them.

Scene 7. Mount Cithaeron. Exterior. Day. (Still on page 35)
Beyond Oedipus' little body, against the violent sky of the African Mediterranean, great reddish mountains can be seen. His little whimperings are lost in the silence of a boundless summer.

His little body is slung on a pole, tied by the wrists and ankles, like a kid. His head is dangling upside down.

The slopes of the reddish desert mountain rise and fall with the slow step of the man carrying the kid Oedipus strung on a pole over his shoulder.

Great cracks open in the earth; and strata of rock-like terraces, smoothed by the wind, rise towards the leaden, still sky.

Far down below, through the crackling air, the greenness of a valley can be seen, dotted with occasional palm trees; it merges finally into the gloomy mauve, veneered with a deeper red, like dried blood.

The man bearing the pole with the whimpering little animal strung to it looks around.

Yes, the spot is sufficiently deserted, removed from all human eyes. He puts down the little bundle on the rock, untying it from the pole. As in a dream he undoes the thongs knotted around its wrists. Then he draws his great shepherd's knife from his belt, raises it, and makes to slit the creature's throat . . . But the creature is looking at him. For a long time both look at each other. The child, lying naked on the ground, his feet tied together, and the man with his peasant's features.

Then the man stands up and, his pole outlined against the sky, he walks away. Hawks circle screeching in the sky.

A snake slithers between the blood-coloured rocks.

Scene 8. The other side of Mount Cithaeron. Exterior. Day. (Stills on page 35)

The shepherd of Corinth and his assistant are making music. The dumb sheep and cows are browsing on the scattered grass of the greenish little valley, in the pink throat of the desert mountain; and while the animals eat through the long, dream-like day, their overseers give themselves up to music.

The eldest one has the fine, slightly imbecilic face of a peasant, but the boy is even more handsome.* He is a youth who doesn't know what it means to be a slave; or at least it hasn't touched him yet, or roused him. His gay musician's eyes are sparkling with joy, defiance and graceful indiscipline.

The eldest one plays his instrument seriously, a coarse, strange object that gives out the authentic, popular music of that time and of all times: the music of the myth of the earth.

Then, suddenly, the two stop . . . And in the brief silence that comes after the music, a wailing can be heard.

What's going on?

They look each other in the eye.

Whatever it is, the surprise in store for them will be welcome — a relief from those long hours of boredom with the animals in the desert.

The youth's eyes are shining: curiosity is stronger than decorum — he cannot conceal it.

The wiser old man is more hypocritical, pretending just to be worried. All the same the two shepherds rouse themselves quickly, becoming excited, and run, their ears tuned to the wailing, like dogs to the prey.

They run around rocks, leap over holes, and fly along the terraces smoothed by the wind.

The crying sounds closer and closer. Here is the wailing child, naked on the rock.

The two men are upon him, the eldest one picks him up, and rocks him in gruff imitation of the women he has seen. The child cries even louder. The youth is chuckling merrily.

Then the old man notices the child's feet tied together, swollen with the strain.

SHEPHERD OF CORINTH: *What swollen feet you've got . . . Look how tight they bound them . . .*³

And he unties the thong, caressing and kissing his little feet better.

SHEPHERD OF CORINTH: *Poor little Swollen Feet . . . now, now, don't cry . . .*⁴

By now they are going back down towards the green valley,

* In the film, the shepherd's assistant does not appear.

beyond the mauve of the desert, when a sudden apparition pulls them up. Grotesque, clumsy and droll, the Theban slave pops up from behind a rock.

The two slow down, and look at him with doubt and anxiety in their eyes.

The Theban slave looks them over in his turn, with a steady and mysterious gaze. No words are spoken.

The two shepherds have now actually stopped, and are looking at him, less with apprehension than with curiosity. His eyes fascinate them.

He goes on staring at them silently; but an expression of satisfaction now spreads mysteriously across his face.

Uncertain of what to do, but supposing that the other is claiming the child, the Corinthian shepherd timidly makes to offer it to him.

The Theban slave then smiles — a smile almost of friendship . . . the shepherd is infected with it and smiles in his turn with complicity; at the same time he offers the other the child more decisively.

But the slave, his eyes now shining with an almost dog-like joy, suddenly turns and runs off, leaping from rock to rock, until he is finally out of sight, in that endless, deep silence.

Scene 9. Corinth. Exterior. Day. (Stills on page 36)

Within its crumbling walls, the 'little town' shimmers in the dark red haze of dust.

The houses emerge, red and crumbling, beyond the red and crumbling walls: their scant towers are fortified with battlements, fashioned with barbarous refinement by local craftsmen . . .

Before the city spreads the dust, and far away, the vivid green of the fields along the banks of the river.

Like a swollen torrent, flocks of sheep are coming down from all directions.

There is a sort of market in front of the city. In its centre, under the small gate, is a canopy whose roughness has the same barbarous refinement as the battlements; it is spread with skins and golden ornaments.

Under the canopy, as though presiding over his flocks, is the

king.

Around him is his little court of scribes, heralds etc. Today is set aside for commercial transactions, and the shepherds have come to give and to receive. In all this confusion and dust, the Corinthian shepherd and his assistant can now be made out. He is carrying Oedipus, little Swollen Feet, in his arms, with the awkward pose of a man unaccustomed to such burdens. Of course the baby is crying. But the constant hubbub of bleatings, bellowings, shouting, as well as the notes of an unseen orchestra which always accompanies important peasant festivals, drown out his voice.

Silently, his burden in his hands, the shepherd takes his turn to stand before his King, the lord of flocks, and timidly — unsure as to whether he is bringing the King a pleasant surprise, or instead an unpleasant reminder of his wife's sterility — he holds out the child.

King Polybus looks at him uncomprehendingly, though deep inside him there is a secret and unfathomable hope.

The shepherd gazes up at the King, emotion choking him.

The King stares at the shepherd.

The shepherd stares at the King.

At last, after a long and pregnant silence, the King utters a few hesitant phrases.

KING POLYBUS : *What is this you're bringing me?*⁵

SHEPHERD : *A child! . . . If you want it . . .*

KING POLYBUS : *A child of Fortune!*⁶

SHEPHERD : *It was on its own, up on Mount Cithaeron.⁷ That's where I found it. It was crying and crying. I brought it back with me, thinking that you . . .*⁸

KING POLYBUS : *Give it to me, wretch, give it to me . . .*⁹

And, his eyes gleaming with a barbarous joy, he snatches it from the shepherd's hands, and tosses it up in the air, as Hector did with Astianatte — and Oedipus, like Astianatte, can only cry even louder.

KING POLYBUS : *Child of Fortune!*¹⁰

King Polybus is a great, fat, sanguine man, at once fierce and gentle : a peasant among peasants, but one who eats as well as a lord, his flesh red with meat and wine. He has the great whiskers of a rogue, and the eyes of a gazelle.

Holding the child high in the air, he starts dancing for joy, leaping up and down in his own version of a tarantella.

Then his mood changes and he turns fiercely on a group of youngsters who are scattered around with their mothers and fathers, all at a respectful distance. He shouts:

KING POLYBUS: *You brats, you see this tiny tot squealing like a kid? Well, one day this little child of Fortune is going to be your King!*¹¹

The children look on in silence, with just the faintest hint of derision in their eyes.

KING POLYBUS: *Get down on your knees, and pay homage to the hereditary prince of Corinth!*

Pushed on by their parents — strong fathers and pious mothers already servile — the children get down on their knees, bowing and scraping. Meanwhile the King has started dancing for joy again, tossing the child up and down over his head.

But the child, lacking the proper respect, does something quite unbecoming to an hereditary prince. The King is not at all put out, and merely wipes the wet patches on his sleeve and robe, to the accompanying giggles of the children round about.

Then, regaining his authority, he demands of his vassals:

KING POLYBUS: *Where is the Queen!*

VASSAL: *She is with the maids, down by the river, supervising the washing . . .*

KING POLYBUS: *Bring me my horse!*

At once his horse is brought; he mounts it with a great leap, and clutching the child tight in his arms, takes off like a mad-man.

In the dusty market-place, and along the red walls of the city, the people make way respectfully before his frantic flight.

Scene 10. A river near Corinth. Exterior. Day. (Stills on page 36)

The river is only a short ride from the city.

Amongst the palms and the lush, green grass, some of the girls are washing clothes, while others spread them out, multi-coloured against the grass, as in a scene on Achilles' shield.

The King rides over to them, the town tiny and red behind him against the sky.

He pulls up in a cloud of dust. The Queen, surrounded by her maids, looks at him in amazement.

She is a strong, buxom, woman; but she lacks the crazy vitality of her husband the King. Something must have saddened her, and she has become humble and religious, like certain bigoted but wholly likeable peasant women.

She stares at the King in disbelief.

KING POLYBUS : *Why do you look at me like that, my Queen?*¹² *Why so sad and serious, and why this apprehension and suspicion in your eyes? You should be laughing rather,*¹³ *and praying to your gods. Today we've been granted a child!*¹⁴ *And who else could it have been but the gods who sent it to us?*

Without a word, the Queen rushes up to the King, and tries to pull the baby out of his arms.

QUEEN MEROPE : *Give him to me! Look how you're holding him! Do you want to kill him, the poor little thing? What do you think you're holding in your arms, a sack of potatoes?*¹⁵

The King sees that his wife is right, but on the other hand there is nothing he can do about it. He sits on his horse, feeling embarrassed and a little repentant.

Meanwhile the Queen holds the little creature to her breast, hugging it maternally.

QUEEN MEROPE : *What are they doing to you, these wicked men? All they're good for is kicking animals and carrying swords — may the gods curse them, the graceless, ill-mannered wretches . . .*

At last, after all this time, the child feels safe, and in a place where he belongs. He stops crying, and although his little face is streaked with tears, he looks up at the woman : a mother's sweet, tender and protective face. The maids too have gathered round, smiling and curious.

MAIDS : *How handsome he is! . . . His eyes are like two little jewels! . . . What lovely little curls he has!*¹⁶

King Polybus dismounts and walks up to the Queen, who is standing with the child in her arms. He leans over it, and starts trying to amuse it, wiggling his fingers and hand in front of its face :

KING POLYBUS : *Kitchy-koo, kitchy-koo . . .*

The child looks at him, fascinated. Proud of his success, King Polybus goes on to an even funnier trick : he pulls the most

hilarious faces, curling up his nose, wiggling his ears, jerking his whiskers up and down . . . The child cannot stop laughing as he watches him. Then the mother laughs, and all the maids . . .

QUEEN MEROPE : *My little Swollen Feet,*¹⁷ *little Oedipus, my son, my son* . . .¹⁸

The child laughs and laughs.

Scene 11. A playing field near Corinth. Exterior. Day.

A javelin flies through the air, in a long arc, then buries itself in the red earth. Then another sticks into the earth a little further on. Then a third comes flying through the air and lands quivering. Then another, and another. The last one covers the greatest distance of all.

The youth who threw it is about twenty years old, with high cheek-bones and a wild face, pathetic and violent, infantile and decrepit : it is Oedipus, now grown into a man.

He laughs triumphantly, a ringing, barbarous laugh.

Swept along by his strength, he sprints up to his victorious javelin, snatches it out of the ground, and leaps about, waving it in the air.

His companions lag behind. They claim their javelins resignedly, as becomes the defeated.

The games are exercises only : there are no spectators, save a few urchins, dirty and curious, and the odd shepherd or peasant passing by with his ass ; but in the background, in the shade of a clump of bushes, is a group of girls looking on, laughing with feigned indifference.

The youth who came second takes hold of his javelin furiously, and looks defiantly at Oedipus.

YOUTH : *We'll see who's best with the discus* . . .

Oedipus is hardly even listening to him ; driven on by his overflowing energy, he rushes up to where the equipment is stacked, and picks up a discus. He remembers to shout, though, as boys do in these games :

OEDIPUS : *I'll throw last!* . . .

The four or five competitors throw the discus one after another : as soon as one of them has thrown and the discus lands, they all rush off together and mark its distance with a little

twig planted in the ground.

The girls are watching it all with great interest, though certainly not from a purely sporting point of view.

Now Oedipus' rival has his throw. He is probably also a rival for the graces of the prettiest of the girls. She stands there watching them with that assumed indifference of hers . . . The discus lands a long way away, much farther than all the others.

While the youths rush off to mark the throw, the girl's face changes — she looks petulant and worried : it must be Oedipus she wants . . .

And now it's Oedipus' turn to throw. He swings around with elegance and power : now the discus flies from his hand, up, up into the sky in a long arc. It hits the ground with a dull thud, and the dust it raises shows that it has fallen beside the furthest twig — the one belonging to his strongest rival. But is it past, or short of the mark?

Oedipus takes off like a bolt of lightning, reaches the spot first and has a look : the discus has landed only a hair's breadth short of his enemy's mark. As deft as a thief, with the tip of his foot, he pushes the discus past the twig, at the same time shouting, jumping up and down and dancing, as if to conceal the shady movement of his foot.

OEDIPUS : *I've won! I've won!*¹⁹

And without waiting for the others, still like a bolt of lightning, he sprints across to the group of girls, screaming :

OEDIPUS : *Here you are, crown me, give me the crown of oak. I'm the winner!*²⁰

The prettiest girl has the victor's oak crown in her hand, ready to place it on Oedipus' head. It could be the Olympic Games . . .

Oedipus, a lover's smile on his lips, feasts his eyes on her as he dips his head for the crown.

But now the others come rushing up, their faces furious. Oedipus' rival is choking with anger.

YOUTH : *I'm the winner!*²¹ *I'm the winner! Oedipus pushed his discus forward*²² *with his foot. You can see by the mark*²³ *in the dust!*²⁴

And he throws himself at Oedipus, as if to snatch the crown

from his head. But Oedipus is already infuriated by his words; he jumps on him, and starts punching him. Of the two, he is the stronger fighter — he is more violent and brutal. The youth is soon on the ground, his mouth bleeding.

He writhes in the dust, twisting and turning on himself like a snake.

YOUTH: *Foundling!*²⁵ *Child of Fortune!*²⁶ *Adopted son of your mother and father!*²⁷

Is Oedipus deaf? Or does he no longer understand the meaning of words? He goes on laughing, in ecstasy over his victory, as if he had heard nothing at all.

Scene 12. The Corinthian royal palace. Interior. Day. (Stills on page 37)

Oedipus' face is lined with an infinite sadness.

He is sitting at the dinner table with his parents. Servants come and go with plates, and a musician is playing a strange instrument. It buzzes like a cicada, in a monotonous, barbarous, obsessive and crazy rhythm.

POPULAR MUSIC FROM THE BARD.

Oedipus is silent and gloomy.

First King Polybus, then Queen Merope, look at him anxiously, but say nothing.

Oedipus is not touching his food; he is surly, closed within himself, like an animal when it feels sick. He sighs.

QUEEN MEROPE: *Why won't you eat something, son? Are you feeling sick? Why so silent? Are you angry for some reason?*

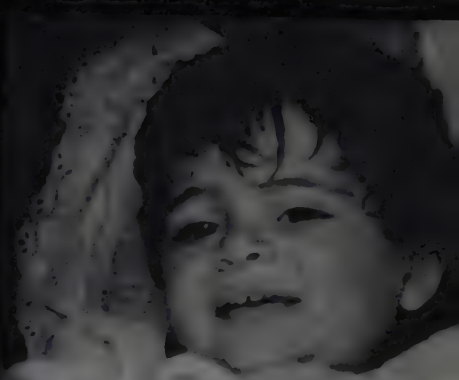
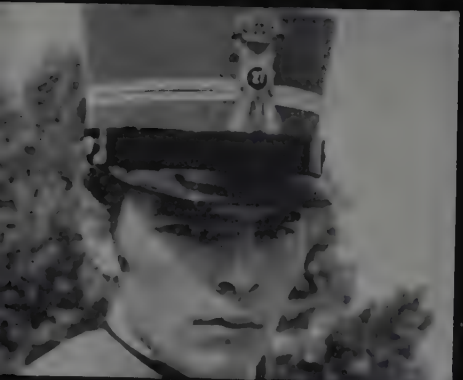
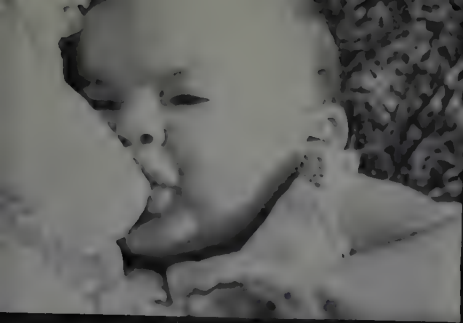
Oedipus, like a spoilt, overbearing child, snaps a surly, ill-tempered reply.

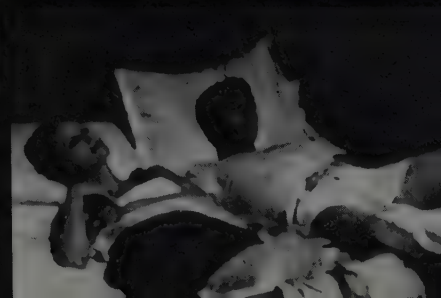
OEDIPUS: *That's enough! I've had enough! It must be the hundredth time you've asked me that question! I'm all right, there's nothing wrong with me. So shut up!*

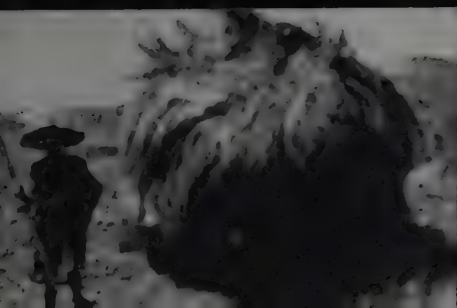
King Polybus picks up the plate which happens to be nearest his hand, and throws it with barbarous violence at the musician.

KING POLYBUS: *Take your whining some place else, you ass! Do you want to drive us all mad?*

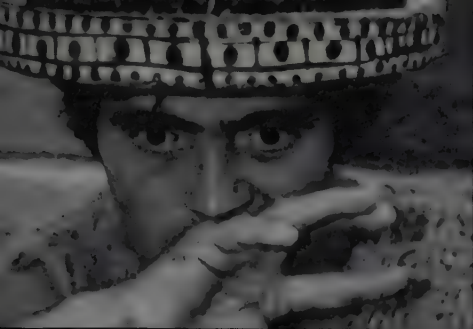
The musician dodges the missile, and at once stops playing his extraordinary instrument.

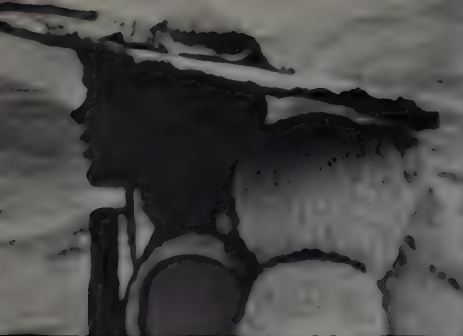




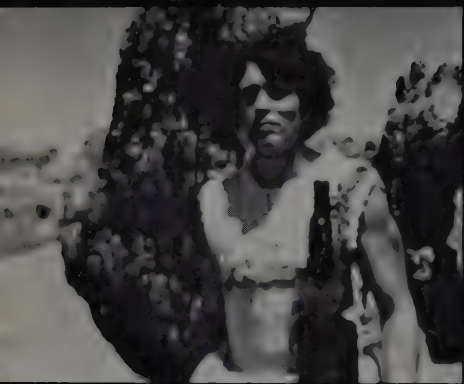












The other musicians look furtively at each other, and launch into a spirited dance number, something very gay.

For a while, Oedipus and his parents eat in silence. Then Oedipus starts to speak:

OEDIPUS: *Mother, last night I had a horrible dream . . . which I can't recall . . . All I know is that it was horrible . . . I woke up sobbing and trembling, with a fear of the dark I haven't had since I was a child . . .*²⁸ *The gods must have wanted to tell me something; but what, if I can't remember it? If I'm not capable of remembering it? I stayed awake till dawn, with shivers up my spine because of the fear that the dark and the silence aroused in me . . . Mother, father: I would like to go to Delphi, to consult the oracle . . .*²⁹ *to ask it about this dream of mine . . . to make it tell me . . . what I can't remember . . .*³⁰

QUEEN MEROPE: *But of course, my son! Everyone in the course of his life makes a pilgrimage*³¹ *to the sanctuary of Delphi, and you haven't done so yet. It's time you went. It's a wonderful trip;*³² *I went there as a girl, with your father. Isn't that so, King? Do you remember? It's much bigger than our most important festivals . . .*³³

KING POLYBUS: *But of course, people from all over Greece go to Delphi. There's always something happening there, around the sanctuary! We'll give you the most wonderful escort you could wish for: horses, slaves, gifts. No son of a King will ever make a better impression than you!*³⁴

OEDIPUS: *No father, I want to go alone.*³⁵

POLYBUS: *Alone? What do you mean, alone? You're a prince, you can't . . .*

OEDIPUS: *In front of God, what use to me is luxury and a huge escort? I'm going to Delhi to consult God, not to impress the pilgrims and tourists . . .*

POLYBUS: *But . . .*³⁶

QUEEN MEROPE: *Our son is right! The gods don't want a display of riches, but sincerity of heart. And when are you thinking of leaving, son?*³⁷

OEDIPUS: *Tomorrow morning, at dawn.*³⁸

QUEEN MEROPE: *At once? So soon?*³⁹

OEDIPUS: *Why should I wait? I don't want that dream to come back and torment me. I want to know what it means.*⁴⁰

*Scene 13. The countryside around Corinth. Exterior. Dawn.**

Sheep sleeping in their folds.

A dog sleeping.

A shepherd sleeping, his instrument beside him.

A tree, and a nightingale singing.

NIGHTINGALE'S SONG.

Slowly the nightingale's song dies away. Now the first notes of the skylark can be heard, as it flies over the empty fields.

The first streaks of dawn are appearing in the sky.

SKYLARK'S TRILLING.

*Scene 14. The Corinthian royal palace: patio. Interior. Dawn.
(Stills on page 37)*

In the almost sacred silence of the dawn, the early hour making them look pale and drawn, the King, the Queen and Oedipus are saying their farewells.

It is a family event, small and solemn.

The mother, with the help of a maid, is putting the last cloak inside her son's pack; her movements are nervous and precise. The father in the meantime gestures to his son to follow him to one side, through delicacy.

He takes out a tinkling bagful of gold coins from the belt he wears looped under his great belly.

He offers the bag to his son, who accepts it with a certain timidity.

KING POLYBUS: *Here, this is a tidy sum . . . you never know what might happen on a long journey, what with the will of the gods . . .*

OEDIPUS mumbling, with a smile of filial gratitude, mingled with the superiority of youth towards money: *Thank you, father.*

Then they turn back towards Oedipus' mother, who is standing heroically but painfully with his heavy pack in her hands, bent almost double with the weight. Oedipus hastens to free her of the burden. It is no more than a twig for him, as he swings it over his shoulders.

And now the mother breaks down, the tears flowing freely.

* As will be seen from the cutting continuity, this scene was altered slightly in the film.

Her sobbing is out of all proportion to the farewell appropriate for a son who is leaving on a short pilgrimage; but she cannot hold herself back. Perhaps it is because this is the first time that mother and son are being separated.

Oedipus caresses her, paternally, almost jovially, trying to make a joke of this womanly emotion: but by now the infectious sorrow has made his father's eyes glisten with tears as well. And the dawn light is so mournful; and in the background the slaves are gathered together with such gloomy restraint . . .

The light-heartedness is extinguished even from Oedipus' eyes, and a shadow of horror, of painful presentiment, crosses his face . . .

He makes an effort, and gives his mother a caress.

OEDIPUS: *Don't cry mother. I'll be back in a few days . . . in a few days . . .*⁴¹ *Good-bye mother . . . Good-bye father . . .*⁴²

And he turns his back on them, going off almost at a run.

Choked by her terrible sobbing, and inspired by prophetic gods, the mother can barely find the strength to speak, to stammer out her farewell.

QUEEN MEROPE: *Good-bye, my son . . . good luck! Farewell my little Swollen Feet!*⁴³

Scene 15. Corinth. Exterior. Dawn.

Oedipus leaves the palace, and goes down the precipitous streets of the town, none of them wider than alleyways, winding their way between the windowless red walls of the crumbling houses.

There's not a soul on the streets at this hour. Only a stray dog, and the crowing of the cocks.

Weighed down by a heavy sorrow, Oedipus has to make an effort to regain his self-control.

He lengthens his step, and begins to whistle.

And thus he recedes slowly into the distance, as he descends the twisting alleys of the dusty red town.

Scene 16. Countryside near Corinth. Exterior. Morning. (Still on page 38)

Now he is walking through a desert landscape.

The city is far behind him, a little mound of houses, hemmed in by high walls; lost forever from his life, a city of strangers almost, so mysteriously tiny there in the distance. And Oedipus strides on, his footfalls echoing in the silence.

Scene 17. Delphic sanctuary. Interior. Day. (Stills on page 38)

The interior of the sanctuary of Apollo is thronged with pilgrims, like one of those churches that Michetti painted.

A frenzied slice of humanity is to be seen there : cripples, the blind, mothers and children, paralytics, whole families and, in their midst, his proud bearing distinguishing him from the slaves, some prince or other. The interior of the temple rings with the sound of voices, prayers, laments, and singing.

Some people are dragging themselves along the ground towards the sacellum. Before this sacellum, and surrounded by a flock of haughty priests, is the 'queue' of pilgrims waiting for their response.

Amongst these is Oedipus, his face dark and frowning.

Slowly the queue moves forward until it is Oedipus' turn; he is ushered into the sacellum, where the priestess is waiting.

She is an abstract, absent, fanatical and obese woman; her face has the pallor of a corpse, and her black-ringed eyes are full of hate and hysteria.

As she casts her eyes on Oedipus standing timidly and awkwardly before her, her expression of hysterical hatred becomes even more pronounced.

Impassively and mechanically, she performs the acts of the ritual, then, without any form of participation, almost bureaucratically, in a species of dumb rage, she pronounces the horrifying verdict of the god on this youth. As he is doubtless guilty and loathsome to the god, he must therefore be just as loathsome to herself.

PRIESTESS : *Take care!*⁴⁴ *In your future it is written that you will kill your father and make love to your mother.*⁴⁵ *This is what the god has said, and this is what inevitably will come to pass.*⁴⁶

Oedipus cannot believe what he has just heard : in the face of such frightful simplicity, in the face of those two words which condemn him without hope, a horrifying anguish seizes hold of him, and turns him to stone. Terror-stricken, he cannot

move from the spot. Until finally someone pushes him hastily towards the exit, to make way for another pilgrim.

*Scene 18. Delphic sanctuary. Exterior. Day.**

A glorious, cleansing sun is shining full on the celebrations in front of the temple. Along with the powerful rumbling of the crowd, a human joy emanates from it all, one which seems to be the only possible form of life. The shanty dwellings, the trails of pilgrims, the games, the races and tumbling bouts between the boys, the moanings of the beggars, and the medley of folk music sounds being played here and there : all this seems to point to the world's truth, its reality. A reality which has now slipped out of Oedipus' hands.

POPULAR MUSIC.

Oedipus passes through the crowd as if in a dream. He seems to recognize nothing. His mouth open, and terror in his eyes, he looks around. He could be an animal on the run, or a beggar imploring pity.

He walks at random, cutting through the crowd and gazing at the objects one after another as his eyes come to rest on them. These are the faithful and mysterious symbols of a reality which eludes him.

He sees mothers and fathers holding their little ones by the hand, or nursing them in their arms. He sees an invalid, his eyes gleaming in his jaundiced face, go by in a litter. He sees the idle rich of his own generation, walking with girls at their sides, laughing happily. He sees toddlers still lost in infancy, playing frenziedly, forgetfully, immersed in a life irredeemably lost for Oedipus.

Young boys playing, sly and ingenuous : happy.

Oedipus looking at them, open-mouthed, terrified.

The boys playing.

Oedipus looking at them.

The boys playing.

Oedipus looking at them.

Oedipus' mouth is half-open. From it issues a sound like a

* As will be seen from the cutting continuity, the following three scenes were altered slightly in the filming.

moan, or a death rattle, coming involuntarily from his throat; he seems hardly aware of it. He still cannot master the pain which fills his being. It dominates him, drives him mechanically onwards.

He goes off groaning.

Scene 19. Countryside near the sanctuary: the road to Corinth. Exterior. Day. (Still on page 39)

Like an automaton now he is walking away from the sanctuary, which can just be seen in the distance over his shoulder. He meets a trail of pilgrims coming in the opposite direction. But he reacts as if he were blind. He doesn't move. These people avoid him, looking at him the way people look at a monster or a social outcast.

Once again he is alone.

On the milestone beside the road is inscribed the word 'Corinth'. This is the road leading back home, to his parents. Oedipus stares at the word, as though struck dumb.

Borne by the wind from the sanctuary, the gay folk tunes sound a little louder. They are heavy with ancient omens.

Oedipus drops wearily onto the milestone, and gives himself up freely to the convulsions of tears.

He cries and cries, covering his face. Others pass and look at him. Their manner points him out as someone different, someone who is not part of the mainstream of human life. In their eyes is a mixture of pity, fear and hostility. Dissolve.

Now he is crying no longer. Tears streak his emaciated cheeks. He stares vacantly into space, and sighs.

He has taken a decision. Mechanically he executes it. He gets up.

He turns his back on Corinth, and walks away.

He turns round to look at the stone carrying the name of his homeland.

Soon the stone is no more than a dot in the distance.

Scene 20. Countryside near the sanctuary: further away. Exterior. Day. (Still on page 39)

Now Oedipus is striding out more confidently and arrogantly. His eyes are dry, and they no longer have that desperate look

about them. Now his eyes are full of cunning, and bitterness. He is walking along a road with no idea of where he is going, knowing only that he wants to assault this new destiny of his. As usual, injustice will harden his resolve.

Now he has come to a parting of the ways.

Two roads lead off towards endless horizons: the clear blue of Mediterranean lands, the mountains yellowed by summer, the dryness, the buzzing of cicadas, and in the farthest reaches unknown cities rising from a world frequented by the gods.

Oedipus halts before the fork in the road, uncertain of which direction to take. But his uncertainty is tinged with contempt and arrogance. He looks to the right and to the left. Which road leads to his destiny? The word 'Thebes' is written on one milestone, and on the other, the name of a different town. Abruptly and decisively he opens his money bag — the one his father gave him — and takes out a coin. He throws it up in the air: the coin drops silently into the dust.

Oedipus picks it up, and after examining it, takes the road to Thebes. No hesitation, no second thoughts.

Aggressive, intent, he walks on in silence.

Scene 21. An inn on the road to Thebes. Exterior. Day. (Still on page 40)

A plateful of beans. Slices of bread. Broad beans and a basket of figs.

GAY TRADITIONAL DANCING MUSIC.

Oedipus is at table, under a bower which the summer is slowly consuming, eating his midday meal.

He wolfs it down with the voracious appetite of a twenty-year-old. He is totally absorbed in an intense dialogue with himself, in the pleasure he takes in living the cunning life of an animal. But every now and then he flicks his eyes, now dulled with satiety, around the room.

There's a party atmosphere to the inn. Perhaps it's a wedding. From a group of peasants playing traditional instruments, the music comes at full blast, rough and wild.

Groups of youths and girls puff and sweat as they dance in the shade of the bower. The steps they are following must surely go back to the most primitive times. Through thousands of

years the dance could not have changed: each summer it is the same, each siesta during the heat waves, when the cicadas are shrilling in ecstasy.

Old drunkards dance too, ridiculous as monkeys.

And Oedipus eats his beans.

Sitting around on some steps is a bored-looking group of youths, all of them about the same age as Oedipus. They must be the local drifters, the layabouts. Certainly Oedipus takes an immediate dislike to them, gazing at them with an absent and challenging expression in his eyes while he goes on eating his beans.

Now the prettiest of all the young couples is dancing. Perhaps they are the newly-weds.

The others form a circle around them, standing against the white walls of the inn.

A mother is breast feeding her child.

Oedipus scowls as he looks over the scene; then angrily lowering his eyes, he goes on wolfing down his food.

When he has finished he calls the inn-keeper, and ignoring the riotous celebrations going on around him, pays with a gold coin and leaves. To the layabouts — leaning back on the steps enjoying the inspired notes of the flutes and bagpipes — Oedipus suddenly becomes interesting: methodically they take in all the details of his pack and purse.

Sullen and alone, Oedipus walks out of the inn, turning his back on the gaiety.

Scene 22. The road to Thebes. Exterior. Day.

Oedipus is walking along the road that leads to far-off Thebes. He is alone, but not sad. He has resigned himself to his destiny: that of a man who can never go back, who must always press onward, out into the wide world waiting for him.

Striding along, his pack set proudly square on his shoulders, he is whistling the tune he heard earlier in the inn.

And so he walks on, whistling, lost in his thoughts.

*Scene 23. The road to Thebes: palms. Exterior. Sunset.**

* Neither this nor the following scene were included in the final version of the film.

The road through the pink desert, uniformly blistering under the summer heat, is now following a river lined by green palm trees.

It is dusk.

The cicadas are silent, making way for the frogs.

Oedipus steps off the road, and finds himself a place for the night in one of the thin patches of grass between the palms.

He stretches out, and falls asleep.

Scene 24. Palms. Exterior. Day.

Dawn has broken, and the sun is already visible over the horizon. As its rays strike Oedipus full in the face, reluctantly, with all the laziness of a twenty-year-old, he drags himself from the depths of slumber.

He gets up, and looks around.

An expression of disbelief, then of utter consternation, gradually clouds his face.

His pack is nowhere to be seen.

Nor is his purse any longer strapped to his belt.

He falls to his knees, not knowing what to think, what to do.

He looks blankly in one direction after another. It is all very still and quiet in the splendour of the dawn. The theft is as mysterious as a miracle; and like a miracle it is inescapable.

Oedipus is prostrate, on his knees.

Finally, his mind made up, he gets to his feet once again, and flexes his shoulder muscles, laughing to himself.

He regains the road, and sets off again. He lopes along as if making for a party, or as if, at any rate, he had a destination.

It's light walking, without a pack; he laughs out loud at this.

Thus stripped bare, he faces the world; he now possesses nothing but himself, his heart and his will to go on.

The road in front of him winds into the haze of the far-off horizon. A road without end, a road leading to a whole in the shape of a void. Dissolve.

Oedipus is further away, down the same road.

SOUND OF A DISTANT INSTRUMENT OR SONG.

The strange music filling the silence invests that hour with a sense of the miraculous: it's an example of the folk music

common to ancient peoples, similar to that of the negroes, and one which conforms to rules unknown in the West. Mysteriously it comes to engulf the vast expanse of the horizon. It brings pleasure in its wake as well as fear : it turns that stretch of road through the desert into something both minute and immeasurably long, both familiar and non-human.

Oedipus walks on and on, as though drawn ineluctably by that song.

He comes at last to a place where the road runs beside the river.

A boat can just be seen through the reeds. An old man, his back to the road, is making music and singing. In the prow, facing Oedipus, is a naked boy, his body endowed with the mysterious beauty of another race, his eyes dark and burning. He stands in silence, outlined against the greenness of the bank and palms.

Scene 25. The road to Thebes: a village. Exterior. Day. (Stills on page 40)

Oedipus has come in sight of a village. By now it is late afternoon : the hour when the peasants and shepherds start to turn their thoughts homewards.

The village, with its squat, wrought towers, looms small and red in the distance through the haze of dust.

The road is still following the river when Oedipus comes across a sort of votive chapel.

But the people gathered there don't seem to be the type who are fond of praying : they are anything but religious devotees. There are several youths, about the same age as Oedipus, leaning lazily against the columns, their attitudes idle and provocative.

Off on one side are two or three youngsters who seem by their expressions to be following in the footsteps of their elder brothers. Their hair is matted, dusty; their eyes wild and cunning.

There are some old men too — those wrecks from areas which have an unsavoury reputation, who sell their services as tin-smiths, or take on jobs wherever they happen to come across them. They live more or less like drunken, godless friars. Here

they are standing around an ass, chatting amongst themselves. A youth is coming out from the clump of bushes on the bank of the river. His looks are weary but his bearing proud. Immediately one of the youths lazing around jumps to his feet and goes up to meet him. They pass, and the new customer disappears behind the bushes. Dissolve.

Now it is much later; all the youths have gone. Only the youngsters and old men are left. An ancient specimen comes tottering down the path and at once Oedipus steps out to meet him, the eyes of the youngsters following him with ironic approval.

He walks about twenty-five yards till he comes to a clearing amongst the palm trees.

In the middle of the clearing is a naked woman, old and fat, her great breasts uncovered.

Oedipus gazes at her. She looks back at him.

For a long time the two stare at each other.

Oedipus takes a few hesitant steps towards her, watching her with exaggerated intensity, as any man does when, inside, he is struck by strange feelings which he doesn't recognize; then suddenly he turns on his heels and, nearly breaking into a run, he retraces his steps, hounded by the laughter of the woman.

WOMAN'S LAUGHTER.

Oedipus comes out onto the road again.

Even the youngsters look curiously at him: but now irony prevails over admiration in their eyes. An irony bordering on derision.

Oedipus sets off along his lonely road, without so much as a single look behind.

Scene 26. The road to Thebes: cutting and embankment. Exterior. Day. (Stills on pages 73-75)

Here the road is very narrow. On one side is a stone-faced cutting, and on the other, a steep slope plunging down to the river.

A carriage is coming towards Oedipus, taking up the whole road. A man's head emerges from the window — he is elderly, but still strong and violent. This is Oedipus' father.

Five soldiers and a slave driving the carriage make up his escort.

The slave is the one who carried Oedipus as a child up onto Mount Cithaeron to die.

Oedipus walks forward, holding the centre of the narrow road. It is hardly more than a track along this stretch of the river.

The carriage moves forward. Oedipus moves forward.

Oedipus and his father gaze lengthily into each other's eyes, both waiting to see what the other will do. A profound, irrational hatred at once disfigures their features: something non-human and hysterical.

It is this which forces men to savagely attack each other when they fear, irrationally, that their dignity has been questioned; when the refusal to stand aside focuses ancient and unexplored feelings, a hidden desire for revenge.

Oedipus advances, firmly resolved not to give way, to defend his pride to the last drop of blood, now that it stands in danger of being wounded. Or perhaps he is waiting only for a civil word from the other, an amicable request to move aside.

But his opponent is furious.

And no such thing occurs. Because that man is Oedipus' father.

FATHER : *Make way, scum!*⁴⁷

Oedipus says nothing. He halts in the middle of the path, looking his adversaries up and down, the way that pimps and faggots do, or knights of fortune.

His eyes have a neutral, challenging look about them. His bearing is one of an endless patience extinguishing provocation. He stands there, legs firmly apart, eyes wan, in the very centre of the road.

FATHER shouting : *Make way, scum!*⁴⁸

Without warning, Oedipus bends down and grasps a great rock, hurling it frenziedly at his father. It hits him on the forehead, drawing blood which trickles into his eyes.

Immediately the two soldiers in front rush on Oedipus, who has meanwhile drawn his sword. The other two soldiers behind are faced with the problem of getting round the carriage, which is blocking the whole of the road. One clammers up the vertical stone facing, while the other inches forward along the

edge of the drop into the river, pressing his body hard against the carriage.

The King curses and wails, smearing the blood away with his hand.

The two soldiers in front are hampered by their long lances. They attack Oedipus in hand to hand combat: two beardless youths, even younger than himself. One of them is wounded straight away, and falls whimpering to the ground.

The other falls a moment later, on top of his companion's body.

In blind rage Oedipus finishes off the wounded one, splitting open his head.

The two soldiers seem even more youthful, now that they are dead.

Their innocence lies there in the dust, soaked in blood.

Now the other two come up, but they aren't together. The one who opted for the riverside approach reaches Oedipus first. He is met by a furious assailant, before he is free even — still clinging to the carriage on the edge of the precipice, and cramped in his movements by the long lance in his hand. He cannot defend himself, and Oedipus strikes him again and again. He falls under the carriage wheels, just as the fourth soldier jumps down from the top of the sheer rock wall.

The father is still cursing and wailing, the blood now pouring from his wound.

Oedipus crosses swords with the fourth soldier, and soon fells him too. Youth and innocence lie squirming in the dust.

Oedipus then jumps up onto the carriage, and lunges at his bleeding father. The terrorized driver scrambles down and runs for his life along the path.

The father too has drawn his sword. But inside the carriage his movements are restricted, as in the grip of a nightmare.

Oedipus closes in on him, and swinging his sword like an axe, cleaves open his head, blood spurting from the gash.

Without their driver, the crazed horses kick out and take off at a gallop. But the narrow road tightens around the carriage like a vice; the beasts are injured, and collapse.

Four youths dead, and the father. The silence of the afternoon, of the desert, falls again on the scene of the tragedy.

Oedipus muses on all he has done as if in a dream.

In the distance the slave is running down the road till he sees a path leading down towards the river, through the green palms. Like a hounded, crazed animal, he reaches a clump of bushes and plunges into them.

Out of sight, he seems protected by the forbidding silence.

No sound, not even a breath of wind, not a single bird singing in that never-ending summer silence.

Behind a shrub, the slave is crouching motionless in the mud, his body racked by a silent sobbing. He twists his head on his shoulders and looks in terror behind him; his eyes are glassy, blind and cunning above his cheek-bones.

Scene 27. The countryside near Thebes. Exterior. Day. (Stills on pages 76-78)

A great crowd is moving forward in silence; some are driving carts, some are on horseback, some on foot. Is this an exodus? Or an emigration?

Carts squeaking in the deep silence, feet scuffling in the dust, and the occasional whimpering of a child.

Then a voice is raised in song; the voice of a woman singing the misery of a people. Her lingering words, followed by the lamentations of a flute, narrate the misery of refugees: people like herself, travelling the road to exile.

The carts swaying along, feet scuffling, the whimpering of children: the road of misery.

Down below the road disappears, merging into an arid plain between rocks and small patches of wheat, in the distant haze of summer. A sea or a lake, or something blueish and dead can be seen, and perhaps the shadowy outlines of a city.

Oedipus is walking in the opposite direction to this emigrating, silent crowd.

He strides on towards the place they are all moving away from, so slowly. He seems to be the victim of some plan yet to be revealed, of some fatal decision to which he is resigned.

And here, at last, is a great clearing, a Thebaid of rocks and mounds, like an archipelago in the blue summer air of death. Here the mass of people is gathered. Obviously only one section of the population has taken the decision to escape. An-

other section is here, outside the city walls, in disorder, in the misery of a refugee camp.

Troops of aimless youngsters wander about. The odd merchant tries to exploit the others' state of confusion, and has set up tents where he is selling food and drink. There are beggars too, as at feasts and around sanctuaries. And there are gangs of youths, roughly the same age as Oedipus, standing apart from the others, as if their youth made them a different and privileged race.

Oedipus goes up to question a teenager who, despite his youth and innocence, has that confident and wide-awake expression of one who is part and parcel of his homeland: of one who reflects its essence in his eyes.

OEDIPUS : *Well son, what's happening? What's going on here? Why are all these people leaving their city, or else camping out here like a tribe of gypsies? Or don't you know?*²⁴⁹

YOUTH : *How come I wouldn't know? He puffs himself up with pride. I'm the local messenger boy — I'm the one who brings the news! It would be nice indeed if I didn't know, now wouldn't it?*²⁵⁰

OEDIPUS : *So?*²⁵¹

YOUTH : *Come with me, come on . . .*⁵²

Obviously the youth has taken an immediate liking to the stranger, or feels respect for him, or at least sees 'something special' in him. Or maybe he's hoping to earn a few coppers; or maybe he's just proud of the fact that he's up with the news, and wants to show him. At any rate, they wend their way right across the camp, till now they are walking along a stretch of deserted road.

Immediately beyond the refugee camp a deep, unnatural silence weighs over the countryside. An abandoned vista greets the eyes: carcasses of animals, farming equipment rusting under the sun, tiny wells disappearing under weeds; houses falling apart, their windows open like eye sockets.

An absurd intrusion into such a place, the sound of a flute is floating through the air.

Oedipus looks into the eyes of the youth: he is watching Oedipus; he knows, but he is silent. They walk on, now seemingly guided by that sound. They come up behind an embankment, which seems to cut off the earth from the sky; before it

lies the expanse of ruined countryside.

The sunlight is the only feature.

But here, squatting between two bushes, is a man.

An old man, flabby, heavy, his face at once infantile and lined with age. But his eyes are not following the mournful, funereal sounds of the flute.

They stay closed and suspended in the air, as if they have been drawn in on his face. He is blind.

Oedipus stares at him, horrified.

Never, throughout the length of his painful journey along the roads traced out by his destiny, has anything affected him so profoundly and so mysteriously as this. Why should this be?

Is this perhaps a new sign his destiny has marked out for him, an allusion to that which awaits his fulfilment of the prophecies? He looks into the eyes of the youth, who stares back at him, murmuring, in a voice filled with holy terror :

YOUTH : *It is Tiresias, the prophet.*⁵³

Oedipus takes one or two steps towards him. Tiresias hears him, and breaks off his plaintive sound.

The two stand facing each other : Oedipus with his boyish eyes, Tiresias with his blindness. All that they have to say to each other is expressed in a long silence. Then Tiresias takes up his flute again. He touches the highest and purest notes ; their pain is the pain of the world.

At the sound of the first measures on Tiresias' flute, Oedipus' eyes are filled with tears. He cannot hold himself back : his whole body is racked by a fit of sobbing, at once horrifying and immensely consoling.

He falls to his knees and listens to that mysterious message, as if it were part of a sacred ritual.

OEDIPUS' INNER VOICE : *He sings, but not about himself. Someone has burdened him with the duty of singing ; he is blind, blind ; someone has burdened him with the duty of seeing ; in these days, in these nights of his city . . . He is singing for others, he is singing about others ; he is singing for me, he is singing about me. He knows all there is to know about me, and his music is referring to this. A poet ! You, a poet with your duty of gathering the pain others feel and expressing it, as if it were the very pain itself expressing itself . . . Destiny goes on beyond the realm of destiny. I am listen-*

ing to what is beyond my destiny.*

The youth comes up to Oedipus and tugs his sleeve, trying to tell him without speaking, as if they were in church, that he must go.

Oedipus looks at him distractedly, as if in a dream. Then he rises, his eyes still full of tears, and follows him.

They walk in silence. Gradually, as they draw away, the sounds of the flute die out.

Now they are walking in a place that is even more mournful and wild. Until they come to the crest of a small rise.

From here they can see the city, and in front of it, in the deserted countryside, the boy points out something totally unexpected, something incredible, beyond all human experience : a beast with a lion's head and a woman's body is squatting motionless on a rock — half asleep perhaps. At least, it seems to have these features, but the distance is great, and they might be dreaming.

YOUTH: *Here is the cause of the misery in our city . . . It just turned up here — no one knows where it came from . . . on this very spot it made its appearance . . . And things were going so well for us. Who would ever have imagined it? It arrived, and ruined everything. It does nothing but sit there, day in, day out. All it asks is questions. But whoever is unable to reply, must die. And until someone comes up with the right answer, it will go on sitting here, asking questions. Our city is ruined. Everyone is leaving, and for those of us left behind, what is there to do?****

Oedipus does not even hear him out, but is already moving towards the Sphinx . . . The youth reluctantly follows him part of the way, tugging at his clothes, trying to persuade him not to sacrifice himself.

YOUTH: *Don't go, don't go, it's useless, you'll be killed⁵⁴ . . . so many others have tried already . . . turn back . . .*

This is the valley of horror. Skeletons everywhere, whitened by the sun.

Here a skull, a yellow sprig of broom growing through its eye socket.

* As will be seen from the cutting continuity, a rather different version of this monologue appears in the film.

** A slightly different version of the dialogue in this sequence is heard in the film.

Here a rib cage, two lizards running between the ribs, mysteriously moving their little heads.

The youth is horrified, and runs back up to the crest of the rise, where he waits and watches.

Down below, Oedipus walks on relentlessly, till he halts in front of the Beast. They appear to be speaking.

Standing motionless before each other.

Minutes pass. Neither makes a move. What could they be saying?

The youth covers his eyes for a moment.

Then gradually he uncovers them, overcome with curiosity, and sees . . .

. . . Oedipus dragging the corpse of the Sphinx by the tail, dragging it laboriously down through the rocks. He has been victorious, and the Sphinx is his trophy.

The youth cannot believe his eyes. He stands there, struck dumb, staring. Then he explodes with joy, and starts dancing and shouting like a madman. He spins round and round, improvising a dance of joy, a tarantella. Shouting and laughing, he waves his arms and hands wildly in the air.

One of the refugees below sees him and becomes curious.

Gradually a small crowd, growing larger all the time, starts moving towards the rise where the youth is dancing for joy.

Until the whole refugee camp comes pouring out towards the spot which was once a scene of death and is now a scene of joy.

Suddenly the youth breaks off his dance and careers down the hillside, rushing off towards the city. The gates have been abandoned by their sentries; he comes up to them and goes in through the red walls surrounding the red crumbling houses, with their squat and intricate battlements.

Meanwhile the crowd has gathered around Oedipus, some staring at him, others at the Sphinx. Once it had been the terror of the city, the living figure of hell, and here it is: a miserable carcase in the dust, as lowly as a butchered beast.

The children are dancing around for joy, just as the messenger was a moment before.

The women are weeping and embracing each other, the men pressing around Oedipus and staring at him: he has become

a hero.

Now a new crowd emerges down below from the city gate, with horses and carts, soldiers, and waving flags. The boy messenger is at the head of the procession, leading it. He runs up and takes Oedipus by the hand, leading him towards the new crowd coming up. In the midst of the uproar, the shouting, the laughing, the music, his voice can hardly make itself heard :

YOUTH : *Come on . . . Come and see Creon . . . and the Queen . . . Didn't you know that whoever killed the Sphinx was supposed to marry the Queen . . .*⁵⁵ *You're going to be King! . . . Come on . . .*⁵⁶

The two crowds cascade together, like twin torrents, so that they form an overwhelming crush. Girls are crowning Oedipus with flowers; some youths lift him up onto their shoulders and carry him off in triumph, towards the city.

And at the very end of the procession is the Queen : Jocasta, the mother of Oedipus. She is being carried in a dazzling litter, screened by precious curtains — the embroideries of Idria.

She appears only briefly : her sweet, cruel face, with its Tartar eyes, and her white breast swelling beneath her white robes. Oedipus, borne shoulder-high in triumph, catches no more than a glimpse of her. No more than a second, but his gaze is *fixed* on her. A fleeting expression of intimacy and lust flickers in his eyes — his eyes magnetized by her white breast. But the movement of the crowd sweeps away that moment of immodest and ingenuously avid contemplation.

Oedipus is placed at the feet of the Queen and Creon. He pays homage to them, kneeling down and kissing their hands. By now, when his eyes meet those of the Queen, he is master of his passions; he looks at her with the hypocritical innocence of respect.

But immediately the people reclaim him — they want their share in the celebrations. They lift him back up onto their shoulders, and carry him off in triumph.

Music playing, flags waving. The whole population of Thebes is milling around its Queen and its new hero. They all move off in the direction of the city gates.

Scene 28. The royal palace of Thebes: bedroom. Interior. Night.

Tonight is like that distant night — belonging almost to another world — of Sacile. The window is open, and beyond the window is the sky and the countryside, with the impetuous, fugitive ringing of the frogs and crickets, and the moon so bright as to appear closer, smoothed by its sultriness. And inside, the newlyweds' chamber; the great bed made up for consecrated love. Its covers, like the embroidered curtains drawn back from the window, glow silver in the moonlight. The lovers are not there, but the bed seems to be waiting for them, as the insects of the summer night seem to be singing for them, and the full moon seems to be shining for them.

*Scene 29. A Theban street. Exterior. Night.**

It is nearly dawn, and the celebrations are coming to an end. But the people are insatiable. They want this night to go on forever. Groups still linger in the streets, in the dusty little squares. Here is someone making music. There a group of girls dancing. And gangs of youths everywhere, as well as old drunks; and fires smouldering in the streets.

The boy-messenger and a few of his friends, all about the same age, are climbing up a fig tree. Their furtive looks make it plain that they are doing something which they shouldn't be doing. From the tree they leap onto a wall, and from there onto a housetop, silently, whispering to each other, their words overflowing with illicit joy.

When they have reached the top, they look across into a house which is bigger and taller than the others: the royal palace. One of them, looking into a window, turns back to the others and makes an innocent but obscene gesture. It is obvious what is going on inside between the foreigner-hero Oedipus and the beautiful Queen.

Scene 30. The royal palace of Thebes: bedroom. Interior. Night. (Stills on page 78)

* As will be seen from the cutting continuity, this scene was altered in the filming.

The two newlyweds come into the peaceful sanctum of their bedroom, its window looking out over the rooftops of Thebes, the countryside and the moon.

First Jocasta, still in her ceremonial robes, and behind her Oedipus, wearing his King's cloak and crown.

They come right in, looking into each other's eyes. They married through the will of the people, but behind this there was their own, spontaneous, virtually shameless desire.

This desire finds its naked reflection in their eyes; the reflection of accomplices. Their love is all of the flesh; it transcends the spirit.

As they undress, their eyes never leave each other. This is the first, gradual discovery of each other's nakedness: the very first moment of intimacy.

Outside, the drowsy summer noises, and the stark moon through the window.

Now Oedipus is naked, in the full assertion of his right as King and husband. He is watching his wife, her head bare, her hair loose, her legs uncovered, but her robe still buckled over her shoulder by a great gold clasp, as long and as sharp as a thorn. She is sitting in this state on the edge of the bed. But her modesty is not that of a trembling virgin. She already knows what it is to give birth. She is a mother. Is this perhaps a false modesty, an extreme an almost brazen coquetry? Or is it rather the gentle, but firm expression of her feminine restraint? There is a look of irony, almost of maliciousness, in Oedipus' eyes: he is ready for love. He approaches her impatiently, and releases the great sharp clasp. Her robe falls about her feet.

Oedipus is poised ready to clutch her in his arms with the same impatience and near-brutality, and lay her out on the bed, when something holds him back.

He withdraws, and studies her, contemplating his mother.

A distant music strikes up in the night, and is just as soon lost; it is the arcane melody of Tiresias' flute, which seems to work within the designs of destiny — and yet, mysteriously, beyond them . . . a mother.

Gently, ever so gently, no longer playing the brutal master, but with a lover's trembling, Oedipus draws close to his mother, and stretches out his body over hers.

Scene 31. In and around Thebes. Exterior. Day. (Still on page 79)

Thebes is plague-ridden; the plague is everywhere like the crazed sun; it spreads death; it provokes screams; it leaves in its wake a void, the plague . . .

Abandoned in the dust, old wheezing men, dead children: Thebes is one vast lazaretto where there is nothing but plague . . .

Plague — in the countryside . . .

Plague — in the deserted centre of the city . . .

Plague — in the dark, shuttered houses . . .

People dying on the roadside, abandoned, loathsome corpses with their eyes open and their pustules rotting, dying people carried in the arms of other dying people, followed by still more dying people, wailing and lamenting . . .

FUNERAL SONGS

Funeral processions along the deserted roads.

Funeral processions without the city walls; every stone a tomb.

Numberless stones shimmering into a burning horizon.

Scene 32. The public square before the royal palace. Exterior. Day. (Stills on pages 79-80)

A small, frightened crowd is advancing towards the royal palace. Leading it are the city's senators and a priest. It inches forward hesitantly; a popular demonstration, coming to petition the King for help.

In their hands they carry olive branches bound in woollen yarn. The crowd is almost exclusively made up of men. They move forward in silence.

The square in front of the palace, where they assemble, is as tiny as a courtyard. They spread out into a circle and look fixedly at the door as they wait for it to open. Meanwhile, through the hushed silence of this gathering of wan faces and suppliants' wands, the sad notes of funeral songs can be heard. The palace gate opens, and Oedipus steps out.

He can no longer be called a young adventurer; a Child of Fortune. Now he is King, in glory and in grief. A full beard sets off his strangely mature face, and the tall crown fitted on his head — as high as a tower — gives a prophetic and occult

grandeur to his royal dignity.

He stands just outside the door, on two or three steps which raise him above the crowd: the public audience rostrum.

From there he looks in troubled silence over his troubled subjects. The senators, the priest,* the humble citizens. Then he speaks:

OEDIPUS: *Speak, I am here to do all in my power.*

PRIEST: *If we, these men and I, have come as suppliants to your threshold,⁵⁷ it is certainly not because we hold you to be god-like. We see you as the first amongst us, in the grief-stricken moments of life, as in those decided by destiny. Was it not you who came to our city and at once liberated us from the nightmare of the Sphinx? And we do not hold that you accomplished this through knowing more than us, but as everyone says, it was through the help of a god that you gave life back to us.⁵⁸ And so Oedipus, our King, we implore you on bended knees:⁵⁹ find us a remedy,⁶⁰ no matter what, through the suggestion of a god, or of a man like us . . . Oedipus, the best of men, give life back to us a second time!⁶¹ Reflect a moment: Thebes calls you saviour for what you accomplished once, but think if your reign should live in our memories as an epoch in which we were at first raised up only to fall back once again . . .⁶²*

OEDIPUS: *These problems that you have raised today . . . my poor wretched citizens . . . have not entirely passed me by. I know only too well how much you all suffer . . . No one, however, suffers more than myself, because your suffering affects one person only, each of you, and no one else: whereas my grief is everyone's; it is my own grief and my grief for you, my people.⁶³*

He looks at the silent assembly: but not everyone looks at him as a suppliant. On the contrary, some, especially the younger ones, are looking at him with an expectant and even a surly expression, as if it were one of their rights, that he should help them. There is a kind of hatred towards him; for though he be the most powerful of men, yet he is unable to offer them any help.

OEDIPUS: *Coming here, you did not rouse me from sleep . . . In fact I was very much awake.⁶⁴ I have been weeping, and turning over in my mind a thousand means of escaping our plight . . .⁶⁵*

* In the film, the role of the spokesman priest is played by Pasolini himself.

There was, it seemed, only one remedy,⁶⁶ and in fact I have already had recourse to it.⁶⁷ I have sent my brother-in-law Creon⁶⁸ to the sanctuary of Apollo, to know directly from the god's lips what must be done.⁶⁹ So be it, and if I have correctly calculated the time that has elapsed since his departure, I have reason by now to be anxious. What is he doing? He is taking longer than I could ever have imagined . . . Why is he not yet here?⁷⁰

The agony of waiting makes its naïve appearance beneath the Kingly brow. No longer a father, but more a frightened son. Dissolve.

*Scene 33. The same place: some time later. Exterior. Day.
(Stills on page 80)*

An hour has passed, or maybe a day, or several days. The sun shines down relentlessly on the same small, perspiring crowd before the royal palace.

As in a nightmare, the funeral chants swell through the surrounding streets.

FUNERAL CHANTS.

The boy-messenger comes running up the main street. He stops in the silence of the square. He looks around uncertainly, then moves towards the priest, not daring to face up to Oedipus, who is looking askance at him from his podium. He whispers in a quavering voice :

YOUTH : *Creon is coming.*⁷¹

The priest, followed by the others, looks down towards the far end of the street, beyond the little square, with its silent and frightened gathering of people.

And in fact a man can be seen approaching. He is walking at a fast and lively pace — he is obviously bringing good news, and waves his arms about in the air, to communicate his feelings . . .

OEDIPUS to himself, his voice tense with naïve anxiety : *Oh God, may he bring us a destiny of salvation.*⁷² *His eyes are shining . . .*

PRIEST : *He seems happy . . . He is crowned with laurel . . .*

OEDIPUS shouting, to make himself heard even at Creon's range : *Creon! Brother-in-law! Comrade! What did the oracle say?*⁷³

Coming closer, Creon shouts back :

CREON : *Good news! . . . Good news!*⁷⁴ . . . *All's well that ends*

*well, even with the most atrocious experiences.*⁷⁵

*OEDIPUS : But the reply! Tell us what it is! That's all we want to know!*⁷⁶

By now Creon has reached the middle of the square, and is standing before Oedipus.

*CREON : Would you like me to announce the reply publicly, here in front of everybody, or would you rather hear it in private, inside the palace?*⁷⁷

*OEDIPUS : No, here in front of everyone. It's for them, more than for my own life, that I endure this torment.*⁷⁸

*CREON : Here is what I heard from the god: the disease that is afflicting Thebes must be thoroughly wiped out; and for this to happen, we must drive out of our city one of our number who is hopelessly afflicted.*⁷⁹

*OEDIPUS : And how, on what charges, with what sentence?*⁸⁰

*CREON : He must expiate with exile, or with death, the murder and bloodshed which is the cause of all that has befallen us.*⁸¹

*OEDIPUS : And who was murdered?*⁸²

*CREON : Before you, Laius ruled over this land . . .*⁸³

*OEDIPUS : I know, I've been told . . . I never met him . . .*⁸⁴

*CREON : He is the victim. And the god wants his murderer to be punished,*⁸⁵ *whoever he may be . . .*⁸⁶

*OEDIPUS : But who is he? How do we go about finding this murderer? Where should we start looking for the clues to a crime committed so long ago?*⁸⁷

Creon rests his eyes on him, he too having been astonished at first by the natural spontaneity of the god's reply.

*CREON : Here, the god said.*⁸⁸

A profound, ambiguous silence falls around the word 'here'.

Abruptly, as if by a miracle, even the funeral chants cease.

*CREON : Here. And he added: that which one seeks to find, exists; while that which one is not seeking does not exist.*⁸⁹

*OEDIPUS : But was Laius murdered in the palace, or out in the open, or in a foreign country?*⁹⁰

*CREON : He too had left for the sanctuary of Apollo.*⁹¹ *And he never came back . . .*⁹²

Oedipus straightens up, his face intense, as though he has been forced to take an important decision in his own mind, and is now beginning to trace the outlines of this design. He cross-

examines :

OEDIPUS : *Was there no guard, no travelling companion, as witness?*⁹³

CREON : *Only one terrified witness was able to escape, and he was able to say just one thing . . .*⁹⁴

OEDIPUS : *What did he say?*⁹⁵ *One thing can point to many,*⁹⁶ *if there is but a glimmer of reality in it.*

CREON : *He said that they were assaulted by bandits, and that a group of them killed him, not just one.*

OEDIPUS : *But what stopped you from investigating the murder of your King? How come you did nothing then to bring the murderer to justice? I don't understand.*

Oedipus is seized with a passion to know and to act. And yet in his enthusiasm there is something forced, something excessive: an arid exaltation. Now shouting rather than speaking, he comes down from the podium and mingles with his subjects.

CREON : *At that time . . . as you know . . . the city was under the spell of the Sphinx's riddles, so how could we have put our minds to other problems?*

OEDIPUS his voice rising : *Then what you people weren't capable of doing, I shall accomplish myself. Starting the investigation over from the very beginning, I will uncover everything, I will avenge at one blow this land and the god; I will leave no stone unturned . . .*

CREON : *There were other rumours circulating at the time . . .*⁹⁷

OEDIPUS : *What rumours? I want to know everything . . .*⁹⁸

CREON : *People said that it wasn't bandits who killed the King, but travellers . . .*

OEDIPUS : *And who could verify that?*⁹⁹

CREON : *The only witness left. Just frighten him a little and he'll talk . . . you'll see.*¹⁰⁰

Dissolve.

*Scene 34. The same place: some time later. Exterior. Day.
(Stills on page 80, 114)*

The same crowd is there. Only Creon is missing.

Even more firmly resolved to know the full facts, Oedipus is now standing on his podium again, at his kingly post. He has mastered his voice — he is no longer shouting, but is speaking

crisply and vibrantly, as though his words are the expression of some implacable will.

OEDIPUS : I shall speak to you as one having no part in this discussion, nor in the event itself, since on my own, with no circumstantial evidence, I shall make little headway with my investigations.

*As your King, I insist that whoever amongst you knows who murdered Laius must speak out, even if you are afraid that by so doing you will bring an accusation against yourself . . .*¹⁰¹

I can . . . I give my word that you will suffer no harm. You will be able to leave the city in safety . . .

But if anyone amongst you possesses information which proves that the murderer is someone else, or a foreigner, you must not keep it to yourself, for you will be compensated, and not only by the gratitude of everyone . . .

If on the other hand one of you has this information and says nothing,¹⁰² either through fear of exposing a friend . . . or of exposing yourself . . . then I must make it clear that I will take harsh measures against you.

I forbid every man in this city which has been placed in my care, and which I govern, to give hospitality to this renegade, to speak to him, to pray or invoke the gods in any way in his company.¹⁰³

I order everyone to close their doors against him, as he is the root cause of all our misfortunes. And as for the guilty party, I can promise him — whether he be in hiding or not, either alone, or with many accomplices — that in his final hours he will experience the most horrific suffering. And if by chance he happened to be here, and I shared my table with him, and if I knew him for what he was, I would wish on myself what I have held out to others.

*You must know that I intend to avenge the death of this King as if he had been my own father . . .*¹⁰⁴

*Now that his power has passed into my hands, along with his possessions, and now that his wife is my wife¹⁰⁵ . . . And perhaps we would also have had some children in common, had he not lost his only son . . .**

But over his last words a strange, remote music comes floating

* In the film, two extra scenes are inserted at this point, before the confrontation between Oedipus and Tiresias.

through the fiery air, its volume growing, so much so that Oedipus is distracted and forced to break off his long, exalted discourse . . .

Everyone in the square is listening intently.

And down at the end of the street where Creon first appeared, through the crush of frightened people, the figure of a grand old man playing a flute comes gradually into focus. He is accompanied by his guide, a high-spirited and thoughtless youth. The man rivets every single person's gaze. All are overwhelmed by the sacred spirit which invests his music : it could be called a song of love. The first senator turns to Oedipus and in a hushed voice, as if in church, or on holy ground, says :*

FIRST SENATOR : *It is Tiresias . . . He has the vision of a god. If you question him, my lord, he will tell you everything you want to know.*

OEDIPUS gloating : *He came because I summoned him here. And I will be told everything.*

Meanwhile Tiresias has come before the King, and has put away his ambiguous flute, that sang too sweetly. He stands there, mute, his blind eyes staring in front of him. Then his voice cuts through the silence :

TIRESIAS : *Ah! How terrible it is to know, when this knowledge is of no use to its bearer!*¹⁰⁶

*And I knew, but had forgotten. Else I had never let myself be brought here.*¹⁰⁷

OEDIPUS : *What is it? Why this shock and horror in your voice?*¹⁰⁸

TIRESIAS : *Let me go home! Heed my words! Our common load will be lighter.*¹⁰⁹

OEDIPUS : *No! You owe it to the city to speak . . .*¹¹⁰

TIRESIAS : *Even in your ears my words will bear no fruit.*¹¹¹ *And so to avoid a similar fate . . .*

OEDIPUS : *Stay where you are, in the name of the god!*¹¹² *You know. We implore you for guidance, all the citizens and myself.*¹¹³

TIRESIAS : *You're mad, all of you.*¹¹⁴ *I'll say nothing. I have no wish to expose your evils . . .*¹¹⁵

* Apart from Creon, none of the various senators have speaking parts in the film.

OEDIPUS : *You know, yet can be silent? You wish to betray us? You wish to lose the city.*¹¹⁶ *Do you have a heart of stone, that you can keep this hostile, stubborn silence?*¹¹⁷

TIRESIAS : *You slander and reproach my character, when you are not aware of the character you carry within yourself.*¹¹⁸

A fit of rage, which has been mysteriously boiling up inside Oedipus right from Tiresias' very first appearance, now explodes, and he screams :

OEDIPUS : *Who could help but be enraged at words which give offence to King and Country!*¹¹⁹

TIRESIAS : *Ah! The facts will speak for themselves, though I say nothing.*¹²⁰

OEDIPUS : *But just for this reason, if for nothing else, you must talk.*¹²¹

TIRESIAS : *I have already said too much. And you can choke on your anger, for all I care.*¹²²

Tiresias' aversion for Oedipus runs deep. His knowledge of the truth is enough. For his is the hatred of light for darkness, of truth for falsehood. And it is this which exasperates Oedipus, who is not aware that he himself is on the side of darkness and of falsehood. And he rails, his reason gone :

OEDIPUS : *So that's your line, is it? Well, would you like me to tell you something which has just struck me as obvious? It was you who planned this murder! And if you weren't blind, I would accuse you of having done the deed yourself, with your very own hands!*¹²³

TIRESIAS : *Is that what you think? Then let me tell you: obey the bands that you promulgated in your own name,*¹²⁴ *and beware of staying here, amongst us; because yours is the guilt*¹²⁵ *that poisons our soil.*¹²⁶

*And in case you didn't understand that, I'll repeat it: you are the very murderer that you are looking for.*¹²⁷

*You are the one. And you are not aware of sharing an infamous relationship*¹²⁸ *with those nearest and dearest to you: you cannot see the evil within you.*¹²⁹

OEDIPUS : *And you think you can utter such words with impunity?*¹³⁰

TIRESIAS : *I am safe. I have truth on my side.*¹³¹

OEDIPUS driving himself into a frenzy : *The truth for anyone else, but not for you. Your eyes are blind, and your ears, as well as your mind!*¹³²

TIRESIAS : *For shame!*¹³³ *You abuse me now but the time is not far off when others will abuse you in exactly the same way.*¹³⁴

In Oedipus' eyes there is a flicker of desperate hope : the diabolical pleasure of a counter-attack which opens the way to victory — the tactics of an animal which fights with teeth and nails.

OEDIPUS : *Tell me, who was responsible for these pretty stories, you or Creon?*¹³⁵ *Wealth, power, majesty — how much envy you arouse within the span of this short life of struggle we endure! Yes, through simple jealousy of the power that was given me by the city — power which I did not ask for*¹³⁶ *— even my faithful Creon, who has always been such a good friend, now wants to overthrow me.*¹³⁷ *Yes, he wants to take my place, using this old sorcerer as his stooge . . . this beggar who can see only when there's gain to be had, but who is blind when it comes to practising his art!*¹³⁸

The people, the senators, have listened in astonishment to this totally unexpected clash : they cannot believe their ears, and look anxiously at each other, like strangers meeting for the first time.

SECOND SENATOR *stuttering, in a low voice : Oedipus and Tiresias, it seems to us that both your words are inspired by anger . . . But anger is not what we need. Rather it's a sober discussion on how best to carry out the demands of the god . . .*

TIRESIAS : *Even if you are King, I can be just as frank with you as you have been with me. I am not responsible to you, but to the god. And since you have seen fit to mock my years and my blindness, I have this to say to you: you have eyes, but you are blind to the evil in your life. You have eyes, but you see neither where nor with whom you live.*¹³⁹ *Do you know who gave birth to you? Do you know that your forbears, those dead and those still on this earth, are cursing you?*¹⁴⁰

*One day, sheer horror will drive you from this place, and darkness will be your only guide.*¹⁴¹

*And you'll howl then, when it finally sinks through to you how and with whom you are married, Child of Fortune!*¹⁴² *Go on, smear the names of Creon and myself with all the filth you can find: no one's fate will be worse than yours.*

Oedipus hurls himself on Tiresias, rattling his frail bones with all the strength he can muster.

OEDIPUS : *Why should I put up with this outspokenness,¹⁴³ why should I?¹⁴⁴ What are you waiting for?¹⁴⁵ Why don't you go? Get out, get out!*¹⁴⁶

TIRESIAS : *I am here because you summoned me.*¹⁴⁷

Oedipus spins him round on the spot, and thrusts him away with a blow on the shoulder.

OEDIPUS : *I'd never have done so, never, if I'd known I was to be subjected to such stupidities!*¹⁴⁸

Tiresias moves away, humiliated by the shake-down he has received at the hands of Oedipus. But as he goes off he turns back to face the King, with the mournful obstinacy of one who sits in judgement.

TIRESIAS : *This is our destiny: you have made us mad, just as she who gave birth to you made us wise . . .*¹⁴⁹

OEDIPUS his rage subsiding to an almost infantile curiosity : *Wait a minute! What did you say? Who gave birth to me?*¹⁵⁰

TIRESIAS : *Come on, let's go. Guide my feet, boy . . .*¹⁵¹

Tiresias leans on his youthful guide, and totters away. Oedipus goes on ranting at his back, raging again after that one moment of ingenuous, desperate curiosity :

OEDIPUS : *Yes, go on, get out. Vanish from these parts.*¹⁵² *And my torment will vanish with you.*¹⁵³

But Tiresias has not yet finished; he stops and turns back one last time.

TIRESIAS : *I shall go,¹⁵⁴ but only when I have told you all I have to tell. Pay heed to my words: that man you are seeking, with threats and proclamations, stands here.*¹⁵⁵

*A foreigner, as is generally believed, — but living here. In fact it will be discovered later that he is from Thebes.*¹⁵⁶ *But this discovery will give him no joy, because it will bring with it blindness and impoverishment, and he will go off to distant lands, a foreigner once more, tapping the ground with a stick.*¹⁵⁷

*It will be discovered that he is at once brother and father of his children.*¹⁵⁸

*That he is at once son and husband of his mother.*¹⁵⁹

*That he is thus united with the woman who was married to his father,¹⁶⁰ and that he alone is the murderer of his father . . .*¹⁶¹

Oedipus hears him out, but his eyes betray the fact that he is not listening. He hears another voice, deep inside him, a dis-

course which unfolds within his soul.

Each new revelation — no matter how terrible, how horrifying — has its own mysterious, joyful vitality.

Oedipus smiles: a timid, monstrous, barely discernible movement of his lips. A smile that mingles elements of shrewdness with elements of idiocy. Deep inside himself he is drunk on truth.

Tiresias turns and walks away.

The smile still playing on his lips, Oedipus goes back inside the palace.

*Scene 35. The royal palace of Thebes: various interiors. Day.
(Still on page 115)*

No sooner is he inside the royal palace than the mask-like, suspended smile falls from Oedipus' face.

An expression of terror takes its place; the intoxication of revelation is over, and all that is left is the nauseous realization — but not yet acceptance — of what has been revealed.

He walks mechanically through the palace.

Here he feels a sense of belonging, of protection.

And in fact it is very peaceful: the peace and wealth of security. Here the reign of terror that prevails over the city is no more than a memory; the palace seems to be an island of refuge in a tempestuous sea.

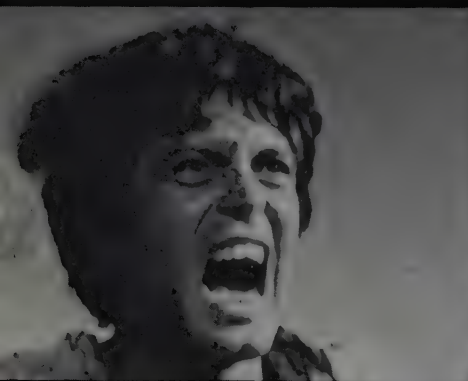
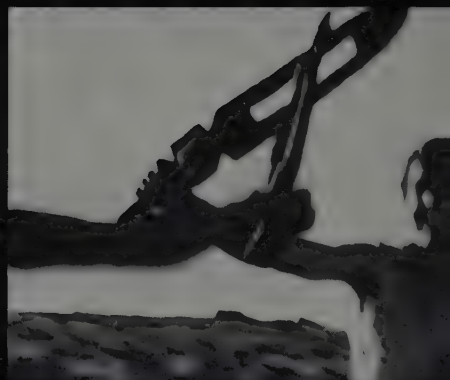
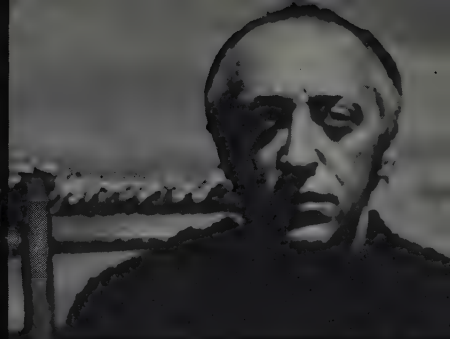
All is gleaming in the luxury, the fragrance of the reassuring shade: the rooms, the interior courtyards and their cloistered tranquility, the gentle splashing of their fountains.

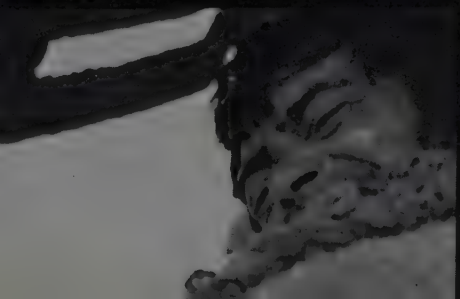
And now a voice raised in song comes drifting across from the royal quarters, a song that is neither sad nor gay, and therefore gay. It relates childish things in childish tones, an ancient, traditional song that comes alive in the fresh, unpolished voice of a young girl.

GIRL'S SONG.

Lured on by that song, Oedipus walks through the palace to the other side, where the women's quarters are. Unseen, in the shadows, he stands and watches. Jocasta is with her maids in a courtyard, whose lines recall the severe harmony of a convent. She is intent on her womanly chores, at her wheel, spinning. The girls stand around her, quietly helping. With one

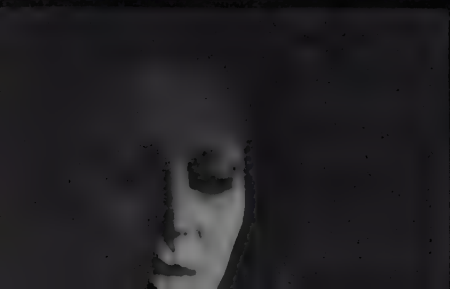




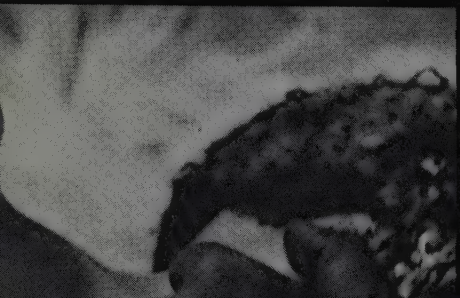












exception: the girl who is singing.

Oedipus gazes at his wife. But who is she, and what is her relationship to him? By now he must know, or if not, then he must at least have heard the words: Tiresias was more than enlightening. Even if he has closed his mind against it, yet something must have penetrated his unwillingness. Tiresias' words were clear, though spoken in anger: the word 'mother', at least, was mentioned. Can Oedipus not help but see his woman now with different eyes?

In her sweetness, in her white veils which blur her features, she moves about her womanly . . . her matronly . . . her maternal work: yes, maternal. Her every feature belongs to a mother; her gestures, her white but no longer fresh and youthful skin, and finally that mature negligence of hers in leaving her blouse unbuttoned . . . Oedipus, when his eyes light on her naked breasts, cannot contain himself, and strides over to her, silent, distraught, unrecognizable, like a hunter about to seize his prey . . . The maid's song dies in mid-air.

Scene 36. The royal palace: bedroom. Interior. Day.

The bed, in daylight: the great bed that used to belong to Oedipus' mother and father.

This is a quiet hour of the day: the mute suffering of the city weighs heavily in the palace air.

Oedipus and Jocasta come silently into their room.

Jocasta is dazed; she says nothing.

Oedipus is mauling her, even before they are through the door: his violence is brutal and unexpected. It smacks of rape, and of the wild intoxication of accomplishing this act which is both degrading, and at the same time the most beautiful and vital act in the world.

He starts tearing off her clothes. But the cursed clasp remains obstinately pinned over her bosom. He forces it open, at the cost of jabbing his hand with the dagger-length pin. He bleeds, and licks his wound.

But now, instead of possessing her at once, he draws back, his eyes burning as they feed on her.

It is a timeless contemplation, one which violates and crushes both of them, an exultant shame, a sacrilegious meditation.

His eyes satiated, Oedipus twists his face into a smile — a snarling, disfiguring, sinister curl of the lips. His face turns crude and vulgar, full of a bestial exultation. Then he leaps upon her, murderous and tormenting.

Scene 37. The atrium of the royal palace. Interior-exterior. Day. (Stills on page 115)

This is the public sector of the palace : it is not meant for the principal popular audiences — as in the preceding scene — but for the meetings of ministers, princes and senators.

The equivocal atmosphere of tragedy still hangs heavily over this palace courtyard, as over the rest of the city.

Creon is already up, mingling with the elders; they speak in hushed tones, as though taking part in a conspiracy, or in some secret council.

Nothing, not even the person and expression of Creon himself, demonstrates whether he is being sincere or insincere, whether he loves the truth or not.

CREON : *I know that Oedipus has brought very grave accusations against me — I'm well aware of this. But the accusations are unacceptable — this is what brings me here. If Oedipus is truly convinced that I have acted in defiance of him, I must defend myself: I have no wish to live under a defamatory cloud of suspicion . . .*

OLD MAN : *But it was in a heated moment that you were accused, there's no need to get upset . . .*

CREON : *But did Oedipus know, or did he not know, what he was saying?*

OLD MAN reticent, perhaps through cowardice : *I don't know. I never see what people do, if they are above me . . .**

Oedipus' entry breaks up the debate. The silence is tense and awkward.

Oedipus is strangely sure of himself, manifestly a King.

But his aggressive confidence is not so much that of an imminent victor, as of someone who desperately does not want to lose.

OEDIPUS sly and nasty : *Ah! Look who's here! What have you come for? What audacity, to show yourself in my home again,*

* None of this preceding dialogue takes place in the film.

*when it's clear as daylight that you want to get rid of me and take over my kingdom! You've come, I suppose, because you think I'm just a coward, or a madman.*¹⁶²

*What are you hoping to get? The people and the power are all on my side: you have nothing to bolster up your claim.*¹⁶³

CREON: *All right, you've had your say, now let me speak . . .*

OEDIPUS: *You don't want to tell me you're innocent, that you have no subversive intentions towards me . . .*¹⁶⁴

CREON: *Subversive intentions? Can you produce a single action of mine that would give you just cause for complaint?*

OEDIPUS: *Wasn't it you who persuaded me to question Tiresias?*¹⁶⁵

CREON: *Yes, I did. And what's more I'm convinced I did the right thing.*

OEDIPUS: *How long is it since Laius . . .*¹⁶⁶

CREON: *Laius.*¹⁶⁷

OEDIPUS: *. . . since the murdered Laius disappeared without leaving a trace.*¹⁶⁸

CREON: *It's a long time now.*¹⁶⁹

OEDIPUS: *And in those days, wasn't Tiresias a prophet?*¹⁷⁰

CREON: *Yes, and he enjoyed universal respect, as he does today.*¹⁷¹

OEDIPUS: *And did he ever allude to me, by chance, in his prophecies?*¹⁷²

CREON: *In my presence, at least, he never did.*¹⁷³

OEDIPUS: *So . . . and when Laius . . . your King . . . was murdered . . . you made no investigations.*¹⁷⁴

CREON: *Of course we did. But they led nowhere.*¹⁷⁵

OEDIPUS: *And why was Tiresias silent on this matter then?*¹⁷⁶

CREON: *I don't know . . .*¹⁷⁷

Oedipus, gloating over his miserable victory, starts shouting and raging:

OEDIPUS: *Ah, you don't know!*¹⁷⁸ *And would you know if I asked you if the two of you were in this together, since Tiresias is going around saying that I am the murderer we're looking for?*¹⁷⁹

Now Creon loses his temper as well; but his anger has a mysterious quality about it, as does everything concerning

Creon: it is never really clear who he is, nor what he wants.

CREON: *Now you answer me.*¹⁸⁰ *is it true that your wife is my sister?*¹⁸¹

OEDIPUS screaming: *Yes, of course she is!*¹⁸²

CREON: *And is it true perhaps that you and she have equal rights to power?*¹⁸³

OEDIPUS still screaming: *Of course we share the power!*¹⁸⁴

CREON: *And am I not your equal, by your side?*¹⁸⁵ *What do I lack? No, no, the last thing I want is to be sovereign;*¹⁸⁶ *it suffices me to live a sovereign's life, as it would anyone with a minimum of sense.*¹⁸⁷ *Am I not supplied with all I could desire? And this without any effort on my part,*¹⁸⁸ *without any worry. If I were King, on the other hand,*¹⁸⁹ *how many things would I have to do against my will; what sort of life would I have, full of responsibilities and anxiety? . . . No, no, treason is the same thing as madness;*¹⁹⁰ *and I am not mad. I haven't set my heart on a way of life which is no better than the one I enjoy. Travel to the sanctuary of Apollo yourself: check with your own ears whether the oracle I brought back with me was true*¹⁹¹ *or whether I made it all up, in collaboration with Tiresias. If I did make it up, then condemn me to death; you would have every reason . . .*¹⁹²

SENATOR: *It seems to me that what he is saying makes sense . . . I should listen to him, Oedipus.*

OEDIPUS: *Makes sense? But I have to make sense too! And that will only be when I have succeeded in frustrating his plans and carrying mine through to victory!*

CREON: *What do you intend doing? Are you going to exile me?*

OEDIPUS: *No, your sentence will not be exile, but death.*¹⁹³

SENATOR: *My lords, that's enough, you mustn't say these things . . . no more, no more . . .*

At this the assembly becomes chaotic: events career out of control, but no one is yet aware of it, and above all no one is able to accept it. Some of the citizens are shouting and others stand there tight-lipped. Oedipus and Creon can be heard quarreling at the tops of their voices over the babble of the senators talking amongst themselves, seeking a way to mediate, to intervene in the dispute . . .

CREON off: *Condemn me if you must, but make the reasons for your hatred public! The real reasons!*¹⁹⁴

OEDIPUS off: *The reasons are that you can't stand being inferior to me!*¹⁹⁵

CREON off: *That's not true! It's not true!*¹⁹⁶

OEDIPUS off: *You lie!*¹⁹⁷

CREON off: *But you won't even try to understand me!*¹⁹⁸

OEDIPUS exasperated and childish: *You're the one who won't give in!*¹⁹⁹

Into this shouting match, this wave of dissension rippling through the group of senators, comes Jocasta; she looks around, seeking to size up the situation, then says nothing.*

CREON off: *I will not give in to your insane orders . . .*²⁰⁰

OEDIPUS off, nearly in tears: *Oh Thebes! Oh Thebes!*²⁰¹

CREON off: *I'm Theban too . . . you're not the only one!*²⁰²

Jocasta intervenes without warning, strangely detached and calm, as one who will not allow herself to become involved. Rather she seems intent on *wiping away all knowledge* of the reality of the event.

JOCASTA: *What's going on here? Why this quarrel — what's behind it? For shame! The city is in a woeful state, and all you can do is foment arguments over your personal grievances! Oedipus, if you don't come back with me to the palace, and if you don't go home, Creon, this minor incident will blow up into a tragedy . . .*

And firmly and sweetly, with the infectious calm of one who would prefer not to know, she goes and takes Oedipus by the hand. He submits at once, and allows himself to be led off like a little boy.

The senators walk a part of the way behind them, as if to profit by this concession on the part of Oedipus, to guide his steps more surely towards a peaceful solution.

SENATOR: *Be reasonable, Oedipus; give in on this point . . .*

ANOTHER SENATOR: *Show some respect for someone who has sworn his sincerity . . .*

THIRD SENATOR: *You can't dishonour a friend with a vague and unfounded accusation . . . not when he has committed himself on oath . . .*

SENATOR: *Let's not add new evils to the old . . .*

Oedipus is now standing on his doorstep; holding tightly onto his mother's hand, he turns towards the senators. His face has changed: it is now mild and bewildered.

OEDIPUS: *Let it be then. I do it not for his sake, but for yours. And thus I condemn myself . . .*²⁰³

* In the film, Jocasta remains in the royal bedchamber throughout this scene.

CREON: *You yield, but with bitterness. Why Oedipus, why?*²⁰⁴

Oedipus whips himself up into one last desperate fury.

OEDIPUS screaming: *Get out! Leave me alone! What are you waiting for? Just go, go!*²⁰⁵

And, together with Jocasta, he disappears inside his private dwelling, without another look back.

Creon turns on his heels and goes off in the opposite direction, in silence, towards the city.

*Scene 38. The palace interior leading to the nuptial chamber. Day.**

Hand in hand, Jocasta and Oedipus — Oedipus allowing himself to be led — walk mutely through the rooms of their palace.

A distant funeral chant comes drifting into the palace, filling the silent void between them.

BARELY PERCEPTIBLE FUNERAL CHANT.

The two walk on, with the faint strains of the death chant lingering in the air.

No words pass between them.

When they reach the courtyard — where a short time before Jocasta was at work spinning with her maids — they both become aware, through a momentary marriage of minds, that they are walking hand in hand.

Close-up of their eyes on their tightly clasped hands.

Close-up of their hands unclasping.

And so mother and son walk on, ever more desolate and alone, towards their bedroom. They seem compelled by habit, or by instinct, to seek out a refuge from the intrusive world.

*Scene 39. The bedroom. Interior. Day.** (Stills on page 116)*

They come into the bedroom and a frigid silence engulfs them. Jocasta sits on the edge of the bed. Oedipus turns his back on her, and looks out through the great window over the rooftops of the city.

* This scene was not included in the final version of the film. The shots of Jocasta and Oedipus hand-in-hand are transferred to the following scene in the garden.

** In the film, this scene begins in the palace garden.

The funeral lament drifts into the room : a little sharper now, though still infinitely remote.

JOCASTA : *Why . . . why were you and Creon . . .*²⁰⁶

Oedipus turns round violently.

OEDIPUS : *Because your brother Creon accuses me of being the murderer of Laius, that's why . . .*²⁰⁷

JOCASTA : *But he . . . accuses you of this . . . on his own initiative or through someone else's suggestion?*²⁰⁸

OEDIPUS : *No, he brought Tiresias before me . . . Tiresias is the one who laid the accusation . . . He proclaims he is innocent . . .*²⁰⁹

The fury of a few moments past is spent, and now Oedipus is speaking out of need; he is almost begging for help. Jocasta replies in a low voice, as befits the ritual of tragedies.

JOCASTA : *If that is all . . . then there is no need to worry . . . On this earth, no one can play the prophet, no one! Listen to me, and tell me whether I'm right or not! Once it was prophesied to my husband, King Laius, that he would be murdered by the son born to him and myself . . . But instead, he was killed by a band of outlaws, not by his son, at some point along a narrow stretch of road cut into a gorge above a river*²¹⁰ . . . *I should tell you that Laius had ordered his child, our son, to be taken away; his feet were tied, and he was thrown amongst the crags of an inaccessible mountain, where he died*²¹¹ . . . *So, you can judge for yourself how successful prophecies are in predicting the future!*²¹² *Believe me, there's no need to worry, Oedipus. If God wishes to reveal his intentions, he does so, without equivocation and without intermediaries!*²¹³

Jocasta's words have had a devastating effect on Oedipus; he looks at her now with terror painted on his face.

OEDIPUS : *On the contrary, if only you knew the anguish, the fear, that your words arouse in me . . .*²¹⁴

JOCASTA now horrified in her turn : *What are you saying? What have you to be afraid of?*

OEDIPUS : *Laius was killed . . . you said . . . along a road cut into a ravine above a river . . .*²¹⁵

JOCASTA : *Yes, so they say . . .*²¹⁶

OEDIPUS : *And where is this place?*²¹⁷

JOCASTA : *Somewhere on the road between here and the sanctuary of Apollo.*²¹⁸

OEDIPUS : *And exactly how long ago was it?*²¹⁹

JOCASTA : *The news of his murder reached us . . . just before you got here . . .*²²⁰

Now the terror in Oedipus' eyes is as naked as a child's. He is silent, then burys his face in his hands.

OEDIPUS : *God! What are you doing to me!*²²¹

And his words seem to resound and echo endlessly in the long and anguished silence which follows them.

JOCASTA : *I don't see . . . why you should be so interested in these things . . .*²²²

OEDIPUS : *Ah please, I beg you, don't ask me any questions. What did Laius look like then? How old was he?*²²³

JOCASTA : *He was tall, with long white hair. His features weren't very different from yours.*²²⁴

Another long silence at this new stroke of destiny. Then a grotesque smile spreads across Oedipus' face, and he takes up the dialogue again.

OEDIPUS : *Then maybe it's true. In the beginning I was heaping curses on myself . . .*²²⁵

JOCASTA : *What are you saying? And why this grim expression on your face . . .? It frightens me just to look at you . . .*

OEDIPUS : *I'm stricken with fear too . . . with the crazy fear that Tiresias might really have foretold the truth . . .*

*But tell me . . . Did your husband Laius travel modestly or with a large escort?*²²⁶

JOCASTA : *He had five men with him, four soldiers and a slave, and they had only one carriage . . .*²²⁷

OEDIPUS : *And who brought back all this information?*²²⁸

JOCASTA : *The slave, the only survivor . . .*²²⁹

OEDIPUS nearly shouting : *And is this slave still here, in the palace?*²³⁰

JOCASTA : *No, when he came back and saw you had taken Laius' place, he begged me to send him out into the country to graze our flocks as far away from Thebes as possible. I granted him his wish, because he was a faithful slave; he deserved much more . . .*²³¹

OEDIPUS : *Could you get him here, at once . . .*

JOCASTA : *Of course, but why do you want to see him?*

OEDIPUS : *Don't ask me . . . I've already said too much*²³² . . .
And even that I said unwillingly, unconsciously . . .

And indeed he intones these last obscure words 'unwillingly' as if in a dream.

Jocasta is meanwhile wilting under his penetrating gaze : he is caressing her with a look of love that is no longer love, but still desperately longs to be so.

He gazes at her features : her face, sweet and joyful; her eyes, long, regal and barbarous; her throat; her white swelling bosom . . . the clasp, catching up her white robe across her breasts . . .

He draws near, and takes her by the hand. Is it to ask her for help? Is it to cling to her for refuge?

But this gesture quickly turns into another.

He lets go her hand, and takes her in his arms, crushing her against him and kissing her hard on the mouth.

But the embrace and the kiss dissolve, unfulfilled, of their own accord.

She is still in his arms. His mouth pressed to hers, Oedipus suddenly finds words again :*

OEDIPUS : *My father is Polybus, King of Corinth . . . and my mother Merope . . . Yet one day . . . a childhood friend of mine felt slighted . . . and called me . . . an adopted child . . . I couldn't rest, and had to ask my parents what this meant. They were most indignant that the boy should insult me like that, and I believed in their sincerity implicitly . . .*²³³

He gives Jocasta another kiss, mechanical and unconscious, then resumes his narrative :

OEDIPUS : *But deep inside me there was a lingering doubt . . . something which I couldn't bring to the surface . . .*²³⁴ *I decided to go to the sanctuary of Apollo . . . but not only did the god . . . not answer my questions . . . but he went on to reveal even more horrifying things. He told me . . . that I was destined to make love to my mother*²³⁵ *. . . And that I was to have monstrous children by her . . . He told me that I was destined also to murder my father . . . Against such prophecies, who would have dared to go back to Corinth?*²³⁶

He is hugging Jocasta in his arms once more : this time he

* As will be seen from the cutting continuity, the tone of this following exchange is very different in the film.

doesn't kiss her, but buries his face in desperation in the hollow of her neck.

And staring into space, he forces himself to go on:

OEDIPUS: . . . *I wandered at random away from Corinth . . . and . . . along a road cut into the side of a gorge above a river . . . I met a man in a carriage, with an escort of four soldiers and a slave*²³⁷ . . . *A quarrel broke out between us . . . I killed the guards, then I killed the man: he had insulted me with his arrogance, with his determination to force me aside . . . Now, if there were any affinity between that man and Laius . . . I've . . .*²³⁸

JOCASTA interrupting him: *Your story fills me with foreboding, Oedipus. But we still have one man's evidence to hear, and his will be decisive. You must wait, and have faith . . .*

OEDIPUS drawing back a moment from her: *It's the only thread of hope I have left . . . This slave who must know . . . who said that outlaws murdered the king . . . Ah! If only he'll repeat this version, my innocence would be confirmed . . .*

An end to the nightmare is in sight. And in the new impetus given him by this absurd hope, Oedipus lovingly worms his arms around Jocasta once again. His hand, through force of habit, moves up to the clasp which catches her robe across her shoulders. But just as mechanically, through a new and much more powerful instinct, Jocasta slips her hand up to check Oedipus, edging his hand gently off the clasp.

The two of them pause, watching each other.

Their eyes flicker a moment, inexpressive.

Then Jocasta backs away, and hastens off. She almost breaks into a run . . .*

Scene 40. The atrium of the royal palace. Exterior-interior. Day. (Stills on page 116)

The senators and ministers are still in session, gathered together in this hour of crisis for the city. They are talking to each other in shocked, anxious tones.

The sudden arrival of Jocasta, and her fugitive appearance, spread confusion through the ranks of the venerable leaders of the city; they gape obtusely, before coming out to meet her.

* Again, the conclusion to this scene is very different in the film.

JOCASTA: *I am on my way to pray*²³⁹ . . . *I'm going to the temples to pray to the gods . . . Oedipus' soul is brimming with anguish . . . He can no longer cope with the new through an understanding of the old, as is rational,*²⁴⁰ *but lets his speech wander . . . He acts on random judgements, no matter how terrible they might be . . .*²⁴¹ *I am going to pray for us all, because it gnaws at the hearts of all of us to see our good counsellor becoming crazed with terror . . .*²⁴²

But at this point the soldiers and slaves push forward a very old man — a slave from Corinth. He is hunch-backed and silver-haired, and trembling with age, but his eyes are bright, and sharp as pins.

OLD MESSENGER: *I've come here, to your city, because I have something to tell Oedipus*²⁴³ *the King.*²⁴⁴

JOCASTA: *I am his wife. What can we do for you; what do you have to say to us?*²⁴⁵

OLD MESSENGER: *I bring good news, for yourself, and for your house . . .*²⁴⁶

JOCASTA: *Tell us. And in whose name were you sent here?*²⁴⁷

OLD MESSENGER: *I come from Corinth. I bear tidings which will bring you joy, and perhaps also cause you pain.*²⁴⁸

JOCASTA: *Go on, speak . . .*²⁴⁹

OLD MESSENGER: *The citizens of Corinth*²⁵⁰ *plan to elect Oedipus as their king.*²⁵¹

JOCASTA: *Why? Is not Oedipus' father, the venerable Polybus, king of Corinth?*²⁵²

OLD MESSENGER: *He was.*²⁵³ *But now he is dead, and already in his grave . . .*²⁵⁴

Dissolve.

*Scene 41. The same place: a little later. Exterior-interior. Day.**

A royal audience is in session. Oedipus is wearing his tall crown on his head, and stands erect in his regal dignity. In his face is expressed a profound and very real sorrow.

OEDIPUS: *How did my father die? Was he assassinated, through*

* This scene does not appear in the film. It is only at this point that Pasolini's script mentions that the old messenger is in fact the shepherd of Corinth; in the cutting continuity he is, however, referred to as the shepherd throughout.

treason, or did he pass away naturally, through some disease?

OLD MESSENGER: *You know, your father was very, very old. It doesn't take that much to kill an old man.* . . .

Oedipus ponders on this; his sorrow at hearing that his father is dead, a genuine sorrow, is the pretext for his long silence. Then when he opens his mouth again, he seems to be speaking almost to himself:

OEDIPUS: *What use are prophecies? You were right, Jocasta. It was prophesied that I would kill my father; yet he is already dead, and lain to rest in his tomb . . . So long as he did not die from the pain of our lengthy separation . . . I could not possibly be the agent of his death . . .*

Jocasta draws close to him, and presses his hand in hers. In that moment, he would seem almost to have triumphed over destiny.

JOCASTA: *You see? Don't think any more on these atrocities which have obsessed you these last few days . . .*

OEDIPUS: *Yes, but there is one thing more which terrifies me . . . The idea of making love to my mother . . . This still horrifies me . . .*

JOCASTA: *But why? Why? We are at the mercy of fate, and no one can ever foresee what is going to happen next! The wisest course is to pin our faith in fortune, and live as we can . . . And why does the idea of making love to your mother hold such terror for you? Why? Think how many men must have made love to their mothers in their dreams!*

These words drip into the silent assembly as a revelation. The councillors look with shocked expressions at Jocasta and Oedipus; but there are some amongst them who are smiling: a faint, derisive smile born of the realization that here is something very much out of the ordinary, a scandal in fact.

JOCASTA: *Who has not dreamt of making love to his mother? And does he live in horror of his dream? Of course not, unless he wants to clutter his life with useless suffering.*

OEDIPUS: *Your words would speak wisdom if my mother were dead, but she is still alive. And I am afraid, I cannot help but be afraid, even if I know that what you say is true.*

JOCASTA: *Meanwhile your father's tomb is an eye open on the world!*

OEDIPUS : *Yes, wide open! But I am afraid of the mother who is living . . .*

At this point the bright-eyed old man intervenes.

OLD MESSENGER : *What is there about her which could frighten you? Unburden yourself of this fear, cast it away . . . And what's more I can tell you why . . .*

OEDIPUS : *What are you saying, old man? What reasons do you have?*

OLD MESSENGER : *Polybus wasn't your true father . . .*

OEDIPUS : *Are you crazy? What do you mean?*

OLD MESSENGER : *Polybus was no more your father than I could have been!*

OEDIPUS shouting : *You're a nothing, a nobody! He must have been my father!*

OLD MESSENGER : *No, neither of us was responsible for your birth . . .*

OEDIPUS still shouting, desperate, child-like : *Then why did he call me his son?*

OLD MESSENGER : *I brought you to him myself, when you were just a babe . . .*

OEDIPUS : *You did? Then how come he loved me so much?*

OLD MESSENGER : *He was childless, that's why he loved you!*

OEDIPUS : *And did you . . . buy me, or come across me by chance?*

OLD MESSENGER : *I found you up on Mount Cithaeron . . . I was grazing Polybus' flocks . . .*

OEDIPUS : *And I was in a state of shock . . . on the point of dying . . .*

OLD MESSENGER : *Your little feet were cut to ribbons by a length of rope . . .*

OEDIPUS : *Ah! You bring back the pain, the long-forgotten pain . . .*

OLD MESSENGER : *Yes, that was why you had the nick-name 'Swollen Feet' as a child, don't you remember?*

OEDIPUS : *I wasn't out of swaddling clothes before I first experienced shame. But who had carried me up there, my father or mother, do you know?*

OLD MESSENGER : *No, it was another shepherd . . .*

OEDIPUS : *And who was it?*

OLD MESSENGER : *He was one of Laius' slaves . . .*

OEDIPUS : *Is he still alive?*

OLD MESSENGER : *I don't know . . .*

OEDIPUS : *Does anyone here know? The time has come when no stone must be left unturned!*

Oedipus is in a state of exultation : the people around him are infected by his enthusiasm, his desperate pursuit of the truth, and try to help him.

SENATOR : *I think it was the same slave you sent out a summons for . . . The witness to the murder of Laius . . . But Jocasta must know better than ourselves . . .*

JOCASTA : *But no, no, what are you trying to unearth? You're letting your words run away with you . . . Don't think about these things Oedipus, you're wasting your time! It's much better, a thousand times better, to know nothing of these things . . .*

OEDIPUS : *You're wrong! All I want to know, when all is said and done, is just who I am!*

JOCASTA : *In the name of the god, don't try to find out . . . if you love life, that is. My pain and sorrow are enough . . .*

OEDIPUS : *You're afraid perhaps that I will turn out to be a child of humble origins? Then have no fear: your nobility is above contamination!*

JOCASTA : *Don't go through with these investigations, Oedipus! I beg you, listen to me!*

OEDIPUS : *I cannot. I must know the truth.*

JOCASTA : *Poor Oedipus! May you never solve the riddle of your birth!*

Tight-lipped, Jocasta leaves the atrium. Her steps are not hurried, but firm and resolute; she is obeying a need so profound that it has almost become a joy.

SENATOR : *Where is Jocasta going? Follow her Oedipus, stay close to her; ask her why she is acting like this; ask her what this immense sorrow is that it should suddenly drive her from amongst us.*

OEDIPUS : *I don't care. The time has come when I must find out who gave me life. Maybe she is ashamed, now, of my humble foundling origins. Yes, I am a Child of Fortune! She is my mother! I feel no dishonour in that. In my life I have known suffering and joy, and I have laughed and wept — and she, Fortune, was my mother! And if it was thus that I came into the world, and how could it be otherwise, then why should I not search after the truth*

to the bitter end?

Dissolve.

Scene 42. A square in front of the royal palace. Exterior. Day. (Stills on page 117)*

Again the citizens are gathered before the royal palace.

In the centre, standing beside the messenger boy who brought him there, is the old slave — the one who carried Oedipus as a child up onto Mount Cithaeron — the witness to Laius' murder. He too is bent with years: but he is trembling not so much with age, as with fear.

Opposite him is the old Corinthian slave. The two veterans look at each other, in silent recognition. In their eyes is the strange, mysterious look of men who have survived the machinations of fate.

Oedipus is present too, standing at the top of the flight of steps leading to the palace door: his usual post for granting audiences. He is still wearing the enormous crown on his head. His eyes rest on the old Corinthian messenger.

Beyond the interweaving of these three enigmatic glances are other gazes in others' eyes: anxious, detached, hostile and even smiling — a smile which opens the way to diversity and revelation, a laugh at once childish and brimming with an uncontainable love of irony.

OEDIPUS: *Is this the man you spoke of?*²⁵⁵

OLD MESSENGER: *Yes, he's the one.*²⁵⁶

OEDIPUS: *So now it's your turn, old man. Look at me and answer my questions! You were once a slave of Laius?*²⁵⁷

OLD SLAVE: *Yes.*²⁵⁸

OEDIPUS: *And what did you do?*²⁵⁹

OLD SLAVE: *I was a shepherd . . .*²⁶⁰

OEDIPUS: *And where did you graze your flocks?*²⁶¹

OLD SLAVE: *I took them up on the slopes of Mount Cithaeron, or thereabouts . . .*²⁶²²⁶³

OEDIPUS: *Did you ever meet this man up there?*²⁶⁴

OLD SLAVE: *Doing what? And which man do you mean?*²⁶⁵

OEDIPUS: *This man here. Don't you recognize him?*²⁶⁶

* In the film, this scene takes place in the countryside near Thebes.

OLD SLAVE : *I'm trying to cast my mind back . . . But it seems to me I've never seen him in my life . . . no . . .*²⁶⁷

OLD MESSENGER : *Of course he wouldn't remember. It was such a long time ago! And yet we spent three seasons together up there on Cithaeron, he with his flock and I with mine . . . from the spring through to the beginning of autumn . . . Three seasons . . .*²⁶⁸

OLD SLAVE : *Yes, perhaps that's so . . . But it was a long, long time ago!*²⁶⁹

OLD MESSENGER : *Don't you remember then, the day I found a child up on the mountain? You were the only one there . . .*²⁷⁰

OLD SLAVE : *What? What are you talking about? Why should you ask me that?*²⁷¹

OLD MESSENGER : *Oedipus, your King, was that very child!*²⁷²

OLD SLAVE : *That's enough . . . I don't want to hear any more of your crazy ideas.*²⁷³

OEDIPUS succumbing to one of his fits of rage : *No, they're not crazy at all — you're the one who's crazy! Take care what you say!*²⁷⁴

OLD SLAVE : *Why, my Lord, what have I done that you should speak to me like this . . .*²⁷⁵

OEDIPUS : *You've concealed the truth . . . We want you to tell us about this child . . .*²⁷⁶

OLD SLAVE : *But I know nothing about it, nothing . . . What can I say?*²⁷⁷

Oedipus snarls in anger at this, and comes right up to the slave as though he would like to kill him there and then. But he restrains himself, and instead screams into the old man's face :

OEDIPUS : *Maybe you'll know what to say under torture . . . I'm giving you fair warning! . . .*²⁷⁸

OLD SLAVE : *But I'm just an old man, a poor old man . . .*²⁷⁹

OEDIPUS : *Take him away! Throw him in chains! Have done with the wretch!*²⁸⁰

OLD SLAVE surrendering, in a state of terror : *But what do you want to know?*²⁸¹

OEDIPUS : *Did you or did you not carry the child in question up onto the mountain?*²⁸²

OLD SLAVE : *Yes, I did, and I wish it had died straight away . . .*²⁸³

OEDIPUS : *And who gave you this child? Was it or was it not your own son?*²⁸⁴

OLD SLAVE: *It wasn't mine . . . it was given to me by . . . other people . . .*²⁸⁵

OEDIPUS: *And these others . . . who were they?*²⁸⁶

OLD SLAVE: *In the name of the god, don't ask me any more.*²⁸⁷

OEDIPUS screaming again: *Speak, old man, or I'll have you done away with on the spot!*²⁸⁸

OLD SLAVE: *The child belonged to Laius . . .*²⁸⁹

OEDIPUS: *Was it his slave, or his own son? Was it born of his seed?*²⁹⁰

OLD SLAVE: *Ah, this is the question that I cannot bring myself to answer!*²⁹¹

OEDIPUS: *And how can I bring myself to listen? But I must, I must!*²⁹²

OLD SLAVE: *The child was his own. But no one knows this better than your wife Jocasta,*²⁹³ *who has just gone back into the palace . . .*

OEDIPUS: *She gave you the child?*²⁹⁴

OLD SLAVE: *Yes, she gave it to me.*²⁹⁵

OEDIPUS: *And with what orders?*²⁹⁶

OLD SLAVE: *To kill it.*²⁹⁷

OEDIPUS: *And the reason for this atrocity?*²⁹⁸

OLD SLAVE: *She was afraid of evil prophecies . . .*²⁹⁹

OEDIPUS: *Which were?* . . .³⁰⁰

OLD SLAVE: . . . *That the child was destined to kill its parents . . .*³⁰¹

OEDIPUS: *And why did you let this old man save its life?*³⁰²

OLD SLAVE: *Out of pity.*³⁰³

OEDIPUS in a whisper: *At last! Now the truth is out.*

Still ruminating on these revelations, seemingly distracted, unaware of what he is doing or saying, Oedipus turns and follows Jocasta inside, making for his private quarters:

OEDIPUS stammering to himself, as in a dream: *Now it all fits together . . . It was willed, but not imposed, by destiny.*³⁰⁴

*Scene 43. Palace interiors. Day.**

Again, Oedipus wanders through the rooms of his palace, meditating as he makes his way towards the bedroom.

He walks as if in a dream — abstracted, slow, and mysteriously calm.

* This scene is not included in the film. Instead two scenes are inserted, the first of Jocasta in the garden just before her suicide, the second of Oedipus returning to the palace after his interview with the slave.

The truth has stunned him; he has not yet recovered, nor even felt any pain. He is no longer himself: amnesia is guiding his feet. Indeed, he looks about him as though he does not recognize his surroundings.

And so, mechanically he goes into the bedroom.

Scene 44. The bedroom. Interior. Day. (Stills on page 118)

No sooner has Oedipus crossed the threshold, than his eyes light on . . .

. . . the dangling body of Jocasta strung from a beam across the ceiling.

Like a wounded beast, Oedipus hurls himself on her body, clutching it to him, as though making a last desperate bid to save her. This horrific vision has jolted him out of his trance, and the violence of his gestures brings back the sensation of pain.

Yet all he achieves by clinging to her lifeless body is to tear off her clothes.

Once more, *his mother* appears naked before his eyes.

And it is this nakedness which he cannot bear.

Like a savage beast he springs open the clasp — the clasp he has opened so many times before to make love to his wife — and jabs the long pin into his eyes, screaming out loud with the pain.

His torn and bleeding eyes are turned towards his mother's naked body: she becomes blurred, then dull and misty, and finally merges into the inky blackness. Slow fade out.

Scene 45. The square in front of the royal palace. Exterior. Day. (Stills on page 119)

The whole town is present, citizens and senators: a mass of people crowding in front of the house that has witnessed a tragedy.

A deep silence, a brooding expectation . . .

Everyone is watching the door: and there, groping, hesitant, Oedipus emerges.

Nothing breaks the long, profound silence: all eyes are on the reeling, staggering figure as he falls, and picks himself up. He is totally alone.

Horror, repugnance, hatred and derision already outweigh the pity in their eyes.

It is a senator, an old man with compassionate eyes, who, with a choking voice, finally breaks that endless, tragic and shameful silence.

SENATOR : *Why? Why did you do it?*

Oedipus whips his head round, trying to locate the voice, his neck and chin stretched taut, like a worm that has just been crushed. He manages to utter a few faltering words, his voice broken by the terrible pain he is enduring.*

OEDIPUS : *Like this, I won't have to look any more on the evil . . . that I have suffered and committed . . . In darkness I will no longer be able to see those things which should never be seen . . . nor recognize those things I wanted to recognize . . .*³⁰⁵

Again a long, long silence. Then Oedipus stammers on, repeating himself :

OEDIPUS : *I should have hacked off my ears as well . . . to imprison this unhappy body all the more securely within myself . . . to no longer have to see or hear anything . . . anything at all . . . How wonderful, to have a mind free of evil!*³⁰⁶

Once more he is silent. Then after a long pause, he starts uttering words at random, in fragments . . .

OEDIPUS : *You must cast me out from amongst you . . . You must not delay in banishing this man who sows fear in his wake . . .*³⁰⁷

And again he is silent, waiting for words to form within his darkest night :

OEDIPUS : *We must never mention the impure things of life . . . never talk of them, never refer to them; we must keep absolute silence! Hide me away! Cast me out of this our land! Throw me somewhere inaccessible, where I will never be seen again.*³⁰⁸

SENATOR still timidly, in his breathless, hushed voice : *Creon must make the decisions now . . .*

A crushed worm again, Oedipus twists his head around, seeking out Creon; at the sound of his name he groans pitifully.

CREON : *No, I have no wish to mock you now, Oedipus, nor to reproach you for your crimes . . . But you, citizens of Thebes,*

* In the film, the role of the senator is abolished and Oedipus utters the following monologue in the bedchamber, just after he has blinded himself.

what are you doing? Take him inside his house, and place him in the care of his loved ones. Compassion demands that they must be the only ones to suffer the sight of his degradation.

OEDIPUS: No Creon, no . . . Out of the same compassion, send me far away from this city . . . Leave me to wander in the desolate mountains, where my mother and father consigned me as a new-born child, and let me die there, as they wished me to . . .

Creon has nothing more to say. He lowers his eyes, glancing enigmatically at Oedipus and at the others.

Again the tragic, shameful silence descends on the assembled company.

They look at each other, and at Oedipus, with horror, contempt, irony and pity in their eyes.

Oedipus begins to sway towards the road leading out of the city, falls, gets up again, and staggers on, in the silence . . .

At this point the boy-messenger steps out, with humility and compassion written on his face; he is holding something in his hand. It is a flute. Shaped like 'Tiresias'. The flute of a blind man. The flute which orders events in their cycles, and makes legends out of tragedies.

The boy is accustomed to a humble station in life, and is not afraid to come close to this wreck of a man, his wounds still fresh and bleeding. He draws near, and holds out the flute that Oedipus cannot see, cannot know of.

Then the boy takes one of his hands, and places it on the instrument; Oedipus' hand feels it all over, and recognizes it, and clutches it tight. Then, supported by the boy, he sets off with him.

The two walk away — through that overbearing and insupportable silence — while the crowd watch their progress, holding themselves aloof.

Oedipus can barely stagger along; it seems to take an eternity for the two figures to reach the outskirts of the town, and set out across the desolate countryside.

And it is only then that Oedipus puts the flute to his lips . . . and plays a first note . . . and then a second . . . while the boy, at his side, lends him encouragement . . .

Now Oedipus — a blind beggar, a prophet — is making music. The melody is still laborious and infantile, harking

back to his childhood; it is the melody of Tiresias' mysterious love song; the melody which is both older and younger than destiny.

The two are lost from sight, far away along the dusty road.

Scene 46. A square. Exterior. Day. (Stills on page 120)

A wide square, bearing the marks of history and of civilization: an unfinished cathedral, in red stone, a palace of the Commune opposite it, with its solemn arcade of pointed arches, and its marble mullioned windows; and on the other side another public building, also in red stone, with battlements; and all around the square, red stone houses with their characteristic roofs and porticos.

On the right side of the square is a long arcade, an elegant series of porticos laden with memories of rich families, of public events, of long-forgotten Sunday promenades.

Here the bourgeoisie can celebrate its rites, and admire its own grandeur.

Between the ancient buildings, and the weathered arcades, a few elegant shops stand out. Within the square itself, traffic and shoppers are in constant movement.

But one of its corners has been taken over by doves and layabouts. They are peacefully soaking up the honey-sweetness of the sun, glowing reddish throughout the lazy day.

Oedipus and his young guide, coming in from a side-street, make for this corner, this refuge away from the vortex of city life.

Oedipus eases himself down and begins playing his flute. He has the long hair and dusty, unshaven appearance of a beggar, or a prophet.

The tune comes from a song of the bourgeois renaissance (or revolution?), of the struggles for liberty.

As the melody unwinds, all the surroundings take on a precise and emotion-laden meaning; they become memory itself, and rediscover, with their daily commonplaces, the epic qualities within them.

Students walk past carrying books. Pretty young girls are mincing through the arcades. A mother passes by with her child in her arms, a benevolent, dignified matron, enjoying her after-

noon or her morning walk.

Children wander up, and form a group around Oedipus. They are a little frightened of him, but before running off they find the courage to throw a few taunts his way :

CHILDREN : *Swollen Feet! Swollen Feet! Swollen Feet!*

Tourists are taking snapshots of the cathedral.

Police are lazing around, half in shade and half in sunlight.

The coming and going, the flashing eyes, the moving hands and feet — just one of the thousand hours through which humanity, in all its laziness and frenzied activity, marches on towards its fate.

The boy-messenger, without cares or responsibility, is playing with the doves, waving his arms at them and making them fly off.

And meanwhile, Oedipus plays his flute, breathing into his instrument the melody which gives his surroundings meaning : the sweet murmurings of history.

Then suddenly he breaks off, as though summoned by an idea, which demands instant satisfaction, verification. He staggers around trying to locate his guide, impatient now and anxious to be on his way.

When the youth reaches his side, Oedipus pushes him towards another side-street — as if guided by a distant, interior summons — and the two are soon lost from sight . . .

Scene 47. An industrial landscape. Exterior. Day. (Stills on page 120)

A calm morning in the industrial north of Italy : the horizon cluttered with the huge, squat and fragile outlines of factories. Here the motorways have room to expand, and the overpasses can leap gaily across rivers of cars, speeding by almost noiselessly in the blue mist.

But the scene is dominated by the presence of the factories, their lines imposed by obscure needs, and hence preserving the simplicity of ancient churches. A soft light hangs over this industrial landscape : the soft lilacs and greys and the dazzling white of the asymmetric walls and the obsessional rows of identical cylindrical structures, and the same colours in the sky acting as a backdrop.

Lost in a forgotten corner of this perfection is a chaotic and rustic survivor: the remains of a field, plus scraps of hedging, and in the background, a huge mountain of coal, looming black and gleaming against the hazy sky.

Oedipus and his guide direct their steps towards this field, which is used by the workers on their way to the factories.

They flop down on the grass. And Oedipus begins to play his flute.

This time the melody derives from a song of popular revolt, from the partisan struggles. Through the mysterious mood it evokes, this seems to give its own meaning to all the surrounding elements: to the workers going by, to the passing traffic, to the groups of common people waiting at the bus-stops in the distance.

A few youths are kicking a football around on the field: Oedipus' guide, gruff and happy, goes off to play with them.

This is an hour of the day that still belongs to the people.

And Oedipus is lost, intent on squeezing from his flute the sort of music which can express the meaning of all those things. Dissolve.

Scene 48. Exteriors in Sacile. Day. (Still on page 120)

Oedipus and the boy guiding him are now walking along a white-washed, modest little village street. They are walking in silence through the midday hush.

And then long-forgotten, indelible images begin to appear:

A street, a house . . .

The countryside is just beyond the houses . . .

For the most part they are humble dwellings, for the lower middle classes . . . There are the characteristic porches, gutters and small lintels over the doors: tell-tale signs of the maritime nobility which has ruled this hinterland for centuries.

Two children in primary school and a soldier passing by . . .

It seems to be the same soldier as before, even if he is no longer dressed in the grey-green of the thirties, but in the khaki of the sixties . . .

Now Oedipus and the boy are walking along a road on the outskirts of the village: the houses appear as a series of whitish clots in the distance. And here . . .

Here is the old rustic house with wheat still on the threshing floor. And a gig . . . and a dog which goes away and comes back . . . Some strange, yet acutely familiar people, and the hens . . .

Now the road runs along a high bank, where the air is fresh and the vegetation sparse . . . and a railway nearby, perhaps — with the occasional train passing that serves this forgotten part of the world — some peasants, a spastic child in its wheelchair . . . going by with a mysteriously pallid face — a testimony to one of those myriad villages which has stagnated into a backwater.

Oedipus walks along the road; below is the wide field where young girls chased each other long ago, and laughed and clapped happily around a little boy . . .

At the bottom of the field: the smooth green waters of a modest little river . . .

Oedipus lingers there awhile, before moving down into the field, driven on relentlessly it seems by his obsession, right down to the bottom where the Livenza is shimmering green . . .

And here he stops. Is this the place he was looking for, in the darkness of his night?

The spot is a jewel of nature; silvery willows are growing in wild profusion, their boughs dipping into the drifting waters. It was here that Oedipus first distinguished and recognized his mother.

The slightest breath of an ancient and inexpressible wind gives life to this pastoral scene; over its image flows that same musical theme, at once investing the surroundings with its own disturbing meaning — a repetition, a return — an original immobility in the vain movement of time — the mysterious music of childhood days — the love song of the prophet — older and younger than destiny itself — the source of all things.

CUTTING CONTINUITY

NOTE: Dialogue from the original script which has been retained in the final screen version has been marked in the continuity by reference numbers keyed to the main text. These numbers refer back to the beginning of each speech or paragraph. Dialogue which is only heard in the final version is transcribed in full. The scene numbers from the main text have been retained in the cutting continuity, though their positioning is necessarily approximate in some cases, where changes have taken place in the transition from script to film.

1. MS of a milestone at the roadside reading: 'Thebes'.

Scene 1.

2. LS of Sacile in the afternoon sun, seen across a field of sweet corn.

3. LS of the town square with a statue. Two soldiers pass by.

Scene 2.

4. MS of a balcony and a window. Inside we can just see a woman giving birth to a child.

5. A closer shot of the balcony and window. The midwives pass the child from hand to hand. Rapid fade out.

Scene 3.

6. LS of a field in the sunshine. A party of women start to cross the field in the distance.

7. CU tracking with a white hat which one of the women is carrying in her hand. Tilt down as she drops it on the ground.

8. MS of the baby lying on a blanket in the grass.

9. MS: camera, almost at ground level, pans with the legs of several of the women as they lay out a cloth on the grass and put down a picnic basket. Pan to show the hand of the mother playing with a flower.

10. High angle MCU of the baby lying on the blanket, crying.

11. LS of the field from the baby's eye level. The mother beckons her women and they all run off into the distance, laughing.

12. MS of the baby lying by itself on the grass.

13. LS of the field. The women run about in the distance, playing like children.

14. MS of the mother, seen from behind, walking slowly across the field, holding her baby.

15. LS of the field, the mother walking along with the baby in the distance.

16. Similar LS: the mother coming towards camera. She puts the baby down on the ground.

17. MCU of the baby sucking at its mother's breast. (Still on page 33)

18. MCU of the mother looking tenderly down at it. She rocks the baby in her arms. (Still on page 33)

19. CU of the baby cradled against its mother's breast. It looks upwards.

20. Shot of what it sees. Camera pans from a low angle across the tree-tops, against the sky.

21. Resume on the mother. She looks down at her baby which she has now put on the ground, then gets up and walks off.

22. High angle MCU of the baby lying on its rug, watching her go. It looks round.

23. Another panning shot of trees and sky; then camera tilts down to show the field in front of the baby.

Scene 5.

24. Low angle MLS of the front of the building containing the orderly room at the barracks with the Italian national flag hanging from an upper window.

25. MLS panning fast with a group of children as they run in through the entrance to the barracks and along past some buildings at the side of the barracks square. The leading child is carrying a flag.

26. MLS of the mother, accompanied by one of her women, wheeling her baby in a pram along by the wall outside the barracks. Camera pans left as she approaches the entrance to the barracks square. Military music.

27. LS of the barracks square including the building with the flag hanging from it in the background. A group of women and one or two men are standing in the distance.

28. Reverse angle LS of the mother, accompanied by the woman, wheeling her child across the square in the pram. She waves to the group, off-screen. Camera pans right as she comes up to the group, amongst whom is the father, resplendent in military uniform. *GENERAL EXCHANGES: Good morning . . . How are you? etc.*

29. Low angle MCU of the father gazing intensely down at the baby off-screen. (Still on page 33)

30. High angle MCU of the baby looking up at him. It sits up in its pram. (Still on page 33)

31. MS: seen from the side, the women go in through the doorway of one of the buildings, followed by one of the men.

32. MLS of the pram in the square. The baby is left with his father staring down at him. (Still on page 33)

33. High angle CU of the baby gazing up at his father. The military music continues.

34. Low angle MCU of the father still gazing down at the baby.

TITLE: 1

35. Resume on the baby. Disturbed by its father's frown, it puts its hands over its eyes. The music stops.

36. Resume on the father still gazing hostilely down at it. Laughter is heard off. The father turns.

37. Low angle MLS of the entrance to the building with the flag hanging from it, half hidden by rose bushes. Laughing, the women stream out of the door, followed by the mother.

38. MCU, panning rapidly left with the mother, seen at first behind the rose bushes, as she runs gaily across the square, laughing. She calls to her women as she comes. *MOTHER: Come on, come on, quickly!* Suddenly she halts and looks at the father standing over the pram, off-screen. Then she runs gaily on again.

39. LS of the barracks square, the orderly room building in the background. On the right is the father, still standing over the pram.

40. Low angle MCU of the father still glowering down at the baby.

TITLE: 2

Scene 6.

41. MS of the doorway to the child's bedroom. It is night. The mother, in evening dress, looks in through the doorway of the darkened room.

42. High angle CU of the baby's head, asleep on the pillow.
43. Low angle MCU of the mother standing in the doorway. She turns to the father in the other room. MOTHER: *He's asleep.* She smiles at the baby, then goes off.
44. Reverse angle shot. Camera tracks after the mother as she goes into the adjoining bedroom. In the background is a large double bed. The father is seated on the edge of it, in his uniform, giving his boots a final polish. Camera pans left with the mother as she goes across to a dressing table.
45. MLS of the father. He stands up from the bed, straightens his trousers, picks up his cap. Camera pans left as he walks across to his wife at the dressing table.
46. MCU of the two of them from behind. We see their reflections in the dressing table mirror as the father leans over and kisses the mother's shoulder. Faint music and laughter off. The mother turns and the father kisses her passionately. MOTHER: *Come on, let's go.* Camera pans left as she draws away from him and walks across the room. He follows her and kisses her again passionately. MOTHER: *That's enough.* She turns out the light. Camera pans again as they walk out of the room.
47. High angle LS of the barracks square. It is dark. A single light is visible from a first floor window in the background. Shouts and laughter as couples in evening dress move towards the back of the square.
48. High angle MCU of the baby. He wakes up and tosses in his bed, crying, as the sound of dance music is heard off.
49. High angle MS of the curtained doorway to the room. Light is shining through it.
50. High angle shot of the room. The child gets out of bed and camera pans as he moves across the room in his night shirt and out past the curtain, onto the balcony.
51. Low angle MS of the balcony, in wrought iron, with pots of geraniums standing on either side. The child comes out and looks down through the railing.
52. Resume on high angle LS of the square. Figures can be seen moving through the lighted window over the balcony at the opposite end. The dance music continues.
53. Low angle MS of the balcony and windows. The mother and father are seen in silhouette, dancing just inside the open window.
54. Resume on the child standing on the balcony, watching.
55. MS of the couple, mother and father, embracing as they dance. Their shadows are thrown on the net curtain over the window in front of them. (Still on page 34)
56. Resume on the child on the balcony. Suddenly there is a massive explosion.
57. Low angle shot from the middle of the square looking up towards the sky. Fireworks explode with a massive noise.
58. Resume on the child. He bursts out crying. Lit by the light of the fireworks, he beats his hand in frustration on the railings.
59. Resume on low angle shot of fireworks exploding over the roof tops.
60. Resume on the child lit by the flickering light of the fireworks. He drops his head and presses his hand to his eyes in a characteristic gesture.
61. Resume on shot of the roof tops and sky in the darkness. All is quiet.
62. High angle MLS of the baby lying asleep in his cot. (Still on page 34)
63. MS of the door of the room. Camera pans right with the two parents as they come in and walk across to the bed. They pause to look down at the child,

then go out on the other side of the room. The light is turned on in the bedroom next door.

64. General shot of the bedroom with the double bed in the background. Arm in arm, the couple go towards the bed. The wife sits down and the husband throws himself passionately on top of her. (Still on page 34)

65. High angle MCU of their heads on the pillow. The husband kisses the wife passionately on top of her. (Still on page 34)

66. MCU of their heads from the level of the pillow. They kiss passionately.

67. MS of the bed. The wife sits up, draws away from the husband and picks up a blue woven night gown. The husband continues to kiss her on the shoulder.

68. High angle MCU of the baby lying in bed, its eyes wide open, looking across at the door off-screen.

69. MS of the doorway to the bedroom, the light streaming through it.

70. Resume on LS of the bedroom. The husband takes off his trousers and throws them on a chair by the bed. Then he throws himself on top of his wife again.

71. High angle MCU of their heads on the pillow. The husband, back to camera, leans over her and kisses her tenderly. Camera moves in on them slightly.

72. MS of the curtained doorway, leading to the next room.

73. LS of the small town in the darkness.

74. LS of the field where the baby was previously, also in the darkness.

75. Similar LS with trees in the background.

76. Similar LS of where we saw the mother walking with her baby.

77. Resume on high angle MCU of the baby lying in his cot, eyes open.

78. High angle MS of the parents lying on their bed, having just made love. (Still on page 34)

79. High angle MCU of the husband lying with his eyes open, an intense expression on his face. Camera pans left to show the mother lying back in repose.

80. Resume on the father. Sound of a flute off. He gets up.

81. MLS of the bed. The father gets up and comes towards camera which pans slightly right as he moves off-screen.

82. MCU of his head as it appears in the doorway of the child's room. He comes into the room and suddenly reaches down towards the child.

83. High angle CU of his hands grasping the child by the feet. He squeezes the feet.

84. High angle MCU of the child's head as it turns over on its pillow in terror.

85. Low angle CU of the father staring down at him in darkness.

86. Resume on high angle CU of the father's hands grasping the child's feet. The sound of the flute continues.

Scene 7.

87. LS. Camera pans slowly across barren, brown hills, tilting up and down slightly. A snow-capped peak is seen in the background. Camera halts.

88. MLS, tracking left with a man in peasant's clothes as he walks along, carrying the baby Oedipus, slung by his feet and hands from a pole. (Still on page 35) The baby screams. The Theban slave stops.

89. Low angle MCU of his face as he looks around him. The baby continues to scream off.

90. Low angle shot of the blue sky. Crows circle around and swoop, screeching.

91. High angle MS, tracking with a snake as it crawls across the ground.

Scene 8.

92. MS of the shepherd of Corinth coming towards camera, the snow-capped peak in the background. The baby's cries are heard off. The shepherd halts, looking at something off-screen.

93. LS of the hills of brown and red earth. Camera pans left.

94. High angle MCU of the baby Oedipus, lying squalling on the ground, his hands bound by rope. (Still on page 35)

95. MCU of the Theban slave seen from behind. He stands over the screaming baby, with a spear raised. (Still on page 35) He hesitates, then suddenly lowers his spear and runs off, camera panning with him.

96. LS of the slave, panning slowly right as he races away across the barren hillside.

97. LS of the shepherd of Corinth coming slowly towards camera. The baby continues to squall off. He stops.

98. A closer shot of the shepherd peering forward. Camera tracks in on him slightly.

99. LS of what he sees. The slave with the spear is coming slowly towards him in the distance.

100. MCU of the shepherd peering forward again. Camera tracks out in front of him as he walks on.

101. LS of the slave with the spear coming slowly towards us as the shepherd walks towards him from the foreground, camera tracking after him. (Still on page 35) The Theban slave moves slightly aside as he passes the shepherd, who glances at him and walks on.

102. MCU of the Theban slave from behind. He turns and looks round at the shepherd off-screen. He almost says something, then decides not to.

103. MS, tracking after the shepherd as he walks towards the sound of the squalling baby. He glances back over his shoulder, then breaks into a run.

104. MCU of the slave, standing holding his spear, as he watches the shepherd run off towards the baby. He turns and walks on again.

105. MLS of the shepherd. He claps his hands in delight and camera tracks left as he runs rapidly along the hillside and kneels down over the baby as it lies squalling on the ground.

106. High angle MCU of the baby, its hands held up. The shepherd's hands release the rope.

107. High angle MCU of the shepherd leaning over and hastily untying the child's feet. (Still on page 35) SHEPHERD:³

108. MS of the shepherd from behind. He picks up the child and camera pans right as he runs off along the hillside. SHEPHERD:⁴

Scene 9.

109. LS of the walls of Corinth, the populace gathered outside with the King sitting under a canopy in their midst. (Still on page 36) Sound of chanting from the populace. Camera tracks in slightly.

110. MS, tracking right with the shepherd as he runs past a flock of sheep, their bells ringing.

111. LS of the King, Polybus, seated under his canopy, wearing a golden crown and red robes. A scribe is seated at his side. Camera tracks in towards him.

112. MS, tracking sideways with the shepherd. He slows down to a walk as he passes a couple more flocks of sheep.

113. MS of Polybus watching the approaching shepherd with interest. Camera tracks in on him. The chanting continues.

114. Closer shot, still tracking with the shepherd, as he holds the squalling child up in his arms for the King to see.

115. MCU of Polybus asking with a smile:⁵

116. CU of the shepherd, the child held high in his hands, above his head and off-screen. (Still on page 36) He replies. SHEPHERD:⁷ KING POLYBUS in a low voice:⁶ SHEPHERD:⁸

117. MCU of Polybus. He leans forward and exclaims:⁹

118. MS of the shepherd, back to camera, still holding the child high in his arms. (Still on page 36) He leans forward and gives it to Polybus. KING POLYBUS:¹⁰

119. Low angle MCU of Polybus swinging the child in his arms, with the shepherd standing beaming just behind him. The child squalls and points a finger off-screen. KING POLYBUS:¹¹ Suddenly he looks down at the child, who has apparently peed on his arm. He brushes at his sleeve.

120. CU of his red, quilted sleeve as he brushes at it with his hand.

121. MS of the scene, the shepherd standing back to camera in the foreground. Behind him Polybus turns, gives the child to the scribe behind him for a moment. Two youths in loin-cloths rush forward and take his crown and false beard. Then he picks up the child again. It is still squalling loudly.

122. MS. Camera pans left as Polybus, holding the squalling child in his arms, moves away from the throng of people and off into the distance. A primitive trumpet is blaring loudly off.

123. MS of Polybus seated on his donkey, coming up a stony track towards camera, with the child seated in front of him.

124. MLS of Polybus from behind as he rides away across the stony ground towards the walls of Corinth in the distance.

125. MS. Camera pans right round as Polybus passes on his donkey, cradling the child in his arms. (Production still on page 36)

126. LS of Polybus entering the walls of Corinth, coming towards camera on his donkey.

127. LS of the fortified walls. Colourfully dressed troops stand to attention in the foreground, while more of his subjects bow to the ground behind. Camera pans left as another figure, dressed in colourful plumes, rushes up to Polybus and takes the bridle of his donkey, leading it along. Other members of the populace come up to accompany them as they walk towards camera. (Still on page 36)

128. Low angle LS panning across the towers of Corinth.

129. MS, panning with the group as they come towards camera and halt. We see that the plumed figure is wearing a crudely painted mask as he turns back to face the king.

130. MS tracking in on the king as eager hands take the baby from him and begin to help him from his horse.

Scene 10.

131. LS of the green countryside surrounding the river, with hills in the background. Queen Merope sits on a rise in the centre of shot. The river is out of sight below.

132. High angle LS of the Queen's women sitting by the river, singing. Multi-coloured garments are laid out to dry on the stones.

133. Low angle LS of the town rising above the river. Polybus appears from a gateway in the centre of shot and runs towards camera, holding up the baby and shouting. KING POLYBUS: *Queen, Queen!*

134. A closer shot of the Queen seated above the river. She slowly puts on her

- crown as her women begin to shout excitedly, out of sight below. KING POLYBUS off: *Look!* WOMEN: *It's King Polybus! It's the King!* The Queen rises to her feet.
135. High angle MS of the women by the riverside. Camera tracks out in front of them as they scamper excitedly up the river bank, shouting and laughing.
136. MCU of the Queen. Camera tracks out in front of her briefly as she takes a step forwards. (Still on page 36)
137. MLS: camera pans slightly left as Polybus runs towards the Queen off-screen, holding up the squalling baby in his arms. KING POLYBUS: *Queen, Queen!*
138. Low angle MCU of the baby Oedipus as Polybus holds him up in his arms. KING POLYBUS: *Look what I've brought you . . .*
139. MLS of the Queen standing above the river bed, her women below and behind her, looking uncertainly towards Polybus off-screen. KING POLYBUS off: *. . . A gift from God!*
140. MS of some of the women standing behind a large boulder, looking at the baby with approbation. WOMEN:¹⁶ They all start to clap their hands while the baby squalls off-screen.
141. Resume on low angle MS of the baby held in the air. He waves his hands and squalls as the King continues. KING POLYBUS: *A gift from God!*
142. MCU of three young girls watching, grinning broadly and clapping their hands.
143. MCU of a small boy, also looking on and grinning. He is holding a small bird, struggling in his hands.
144. MCU of the Queen, looking doubtfully at the baby off-screen. KING POLYBUS off:¹²
145. Reverse angle MCU of Polybus holding up the child. (Still on page 36) KING POLYBUS:¹³
146. Reverse angle MS: camera tracks after Polybus as, holding up the child, he advances towards the Queen, who is standing facing him a little way away. (Still on page 36) KING POLYBUS:¹⁴ He lowers the child as the Queen replies severely. QUEEN MEROPE:¹⁵ She takes the child in her arms and speaks to it softly, while Polybus takes it by the feet. QUEEN MEROPE:¹⁷
147. CU of Polybus, playing with the child's feet, kissing them and pressing them together, glancing joyfully down at the child off-screen. QUEEN MEROPE:¹⁸
148. CU of the Queen looking at him tenderly.
149. CU of Polybus smiling tenderly down at the child. He kisses its feet again Fade out.
- Scene 11.*
150. MCU of the hands of two girls holding bunches of flowers. One of the girls is handing flowers one by one to her companion, who is wearing a garland, and is dressed in mauve.
151. High angle LS of a playing-field near Corinth, which can be seen some way off in the background. A line of youths stand on the left while another figure holds a discus. Camera pans right as it flies through the air and lands with a thud. There is a line of spectators watching on the edge of the field in the background.
152. Resume on the two girls with the flowers.
153. Resume on the field. Another figure hurls a discus. It lands with a thud a little way beyond the first one. Camera pans with it.
154. Resume on the other end of the field. Camera pans again as the line of

youths run forward to see how the discuses have landed. One figure is several yards ahead of the others.

155. Low angle MCU of the leading figure, the twenty-year-old Oedipus, as he arrives at the spot, glances behind him, then looks down at the ground.

156. High angle MS of his feet as he surreptitiously kicks his discus ahead of the others.

157. Resume on low angle MCU of his face. He moves off-screen. Another youth appears in his place, looking down at the ground.

158. LS: camera pans with the group of youths who chase after Oedipus as he races to the edge of the field and grabs his cloak shouting. OEDIPUS:¹⁹

159. MCU of the two girls, their heads still out of shot. The one on the right raises the garland she has been weaving in her hands.

160. MS: waving his cloak in the air, Oedipus rushes towards camera shouting. OEDIPUS:²⁰ He halts and lowers his head.

161. MCU of the girl dressed in mauve. Camera tracks with her as she goes up to Oedipus and lays the garland on his head.

162. MLS of the scene. Standing back to camera, Oedipus straightens up, the garland on his head, as the girl turns and walks back to her companions. An angry voice cries off. YOUTH:²¹

163. MCU of Oedipus, the garland on his head, gazing in front of him as the youth runs up behind, shouting angrily. YOUTH:²² Oedipus turns slowly.

164. Reverse angle MS as he turns round and suddenly rushes towards camera. YOUTH off:²³

165. Reverse angle shot. Seen from behind, Oedipus rushes towards the youth, grapples with him and starts to hit him. The other youths rush up in the background. YOUTH:²⁴

166. CU of Oedipus's face as he hits out at the youth, the garland on his head.

167. Resume on MS as Oedipus throws the youth to the ground. YOUTH:²⁵

168. MCU of Oedipus stepping back. He steps back, gasping, as the youth continues. YOUTH off:²⁶

169. MCU of the youth sitting up on the ground. Numerous other youths stand watching in the background. YOUTH:²⁷

170. Resume on MS of the scene. Oedipus turns away from the youth and strides towards camera, grinning happily. He comes into CU and goes off.

171. CU of Oedipus. Camera tracks with him as he paces round and round, clasping his hands together in ecstasy over his victory.*

Scene 12.

172. MCU of Oedipus sitting in the royal palace at Corinth, gloomy and morose. He rubs his knuckles against his mouth. (Still on page 37)

173. MS of Queen Merope, seated amongst her women, carding goat's wool. She looks anxiously across at Oedipus, off-screen. (Still on page 37)

174. Resume on Oedipus. He continues to bite his knuckles.

175. MS of Polybus seated on a stone step. An attendant is washing his feet.

176. MLS of Oedipus, framed by two pillars. He is wearing a kind of crown, with two large wings extending from it. He gets to his feet and comes towards camera, addressing his mother off-screen. OEDIPUS:²⁸ (Still on page 37)

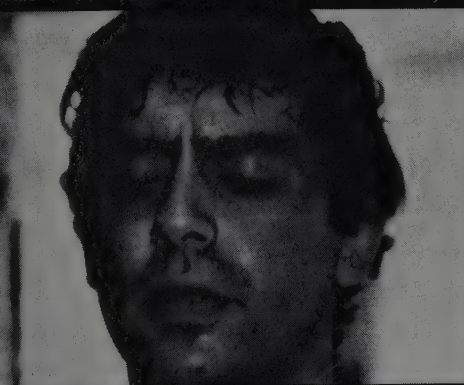
177. CU of Oedipus as he speaks. He looks sad and strained. OEDIPUS:²⁹

178. MLS of the courtyard of the palace. In the background Queen Merope rises from amongst her women and comes out into the sunlight as Oedipus continues off. OEDIPUS:³⁰ The Queen halts in the centre of the courtyard and

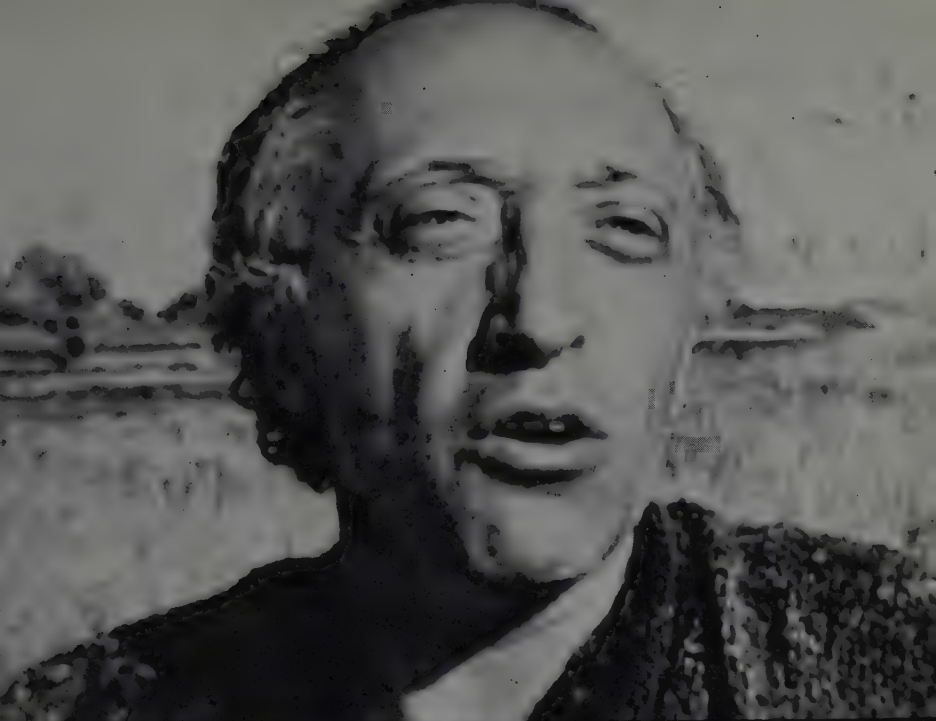
* End of reel one, 600 metres approximately.

















says :³¹

179. As the Queen continues, cut to high angle shot of the courtyard. Oedipus stands between two pillars in the background, listening, while his mother addresses him from the centre of the courtyard. Polybus, attended by a number of youths in loin-cloths, rises to his feet in the foreground and walks towards Oedipus. QUEEN MEROPE :³²

180. MCU of Merope standing in the courtyard. She turns to her husband off-screen as she continues enthusiastically. QUEEN MEROPE :³³

181. MCU of Polybus. He shrugs. KING POLYBUS :³⁴

182. Resume on CU of Polybus. He looks at his father. OEDIPUS :³⁵

183. Resume on MCU of Polybus. He tries to object. KING POLYBUS :³⁶ His wife breaks in.

184. MCU of Merope. QUEEN MEROPE :³⁷

185. Resume on Oedipus. He turns to his mother. OEDIPUS :³⁸

186. Resume on Merope. QUEEN MEROPE :³⁹

187. Resume on Oedipus. OEDIPUS :⁴⁰

Scene 13.

188. Low angle LS of the towers of Corinth, blue sky and clouds behind.

189. Low angle MLS of a stork standing on its nest on the roofs of one of the houses in Corinth.

190. Low angle shot. Camera pans with the stork as it flies across and perches on the roof of another building.

191. Another similar shot. Camera pans to the right as the stork takes off again and flies away from the city. We hear the sound of its wings flapping.

192. LS of a flock of sheep outside the town. Camera pans right to show the shepherd who found Oedipus on the hillside, seated nearby.

193. MCU of the shepherd. Camera tracks in slightly on his face as he stares straight ahead.

Scene 14.

194. MCU of Merope in profile, standing in front of Oedipus as he takes leave of her. Oedipus appears in shot as he puts out his hand to touch her on the cheek.

195. MCU of her seen over Oedipus's shoulder. She gazes anxiously into his eyes. Oedipus strokes her cheek. (Still on page 37)

196. Reverse angle shot of Oedipus, Merope in back view in the foreground. Polybus stands a little behind them to the right while various others stand peering through an archway in the background. OEDIPUS :⁴¹

197. LS of the palace courtyard. In the background, Oedipus finally leaves his mother and walks across the courtyard towards camera. (Still on page 37)

198. MCU of Merope looking sadly after him, flanked by a serving woman on either side. QUEEN MEROPE :⁴³

199. MCU of Oedipus. He turns and looks back at her. OEDIPUS :⁴² He turns and walks out, putting on his wide-brimmed hat as he goes.

200. MCU of Merope. She bursts into sobs and camera tilts down with her as she sinks to the ground. She looks up towards camera.

Scenes 15-16.

201. LS of the gates of Corinth with the towers of the palace behind. Two guards stand to attention as Oedipus comes out and the gates slam shut behind him. Camera pans left with him as he starts to walk away from the gate.

202. MS, panning left with Oedipus as he starts to walk away from the city. (Still on page 38) He pauses and turns back, then walks on, still looking behind him.

203. High angle MLS of Oedipus, now some way up the road, the city below him in the background. Camera pans left as he turns and walks on again, passes us and goes out of frame.

Scene 17.

204. Loud music. Shot of animals and people gathered in the market place at Delphi.

205. MS of the lower half of Oedipus's body as he strides past a milestone pointing back to Corinth.

206. Shot of the caravanserais with donkeys laden with panniers etc as Oedipus makes his way amongst them, going away from camera.

207. Shot of a crowd of pilgrims holding branches of greenery, seated on the ground at the shrine. Oedipus strides between them, coming towards camera. (Still on page 38)

208. LS of the scene, the shrine under a large tree on a rise in the background. In the foreground is a long queue of pilgrims, waiting their turn to consult the oracle. Priests and bystanders form a corridor on either side. In the foreground, Oedipus kneels down at the end of the queue.

209. CU of Oedipus's face. Camera tilts up as he rises slightly, looking up at the oracle off-screen.

210. LS of the scene. This time Oedipus is out of sight. A figure comes down the hill from the oracle and at the same time the man at the head of the queue rises to his feet and starts to walk up towards him. They pass each other. (Still on page 38)

211. Dissolve to high angle MS of Oedipus kneeling, now at the head of the queue. The priests on either side of him rise to their feet, holding their branches of greenery. Oedipus looks up. (Still on page 38) Camera tilts up with him as he gets to his feet and starts to walk, staring straight ahead.

212. LS of what he sees: the oracle standing in the shade of a vast tree at the top of the hill with its attendants in the background. Camera tracks in slowly as Oedipus walks towards the oracle.

213. Reverse angle MLS: camera tracks out slightly as Oedipus comes up the hill towards the oracle. The queue of pilgrims is seen in the background.

214. Reverse shot of the oracle, camera tracking in again as Oedipus continues to walk.

215. High angle MS of Oedipus at the foot of the rise just below the tree, as seen by the oracle. He looks up, then bows low, his face almost to the ground. Then he looks up again.

216. Low angle MS of the oracle standing under the tree, with her attendants behind her. She claps her hands and several of the figures run off, to reappear in a few seconds, carrying several platters and bowls of food. Then they sit down behind the priestess as she starts to stuff handfuls of rice from the bowls into her mouth.

217. MCU of the oracle with an attendant on either side of her, as she stuffs the rice into her mouth.

218. CU of Oedipus with his hand over his eyes. He lowers his hand and his eyes fill the screen as he looks up at the oracle. ORACLE off: ⁴⁴

219. Low angle MCU of the oracle as seen by Oedipus, speaking. (Still on page 38) ORACLE: ⁴⁵ She bursts out laughing.

220. High angle MCU of Oedipus looking up at her. He also laughs.

221. Low angle closer shot of the oracle laughing wildly.

222. Resume on Oedipus looking more uncertain.

223. Back to the oracle as she begins to speak again. ORACLE repeating: *You*

understand . . .^{45, 46}

224. Resume on Oedipus looking up at her in alarm. ORACLE off: *Now go.*

225. MCU of the oracle with her attendants behind her, lit by the sun shining across the hill behind, the tresses on her mask now covering her face. ORACLE: *Do not contaminate these people by your presence.*

226. Resume on Oedipus.

227. Low angle MCU of the oracle with the tree behind. The sun shining down from above the tree almost blots out the scene.

228. Resume on Oedipus. Camera tilts up with him as he gets up, turns hesitantly, looking back, and walks away down the hill.

229. LS of the hill with the waiting pilgrims in the foreground. Oedipus comes slowly down towards them while the next pilgrim from the queue starts up the hill.

Scene 18.

230. Very LS of Oedipus coming down the hill, completely alone in a vast expanse of sand. He pauses, then moves on again.

231. MCU of Oedipus, camera tracking out in front of him as he moves on, glancing anxiously round at the pilgrims off-screen.

232. Reverse angle LS of the line of waiting pilgrims with the priests and bystanders. The sun shines down blindingly from above. Camera tracks slowly forward as Oedipus, whom we do not see, walks along the queue of pilgrims.

233. MCU, tracking out in front of Oedipus, as he walks past the queue. Suddenly he clutches his hands to his eyes.

234. Another LS of him coming down the hill away from the tree. Camera tracks slightly left as he comes towards it.

235. Resume on Oedipus wandering past the pilgrims, looking round in bewilderment.

236. Another forward tracking shot through the crowd, the sun blazing down from above.

237. Very LS of Oedipus walking along through a barren landscape with hills and sky in the background. Camera tracks slowly left with him.

238. Forward tracking shot through the caravanserai at Delphi, pilgrims squatting on the ground, others standing around.

239. MCU, tracking out in front of Oedipus as he walks through the crowd.

240. MCU tracking out in front of him as he walks along through the same countryside, now apparently deserted. He mops his eyes.

241. Forward tracking shot through the crowd, blurred and misty.

242. MCU tracking out in front of Oedipus as he walks through the crowd.

243. MCU tracking out as he walks through the deserted landscape.

244. Forward tracking shot as he approaches some soldiers wearing plumes. The nearest is holding up a large sword, his face hidden by the plumes.

245. LS of the animals standing in the caravanserai.

246. Another similar shot. Oedipus runs amongst the animals towards camera, his hand pressed to his forehead.

Scene 19.

247. Forward tracking shot past pilgrims and animals towards a ruined wall behind which the sun is shining brightly. A procession carrying branches of greenery passes in the foreground. Camera comes round to the end of the wall so that the sun is shining directly into the lens, then tilts down to show a milestone at the bottom.

248. MCU, tracking sideways with Oedipus as he comes up and leans forward, staring at the milestone off-screen.

249. MCU of the milestone, which indicates the road to Corinth.

250. Low angle MCU of Oedipus looking down at the milestone. He presses his knuckles to his mouth again in a characteristic gesture. (Still on page 39)

251. Resume on the milestone. Camera tracks in on the name.

252. Resume on Oedipus. He suddenly turns and rushes away amongst the animals and pilgrims in the caravanserai.

253. Reverse angle shot. Oedipus rushes towards camera which pans right as he goes off and away into the distance.

254. High angle shot of the pilgrims and beasts gathered on the sand. A town can be seen in the distance. Oedipus appears on the right of frame and camera pans left as he rushes away into the distance.

Scene 20.

255. LS of a green field with hills behind.

256. Another similar shot: corn is waving in the field.

257. Slight high angle MS of Oedipus lying in the ditch, half concealed by the corn.

258. High angle MCU of him lying on his back, his eyes closed, gasping. He puts his hand to his forehead.

259. MS: Oedipus comes towards camera across a vast and barren desert with hills in the background. Camera pans slightly right as he goes on his way, his hand pressed to his eyes. (Still on page 39)

260. MS, tracking sideways with Oedipus, as he walks across the desert, his hat protecting him from the sun, his hands clasped to his eyes.

261. Another MS, tracking with him, as he walks on across the desert, blue hills in the background. Camera pans left as he passes, rubbing his eyes and protecting them with his arm.

262. High angle very LS of him crossing a greener stretch of ground.

263. LS of Oedipus walking away from camera towards a town in the background, bathed in evening light. He halts.

264. CU of Oedipus's face under his wide-brimmed hat as he turns his head, scanning the countryside.

265. CU of his eyes.

TITLE: Where are you going, my youth? Where are you going, my life?

266. LS of the mountains seen at the beginning of the film. Camera pans right to hold on the snow-capped peak in the distance.

267. LS of a road leading towards a patch of green landscape in the distance with hills beyond.

268. MCU of Oedipus under his wide-brimmed hat, staring ahead of him, tears pouring down his cheek. He suddenly clasps his hand to his eyes, then spins round several times. He stops, removes his hands from his eyes and continues to sob, then walks off to the right.

269. MS of a milestone at the side of the road which reads 'Thebes'. The lower half of Oedipus's body is seen as he walks past it in the direction of the city.

270. MS, tracking sideways with Oedipus as he walks across the barren hills, continually clasping his hands to his eyes. He halts by a milestone.

271. MCU. He puts his arm over his eyes and spins round in a circle again. He stops, looks ahead and walks on, tears pouring down his cheeks. Camera pans right as he moves away from camera and down a road into the distance.

Scene 21.

272. High angle MCU of Oedipus's hat with some pink flowers stuck into the crown. Camera tilts up to show his pack lying in an opening in a wall, then

pans very slowly right to show Oedipus sitting with his back to the wall, eating.

273. MS of some dark-skinned musicians playing a variety of wind instruments and drums. (Still on page 40)

274. Low angle MS of a couple of men and a woman looking on, beating time with their hands. Camera pans left, tilting down to show a bridal couple squatting on the ground with more women standing clapping their hands on the right.

275. MCU of the bride and bridegroom, with flowered garlands round their heads. They smile towards camera.

276. MLS of Oedipus, sitting in the corner with his back to the wall, eating. A youth in a loin-cloth comes out of a doorway beside him and lays a basket of food down in front of Oedipus. He goes back into the building. On the right, one of the members of the orchestra can be seen beating his tambourine.

277. MCU of Oedipus, eating, looking across at the bridal couple.

278. MS of a row of onlookers, beating their hands in time to the music.

279. MCU of the smiling bridegroom wreathed in flowers. Camera tracks in on his face then pans left to the new wife who smiles also.

Scene 22.

280. MCU of Oedipus under his broad-brimmed hat as he spins round once more, the hat tilted down over his eyes. He stops and raises his hat, then walks in the direction he is facing.

281. MS: camera pans right as Oedipus walks off up the road.

282. MS of a milestone saying 'Thebes' at the roadside.

Scene 25.

283. LS of Oedipus coming towards camera with green landscape and hills in the background. A wind is blowing. He stops at a wall.

284. Reverse angle LS of what he sees. In the distance is a village; in front, a belt of greenery and a ruined wall. Camera pans right to show several figures standing by a donkey, then another figure, robed in black, spinning round, watched by a row of children and accompanied by the clapping of several similarly dressed men. In the background are more ruins. (Still on page 40)

285. MCU of Oedipus: camera tilts down as he sinks to the ground.

286. MCU of the black-robed man spinning round, clapping his hands, his companions doing likewise.

287. MCU of a youth wearing a hat like Oedipus's. He turns round to face camera and grins broadly.

288. Resume on the group around the dancer. Camera pans left to show the youth with the hat. He takes it off.

289. High angle MS: the youth hands the hat to one of his two companions who puts it on and they walk away into the distance.

290. MCU of Oedipus watching the scene pensively.

291. MS of the group of children watching the dancers. They look across at Oedipus, grin and one of them waves.

292. Resume on Oedipus. Camera tilts up as he rises to his feet.

293. MCU of the dancer. Still dancing, he waves his hand, looking at Oedipus off-screen and pointing across at the ruins behind him.

294. MCU, tracking behind Oedipus as he walks over to the dancer, who is still gesticulating wildly.

295. CU of the dancer, old toothless and bald. He gesticulates wildly, pointing in the direction of the ruins.

296. High angle MCU, tracking and panning after Oedipus as he makes his way among the ruins, close to where the dancer has been performing.

297. MS tracking out in front of Oedipus, as he comes out from between two ruined walls and continues on his way. (Still on page 40)
298. MLS of Oedipus from behind as he goes through a ruined archway. (Still on page 40) Camera tracks after him as he reaches another ruined wall and goes round behind it.
299. MCU of a girl naked to the waist, standing amongst the ruins, motionless. (Production still on page 40) Camera tracks in on her face.
300. Slight high angle MCU of Oedipus who has stopped, looking at her. He clamps his knuckles to his mouth.
301. Reverse angle shot with Oedipus in CU, facing the girl who can just be seen behind him. He chews his knuckles, then turns and looks off-screen.
302. MCU of another milestone, showing the way to 'Thebes', at the roadside.
303. MCU of Oedipus, now on the road again, wearing his hat and pack, which he had abandoned in the previous sequence. He clenches his fist to his eyes and spins round once more, then sets off in the direction he is facing, away from camera.
304. Reverse angle shot of Oedipus. He suddenly tears the hat from his head with a furious gesture, then continues to walk along the road, camera tracking out in front of him. He stops, staring at the road ahead. Camera tracks away from him. Fade out.

Scene 26.

305. MS. Oedipus comes towards camera, having now divested himself of his hat, carrying a branch above his head to protect himself from the sun. (Still on page 73)
306. Reverse angle shot along the road: a cart appears round a bend with two figures in it, preceded by several soldiers. (Still on page 73)
307. Reverse angle shot of Oedipus. He comes towards camera and halts in MCU, peering along the road from under his branch.
308. Another shot of the little procession as it comes towards camera.
309. Low angle MCU of the chief occupant of the cart: Oedipus's father, with a flowing grey beard and a furious expression. A soldier stands on the cart behind him as it comes towards camera. (Still on page 74)
310. Resume on Oedipus staring along the road, his eyes wide.
311. MCU of another member of the cortège. It is the slave who abandoned Oedipus on the hillside so many years ago. He looks intently towards Oedipus off-screen. (Still on page 74)
312. Resume on Oedipus staring.
313. MLS of the cart. One of the soldiers tries to calm the horses as they leap up and down. The slave flicks the reins, urging them on.
314. Low angle MCU of Oedipus's father as he shouts out angrily. FATHER:⁴⁷
315. Resume on Oedipus. Without saying anything he shakes his head.
316. Resume on MLS of the cart, the horses leaping up and down.
317. Low angle MCU of the father. He shouts again. FATHER:⁴⁸
318. Resume on Oedipus. He shakes his head again, looking out from under his branch.
319. MCU of one of the soldiers as he draws his sword and comes towards camera. (Still on page 74)
320. Resume on Oedipus. He shakes his head again. Camera pans right, tilting down, as he suddenly throws his belongings down at the side of the road.
321. Reverse angle LS of the scene as Oedipus in the foreground picks up a large stone from the ditch at the roadside and hurls it at the advancing soldier.

The soldier falls. Oedipus turns and runs off up the road, camera tracking out in front of him, with another soldier in pursuit.

322. MCU of Oedipus running along the road, yelling at the top of his voice, camera tracking out in front of him. The other soldiers can be seen pursuing him, behind.

323. High angle LS of the road. Oedipus runs along, pursued by the soldiers, one further ahead than the rest. Camera pans left, losing the soldiers.

324. High angle LS showing Oedipus from behind as he runs off up the road, pursued by three soldiers.

325. MS, tracking out in front of Oedipus. He is beginning to get out of breath. The pursuing soldiers can be seen coming along the road in the background. Oedipus looks round and runs on.

326. Reverse angle MCU, following Oedipus from behind as he runs along, slower and slower.

327. Reverse shot, tracking out in front of Oedipus, gasping as he runs.

328. Another shot of him from behind. He continues to run, camera tracking after him. He looks back over his shoulder.

329. Another shot, tracking out in front of him. He pauses, looks back, gasping for breath.

330. MCU of him seen from the side. He puts his hand to his forehead and bows his head, gasping for breath.

331. Low angle MCU of Oedipus still gasping for breath. He looks up as one of the soldiers comes up off-screen, then suddenly grabs his sword and raises it. The soldier's arm comes into the shot as he wields his sword. Oedipus parries the blows; there is a loud clanging of their swords.

332. Low angle MS of the two men circling round each other, the sun shining brilliantly overhead. (Still on page 74)

333. Low angle MCU of Oedipus, camera panning with him as he circles round his opponent.

334. Back to MS. Oedipus dances backwards, still parrying the blows.

335. MCU of him holding up his sword as the soldier slashes at him off-screen. Suddenly he raises his sword and lunges forward with it.

336. Low angle MCU of the soldier, silhouetted against the blinding sun. Oedipus's sword catches him on the neck and he starts back, clutching at his throat. He falls, throwing up a hand covered in blood.

337. MCU, camera panning and tilting with him as he falls to the ground. His helmet rolls off.

338. MCU of Oedipus looking down at his victim and then off as another soldier approaches. He gives a great bellow. (Still on page 74)

339. MS of Oedipus. Camera pans right as he turns and runs off up the road.

340. LS of the road. The next pursuing soldier races past his dead comrade and on towards camera.

341. Another LS of the road. Oedipus appears in the distance, kicking up clouds of dust as he runs onwards. Two pursuing soldiers are strung out a long way behind.

342. MCU, tracking after Oedipus as he hurries on, exhausted, gasping for breath and looking back anxiously over his shoulder.

343. High angle LS of the road, camera tracking sideways with Oedipus as he runs along.

344. Resume on MCU of him from behind, camera tracking after him. He looks anxiously back over his shoulder several times. Camera halts. He moves away then turns round and races back towards camera, bellowing, his sword raised.

Camera tracks out in front of him.

345. LS of the approaching soldier. In the foreground, Oedipus runs towards him. The soldier pauses uncertainly.

346. Low angle MCU, tracking with Oedipus as he runs, bellowing, his sword raised.

347. MS: the two men meet.

348. A closer shot as they fight. A blinding sun obscures our vision but finally camera pans left as Oedipus draws back, then tilts down to show the soldier lying dead at his feet.

349. Low angle CU of Oedipus looking down at the soldier, his eyes wild, trembling. He backs away slightly.

350. High angle MS of the soldier lying on the ground. Oedipus moves away from him then camera pans right as he comes back across frame and runs back down the road, glancing behind him as he does so.

351. LS of the dead soldier lying in the road, as seen by Oedipus. Camera tracks slowly away from the body.

352. MCU, tracking with Oedipus, as he staggers along the road, gasping for breath. He suddenly stops and stares ahead.

353. MS of the third soldier running up the road towards him. Before reaching him, however, he falls exhausted to the ground.

354. Resume on MCU of Oedipus as he comes forward gasping, his sword over his shoulder, camera tracking out in front of him. He stops.

355. High angle MS of the soldier lying in the road. He makes an effort to get up.

356. A closer shot of Oedipus, gasping, holding his chest. Camera pans, tilting down, as he sinks down at the roadside.

357. Resume on the soldier. He puts his hand to his chest, gasping painfully.

358. MS of Oedipus seated at the roadside, holding up his sword, gasping.

359. MCU of the soldier gasping for breath, his hand, holding his sword, pressed to his chest. His face is obscured by a metal helmet. (Still on page 74)

360. Resume on Oedipus still breathing heavily. Suddenly he gets up with great determination and rushes off.

361. MS: camera pans with Oedipus as he rushes along the road towards the soldier, who barely has time to get off his knees. Again their fight is obscured by the blinding sun. We catch a glimpse of Oedipus sitting astride him, his hands at his throat. Finally the soldier lies back, dead. Oedipus gets up.

362. Low angle CU of Oedipus's face as he rises, looking down at the dead soldier. He looks up at the sky.

363. High angle MCU of the soldier, lying dead on the ground, his sword beside him.*

364. MCU of Oedipus from behind. He stands in the middle of the road, his arms outstretched, then camera tilts down with him as he falls to the ground.

365. High angle CU of Oedipus lying on the ground, gasping for breath. Camera follows his faces as he tosses his head from side to side. Suddenly he hears a noise off and looks around.

366. MS of Oedipus, the dead soldier lying in front of him. He leaps to his feet and runs off up the road, going out of frame to the left. (Still on page 74)

367. MCU, tracking out in front of Oedipus as he runs back up the road again, gasping for breath, holding up his heavy sword. He looks round.

368. MLS of what he sees. Camera tracks away from the figure of the dead

* End of reel two, 600 metres approximately.

soldier lying in the road.

369. LS of Oedipus. Camera pans briefly right as he runs away along the road, into the distance.

370. MLS of the stationary cart, the soldier whom Oedipus wounded first sitting on the ground just in front of it. Oedipus's approaching steps are heard off.

371. LS of Oedipus as he comes into view over a rise in the ground, running along the road. Camera tracks out in front of him as he comes into MCU.

372. MLS tracking towards the cart as seen by him. As we draw near, Oedipus's father stands up in the cart and puts on his tall golden crown.

373. Resume on MCU of Oedipus, tracking out in front of him. (Still on page 74)

374. Low angle MS of his father standing in the cart, the crown on his head, gazing furiously down at Oedipus off-screen. Camera tracks in towards him.

375. MCU of Oedipus facing him. He bursts out laughing.

376. Low angle shot of the cart, the horses nearest camera, Oedipus's father standing on the cart in the background. (Still on page 75)

377. MCU of the one remaining soldier. Camera tilts up with him as he gets to his feet, gasping. He raises his sword and staggers painfully forwards. (Still on page 75)

378. CU of Oedipus watching warily.

379. MS of the soldier standing with his sword raised. Camera tracks out briefly.

380. MCU of Oedipus watching. Suddenly he throws down his sword and camera tilts down with him as he grabs a large stone up off the ground. Camera tilts up again as he throws the stone at the soldier off-screen.

381. MCU of the soldier's legs; the stone hits him on the knee and he sinks to the ground with an agonized cry. (Still on page 75) Camera tilts down with him.

382. MCU of the slave sitting on the cart. Camera pans with him as he suddenly leaps past Oedipus's father and runs off down the road.

383. Low angle MS of the slave as he appears over a rise in the ground, running away. (Still on page 75)

384. LS: camera pans briefly left as the slave runs across and takes cover behind some rocks, somewhere near the roadside.

385. MCU of the slave looking out fearfully from behind his rock.

386. Low angle MCU of Oedipus's father standing on the cart, looking down furiously at Oedipus off-screen. We hear Oedipus laughing.

387. High angle MCU of Oedipus. He laughs, then suddenly moves out of shot.

388. High angle MLS of Oedipus. Camera pans right with him as he runs towards his father, his sword raised, and slashes out at him. (Still on page 75)

389. MCU of Oedipus grappling with his father off-screen. Camera tilts up with him as he leaps up onto the cart.

390. MCU of his father, who stumbles and falls backwards. Camera tilts down and Oedipus's back obscures him from view.

391. High angle MS of the two of them; Oedipus stands over his father in the cart and raises his sword. (Still on page 75)

392. Low angle CU of Oedipus, the blinding sun behind him. He raises his sword and plunges it down with both hands. (Still on page 75) There is a groan from his father. He plunges it down again and pulls it out, and stands gasping.

393. High angle MCU of his father lying in the cart, his head thrown back, mouth open. (Still on page 75)

394. Resume on low angle CU of Oedipus. He gazes down at his father, then

turns and disappears from shot.

395. MLS of the cart. Oedipus gets down and walks slowly away, camera panning left with him. Sinister music: a drum and flute. Oedipus goes up to the last remaining soldier who is kneeling gasping on the ground. He kicks him over with his foot.

396. High angle MS of the soldier as he sprawls on the ground, his face obscured by his metal helmet.

397. High angle MCU of Oedipus. He raises his sword and strikes.

398. MCU of him from the front as he plunges the sword downwards, his eyes closed. He pauses for a moment, then lets the sword fall to the ground.

399. High angle CU of the soldier's head encased in the helmet. Oedipus's hands appear in shot and remove the helmet.

400. MS of Oedipus kneeling over the body. He puts the helmet on his own head, then picks up the sword and gets up, camera tilting with him.

401. High angle MS. Camera pans right with Oedipus as he walks slowly past the cart containing his dead father and off down the road.

402. MCU, tracking sideways with Oedipus as he walks along the road, wearing the helmet. The sun shines blindingly just above the horizon. Oedipus moves out of shot. Fade out.

Scene 27.

403. High angle LS of the road. In the distance, a long procession of animals and men is coming slowly towards camera.

404. LS of Oedipus standing in the road. He has halted, looking at the cortège off-screen. He walks on.

405. MCU of Oedipus. He takes another step forward and stops. The loose plates on his helmet clang loudly.

406. A closer LS of the procession of people coming up the road towards camera.

407. CU of Oedipus as he takes another step forward again, his helmet clanking.

408. High angle MLS of the procession of people coming towards camera.

409. CU of Oedipus. He walks forward.

410. MCU tracking with Oedipus from behind as he walks past the procession. There are people pushing a hand-cart, others carrying their belongings on their backs, etc.

411. MLS of the procession. Oedipus walks past in the opposite direction. Sounds of sobs and lamentations. Camera pans slowly left with Oedipus, then halts. We hear the crowd chanting.

412. MCU of Oedipus who has halted, his face still covered by the helmet. Part of the procession can be seen winding up the road in the background. Camera tracks out in front of him as he moves forward again, his helmet clanking. He enters an enclosure where a crowd of people is gathered, standing in small groups.

413. General shot of the scene, the people standing around, apparently aimless. Sound of singing and a flute.

414. MCU, tracking with Oedipus, as he walks past the people.

415. MLS of part of the crowd; some of them turn to watch him.

416. Resume on Oedipus. Camera tracks out and pans left as he walks on, then tracks in again as he halts and raises the face plate on his helmet.

417. High angle MCU of a youth and a small girl squatting on the ground, looking up at him. (Still on page 76)

418. MCU of Oedipus, the face plate on his helmet raised. He addresses the

youth off-screen. OEDIPUS :⁴⁹ Camera pans left as he walks towards the youth.

419. Resume on the youth and the little girl as the former replies. YOUTH :⁵⁰

420. Resume on Oedipus. OEDIPUS :⁵¹

421. Reverse angle shot, Oedipus standing back to camera in the foreground. In the background, the youth rises to his feet with the small girl and says to Oedipus :⁵² He bends down, picks up his hat and comes towards Oedipus. Camera pans right, then tracks after them as the youth takes Oedipus by the hand and leads him away out of the refugee camp. (Still on page 76)

422. LS of the deserted countryside near the camp. The youth leads Oedipus towards camera, which pans left as they round a bend and then halt, looking off-screen.

423. LS of what they see: a deserted countryside with barren hills beyond. Music.

424. MCU of the two of them looking across at the hills off-screen. Snow-capped mountains can be seen in the background.

425. LS, panning left with the two of them as they continue to walk, then halt beside a ruined wall. A flute comes in with the music.

426. MLS of what they see: an aged figure, standing against a ruined wall, playing a flute. Camera moves slightly, hand held.

427. MCU of Oedipus and the youth. Camera tracks out in front of them as they walk slowly forwards, staring at the figure off-screen. (Still on page 76) They halt and camera tracks out and tilts down slightly as Oedipus sinks to his knees beside the youth.

428. Reverse angle MLS of the figure standing beside the ruined wall. Camera moves slightly to the right. A youth wearing a loin-cloth is lying on the ground in the centre of shot, listening while the old man plays. (Still on page 76)

427. High angle MS of Oedipus kneeling on the ground. The youth puts a hand on his shoulder and whispers :⁵³

430. MCU of Oedipus staring at Tiresias off-screen, the youth's arm on the right of shot.

TITLE : *The others, your fellow citizens and your brothers, suffer, weep, seek salvation together . . . And you, you are here, blind and alone, and you sing . . .*

SECOND TITLE : *How I wish that I were you! You sing of that which is beyond destiny.*

431. Resume on Oedipus still looking at the old man off-screen. He lowers his eyes, then looks up again.

432. MCU of Tiresias standing in front of some reeds, playing his reed flute, gazing sightlessly towards camera.

433. MCU of Oedipus still watching. Camera tilts up and tracks left as the youth takes him by the hand and leads him off past Tiresias, Oedipus gazing at the prophet over his shoulder as he goes.

434. MCU of Tiresias in profile, quietly playing his flute, his eyes closed. The music ends. (Still on page 76)

435. LS of the walls of Thebes at sunset.

436. A closer shot of the same scene. A woman's voice is heard singing off.

437. Another similar shot of another part of the town.

438. LS of a barren mountainside with blue sky behind.

439. LS of some cliffs rising above a river bed in which there are a few sparse trees.

440. CU, tracking with Oedipus's head as he walks along. Camera pans left as it tracks to show the youth leading him by the hand. They halt and the youth

points upwards. YOUTH: *There!*

441. Resume on a slightly longer shot of the cliffs and the dried up river bed. The youth continues off: *Up there is the cause of our town's misery.*

442. MCU of the youth as he turns towards Oedipus. YOUTH: *Just think. It came from the bottom of an abyss, no one knows where . . . Everything was going so well . . . Who could have imagined . . .* The chanting heard previously continues.

443. MCU of Oedipus in profile, his face hidden by his helmet, as the youth continues off. YOUTH: *No one has the courage to throw it back into its abyss. Even though he who does is to become the husband of Jocasta . . .* Oedipus turns slowly towards camera, revealing his face.

444. Resume on the youth as he continues. YOUTH: . . . *the Queen of Thebes.*

445. Resume on Oedipus. He turns his head away again. The chanting continues off. He turns slowly round to face in the opposite direction and starts to walk.

446. MCU of Oedipus, tracking out in front of him as he starts to move like a sleep-walker, his eyes closed, the youth following anxiously. Camera pans right, tilting up to show him from behind as he suddenly starts to run off up the hillside. The youth shouts to him. YOUTH off: *Where are you going?* He runs into frame after Oedipus.

447. High angle MS tracking and panning with the two of them as the youth pursues Oedipus up the hillside. YOUTH:⁵⁴ Camera pans away to the right, losing the youth, as Oedipus runs on.

448. MCU of the youth looking out over the top of a rock, waving his arm and shouting: YOUTH: *Come here! What are you doing?*

449. Low angle LS of the barren mountainside. In the centre of shot, Oedipus runs up it, his helmet clanking as he goes.

450. High angle MS, panning right with the youth as he pursues him.

451. MS of the youth as he crouches down behind a rock to watch.

452. MS of Oedipus from behind as he walks slowly towards a figure sitting on the barren rock in the background. He halts.

453. MCU of the youth peering up anxiously over the top of his rock.

454. MS of the Sphinx: a strange figure wearing a large mask which covers the whole of the top half of its body, sitting on the barren hillside.

455. MCU of Oedipus, staring back at it.

456. MCU of the Sphinx as it raises its head and speaks from behind the mask. SPHINX: *There is an enigma in your life. What is it?*

457. CU of Oedipus. He draws his sword. OEDIPUS: *I don't know. I don't want to know.*

458. MS, tracking after Oedipus, with hand-held camera, as he rushes towards the Sphinx, sword raised, his helmet clanking loudly.

459. MS of the Sphinx. Camera tilts up as it rises to its feet. SPHINX: *It's useless . . .*

460. MCU of the youth ducking down behind his rock.

461. Low angle MCU of the Sphinx as Oedipus comes up to it, seen from behind. (Still on page 77) The creature pushes him contemptuously aside. OEDIPUS: *I don't want to see you . . .*

462. High angle CU of Oedipus as he lunges forward at the Sphinx. OEDIPUS: *I don't want to see you — I don't . . .*

463. Resume on low angle MCU as Oedipus circles round the Sphinx, lunging at it. OEDIPUS: . . . *want to hear you.* SPHINX: *It's useless, it's useless. The abyss you are pushing me into is within yourself.* Oedipus lunges forward again,

- his head disappearing from shot as he does so. He finds his mark and the Sphinx sinks down out of shot also. Camera holds on the blue sky and white clouds above. Oedipus's helmet reappears momentarily in frame.
464. MS of the youth peering anxiously out from behind his rock, his face almost obscured.
465. Reverse angle LS of what he sees: Oedipus coming slowly towards camera, slinging his sword back over his shoulder.
466. MS of the youth as he springs up from behind his rock. Camera pans right, tilting up slightly, as he runs up and looks over the edge of the abyss in the background. Then he turns and starts ringing the bell he carries and jumping up and down, waving his arms and shouting for joy.
467. General shot of the inhabitants of Thebes in the refugee camp, all turning as they hear the youth shouting. YOUTH off: *The Sphinx is dead!*
468. CU of the youth standing on the cliff-top, jumping up and down and shouting.
469. Resume on general shot of the Thebans. They all turn and start to run off, shouting and cheering joyfully. Camera pans slightly right as they go. YOUTH off: *Come, come! The Sphinx!*
470. High angle LS of the Thebans streaming out of the refugee camp, cheering.
471. Resume on CU of the youth as he leaps up and down, cheering. He claps his hat, which he has been waving in his hands, back on his head.
472. High angle very LS of the Thebans streaming along at the bottom of the cliff.
473. Low angle LS of the youth still leaping up and down on the cliff-top. Camera pans left as he turns and runs down the hill again.
474. LS of the barren mountainside seen earlier, as the youth plunges down, rushing towards camera.
475. MS, panning and tracking to and fro with the youth as he rushes backwards and forwards outside the city, cheering and shouting. The walls of Thebes can be seen in the background. YOUTH: *The Sphinx is dead! The Sphinx is no more!* Joyful music. Sound of a jew's harp.
476. LS: camera pans right with the crowd of Thebans as they rush joyfully down the hillside, shouting and cheering. They reach Oedipus and catch him joyfully by the arm, leading him towards camera, as another crowd of citizens appears in the background.
477. LS of the city of Thebes. There is joyful chanting as a crowd of citizens, having emerged from the gates, moves towards camera in the distance. Camera pans left to show more Thebans emerging from other gates in the distance.
478. A similar shot with the same panning movement as the joyful citizens come nearer.
479. High angle LS with joyful music as the crowd of Thebans bring Oedipus towards camera.
480. MLS of the people streaming out of the city, filing towards camera and off to the right.
481. MLS of more of them running across frame to the left.
482. Resume on high angle LS of the joyful crowd leading Oedipus towards the city.
483. Low angle MS of a procession emerging from the gates of Thebes, in the centre of which sits Queen Jocasta in her chariot. The youth rushes ahead of the procession, followed by a crowd of children. He comes towards camera, shouting joyfully to Oedipus off-screen. YOUTH:⁵⁵ He runs out of frame in the

foreground.

484. High angle LS of the crowd approaching from the opposite direction with Oedipus in the centre. The youth appears from the foreground, leaping down the slope towards Oedipus, shouting. YOUTH: ⁵⁶ He takes him by the hand and leads him towards camera.

485. Reverse angle MS of Jocasta coming towards camera with her retinue, being wheeled in a kind of ornamental wheelbarrow.

486. MCU of the approaching crowd. They stop. The youth grabs Oedipus by the arm and, looking off joyfully, exclaims: YOUTH: *There she is!*

487. MS of Jocasta approaching in her chariot. (Still on page 77)

488. MCU of Oedipus staring at her, transfixed. Sound of a flute and drums.

489. MS of Jocasta halted in her chariot with the crowd around her.

490. A closer shot of the same. The sound of the flute continues.

491. Resume on Oedipus gazing across at her silently.

492. MCU of Creon staring at him from under a large crown. (Still on page 78)

493. CU of Jocasta also staring at him, also wearing a crown. (Still on page 78)

494. CU of Oedipus. He raises his head slightly as he steadily looks back at Jocasta.

495. Resume on Jocasta. She smiles slightly.

496. Resume on Oedipus, a look of recognition in his eye. (Still on page 78) He lowers his head again.

497. MCU of Jocasta, her crown topped by a vast straw hat. The attendant youths lift her chariot and start to turn it round.

498. High angle shot of the crowd, Oedipus three-quarters back to camera on the right. In the centre of shot, Jocasta is turned on her chariot before being wheeled back towards the city of Thebes.

499. Low angle MCU of Creon, watching. His crown bears two vast wings. His attendants turn and carry him on his litter away from camera.

500. CU of Oedipus's face, looking after Jocasta. He moves out of frame, followed by the crowd as it surges after the little procession.

501. High angle LS of the crowd moving slowly towards the city.

502. A closer shot of the crowd with Creon in back view in the centre. Camera tracks after them. Loud festive music.

Scene 28.

503. Low angle shot of the bridal chamber in the palace with a vast canopied bed in the background.

Scene 29.

504. General shot of the celebrations in the city. Crowds of people dance past camera, joyfully waving branches of greenery.

505. General shot of seated musicians with the crowd standing around them, clapping their hands and waving garlands of flowers.

506. High angle shot of the crowd around the musicians clapping their hands, the walls and towers of Thebes in the background. Camera moves slowly left and a large flaming torch comes into view in the foreground.

507. A similar shot from a different angle. Camera tracks in on the torch bearer, then on the torch itself.

508. Very LS of the city at dusk from outside. The camera pans slowly along to show torches glimmering everywhere behind the walls. Joyful music continues loudly.

509. Low angle shot of the bridal chamber from outside, a light burning in the window. The music continues off.

Scene 30.

510. LS of the darkened bedchamber. In the background the figures of Jocasta and Oedipus can just be seen on the vast bed.
511. MCU of Jocasta fixing her hair in a hand mirror, which obscures her face. She lowers the hand mirror and stares at Oedipus, off-screen in the darkness.
512. Reverse angle MCU of Oedipus sitting naked at the opposite end of the bed, looking at Jocasta.
513. Resume on Jocasta. She unbraids her hair and lets it hang loose. (Still on page 78)
514. Resume on Oedipus staring at her silently (Still on page 78)
515. Resume on Jocasta. She looks at him still without speaking.
516. Resume on Oedipus. He moves slowly forwards.
517. Back to Jocasta watching him.
518. Resume on Oedipus as he comes closer.
519. MCU of Jocasta; Oedipus's profile comes into frame on the right. He puts up a hand and tenderly strokes her cheek, then leans slowly towards her. Camera begins to tilt down as he draws her down on the bed.
520. Resume on LS of the room. Oedipus's naked back can be seen faintly moving in the gloom on the vast bed in the background.*

Scene 31.

521. High angle MCU of a body, blistered and disfigured with plague, lying in the sun.
522. MS of the body lying on the ground outside the walls of Thebes. A baby is crawling around beside it, crying. Camera tracks in on the body, tilting down. (Still on page 79)
523. Low angle shot of birds of prey circling in the sky, squawking.
524. MCU of another body, covered only in a loin-cloth. Camera tracks sideways and tilts up to show other bodies lying around on the bare stones.
525. High angle LS of a couple more bodies lying on the ground, a couple of crows nearby, squawking.
526. High angle shot of another body with more crows nearby.
527. Low angle shot of the sky; camera tilts down to show many more bodies scattered around on the ground, all covered only in a white loin-cloth.
528. High angle MCU of another body, scabbed and scarred.
529. Low angle LS of the towers of Thebes. Camera tilts down slightly.
530. Another low angle shot; camera tilts up between two walls to show a tower rising up into the sky.
531. MLS of a gateway in a broken stone wall with bodies lying in the foreground.
532. MS of a gateway, a body lying on the other side.
533. Low angle LS: camera pans slowly right across the buildings of the town, apparently completely deserted. A voice is heard chanting faintly off.
534. Low angle shot of more houses with the blue sky behind.
535. Another similar LS.
536. Another shot through a gateway: a body lies in the centre of shot. A couple of donkeys and a woman shrouded in black are the only signs of life.
537. High angle MS of another body lying in the sun. Camera pans left, tilting up over the façade of a courtyard to show a figure looking down from a gallery above.
538. Low angle shot of crows and vultures circling in the sky.

* End of reel three, 450 metres approximately.

539. MCU of another body, fully dressed, lying on the ground, disfigured by plague. The legs of another man come into shot as he leans down and removes a gold pendant from around the body's neck. He goes off.
540. MLS of two bodies hanging from gibbets with the walls of the town in the background.
541. Another low angle shot of crows circling in the sky.
542. MS of a man sitting by a well, dipping his hands in the water. A youth, sitting back to camera in the foreground, turns his head towards us. They are both disfigured by plague.
543. Another shot, somewhere in the city, with several bodies lying on the ground.
544. High angle MCU of another body.
- Scene 32.*
545. LS of the gateway to the palace. Several people stand on either side of a figure wearing long white robes and a gold crown. Camera tracks slowly in as we hear the sound of chanting off.
546. High angle MLS of a crowd of priests, their heads garlanded in shells, coming towards camera, which tracks slightly to the right as they walk. One of them addresses the white-robed figure — Oedipus — off-screen. (Still on page 79) PRIEST:⁵⁷
547. MCU of the priest speaking in front of his companions, camera tracking out as he continues to walk. PRIEST:⁵⁸
548. MLS of Oedipus standing at the entrance to the palace, his soldiers around him. Camera tracks in on them slowly while the priest continues off. PRIEST:⁵⁹
549. CU of the priest, camera continuing to track out in front of him. PRIEST:⁶⁰ He halts as he continues:⁶¹
550. MCU of Oedipus in profile, the soldiers ranged on either side of him. PRIEST off:⁶² As he continues, camera tilts up to show the sky with the sun beating down, then pans right round to show the window of the royal bed-chamber at the top of a tower. (Still on page 80)
551. MS of Jocasta sitting three-quarters back to camera, looking out of the window.
552. CU of Jocasta facing camera as she sits staring out of the window.
553. Low angle MCU of Oedipus standing in front of the palace gateway, looking down at the priest. He glances up at the window, off-screen. (Still on page 80)
554. CU of the leading priest with the others behind him, now standing silently.
555. Resume on low angle MCU of Oedipus. Camera tracks in slightly as he speaks. OEDIPUS:^{63, 64}
556. High angle MS of the priests watching him in silence. OEDIPUS off:⁶⁵
557. CU of a young priest watching silently. OEDIPUS:⁶⁶ Camera tilts up to show another young priest standing behind him.
558. CU of another priest watching. OEDIPUS off:⁶⁷
559. CU of another priest watching with a sceptical expression. OEDIPUS:⁶⁸
560. High angle MCU of two very young priests, listening. OEDIPUS off:⁶⁹ Camera pans left to another priest.
561. CU of the original spokesman, listening in silence.
562. Low angle MCU of Oedipus. OEDIPUS:⁷⁰ Camera tracks in on him. Fade out.
- Scene 33.*
563. MS of several people standing around near the walls of the town. The

youth who took Oedipus to the Sphinx runs up in the background, ringing his bell. (Still on page 80) He comes forward through an archway in the foreground, camera panning right with him. He halts and looks up at Oedipus off-screen.

564. Low angle MS of Oedipus standing flanked by his soldiers.

565. Resume on the youth. Camera tilts down and pans right again as he jumps down a step and goes across to the priests. YOUTH:⁷¹

566. Low angle shot of the façade of palace, showing the window of the bridal chamber. YOUTH off: *He's already here, at the town gate.*

567. CU of Jocasta sitting at the window of the bridal chamber, looking out.

568. Low angle MCU of another woman looking out through a small window in a wall.

569. MS of another girl looking out through a similar window.

570. Another similar shot. Camera tracks in on another girl looking out of a window.

571. MCU of Oedipus. He moves forward slightly, looking off.

TITLE:⁷²

572. MS of the archway leading out of the square in front of the courtyard. In the background, Creon runs up, followed by some soldiers.

573. Resume on MCU of Oedipus. He leans forward and shouts. OEDIPUS:⁷³

574. MS of the archway as Creon comes through, wearing a blue robe and broad-brimmed straw hat. CREON:⁷⁴

575. Low angle MS of Creon as he enters the square in front of the palace. Camera pans left as he walks across to the palace entrance where Oedipus is standing, flanked by his soldiers. (Still on page 80) CREON:⁷⁵ OEDIPUS:⁷⁶

576. High angle MCU of Creon. Camera tracks out slightly as he takes a step towards Oedipus and stops. CREON:⁷⁷

577. MCU of Oedipus facing camera. OEDIPUS:⁷⁸

578. MCU of Creon as he replies. CREON:⁷⁹

579. CU of Oedipus. OEDIPUS:⁸⁰

580. MCU of Creon. CREON:⁸¹

581. Resume on Oedipus. OEDIPUS:⁸²

582. Resume on Creon; his head is bowed and the brim of his hat covers his face. His face is revealed as he looks up again. CREON:⁸³

583. CU of Oedipus. OEDIPUS:⁸⁴ CREON off:⁸⁵

584. Resume on Creon. CREON:⁸⁶

585. Resume on Oedipus. OEDIPUS:⁸⁷

586. MCU of Creon as he replies. Camera zooms in on his face. CREON:⁸⁸, ⁸⁹

587. Resume on Oedipus. He stares at Creon for a moment and then asks: OEDIPUS:⁹⁰

588. MCU of Creon. CREON:⁹¹ Camera zooms in on him again as he continues, after a pause:⁹²

589. Resume on Oedipus. OEDIPUS:⁹³

590. MCU of Creon. Camera pans left as he steps towards Oedipus. CREON:⁹⁴ OEDIPUS:⁹⁵

591. MS of Oedipus standing in front of his soldiers. He bursts out: OEDIPUS:⁹⁶ Creon replies. CREON off: *Yes.*⁹⁷

592. Low angle shot of the façade of the palace, with the window of the royal bedchamber. OEDIPUS off:⁹⁸

593. CU of Jocasta listening in the bridal chamber, as Creon continues. CREON off: *It is said that he was attacked by bandits and that a group of them killed him, not just one.* OEDIPUS off:⁹⁹ CREON off:¹⁰⁰ Fade out on Jocasta's face.

Scene 34.

594. Low angle MLS of Oedipus standing at the entrance to the palace flanked by his soldiers. OEDIPUS: *Here is my decision.*^{101, 102, 103}

595. Low angle shot of the window to the bedchamber.

596. CU of Jocasta listening. OEDIPUS off:¹⁰⁴

597. Resume on low angle MS of the scene. Oedipus continues. OEDIPUS:¹⁰⁵

598. As he finishes, cut to CU of Jocasta. She smiles on hearing his words.

599. CU of Oedipus looking up towards Jocasta's window, off-screen.

600. Shot of the bridal chamber at night, the bed in the centre. No one is to be seen.

601. High angle CU of Jocasta's head as she lies back on the bed, breathing heavily.

602. MCU of Oedipus standing at the end of the bed, looking down at her.

603. MS of the same scene. Camera pans left as Oedipus comes round the end of the bed towards her.

604. Resume on Jocasta looking up at him. (Still on page 80) Camera starts to turn above her.

605. Low angle MCU of Oedipus looking down at her. (Still on page 80)

606. MS of the bed. In the background Oedipus stands over Jocasta. She lies back; he leans over her and kisses her, then throws himself on her passionately.

607. High angle CU of the gold ornament fastening Jocasta's robe. Oedipus' hands appear as he feverishly undoes the clasp. (Still on page 80) OEDIPUS in a whisper off: *My love . . .*

608. MS tracking out in front of a funeral procession. (Still on page 80) A woman's voice sings a mournful song off. Camera pans round as it tracks to follow the cortège from behind. Several pall-bearers are carrying a corpse on a stretcher, wrapped in brightly coloured rags. They go off through one of the gates of the town.

609. LS tracking slowly sideways with a whole procession containing several similarly wrapped bodies as they are carried along outside the walls of the town.

610. Another similar shot, camera tracking sideways, as the bodies are carried along followed by mourning women.

611. MCU tracking after one of the stretchers as it is carried along.

612. MS tracking with the mourning women as they accompany it.

613. General shot tracking along with the scattered procession.

614. MS of several bodies being carried along outside the walls of the city, rugged hills rising up behind. There is loud chanting from the mourners. Camera pans left as it tracks and the mourners move away from it.

615. MCU tracking sideways with one of the bodies as it is carried along on a stretcher.

616. LS of the procession as it arrives by a large pit dug in the earth. Clouds of smoke are rising from it. Camera tracks in on the mourners as they halt and start to lay down the bodies.

617. MS panning and tilting with one of the bodies as it is lowered to the ground on its stretcher. Flames rise out of the pit behind.

618. Similar shot of another body being brought to the edge of the pit and laid down. Camera pans as most of the mourners kneel down while two of them pick up the body and carry it towards the edge of the pit. (Still on page 113) They throw the body over the edge and camera pans as they move back again.

619. MS of another body being laid on the ground on its stretcher. (Still on

page 113) Camera tracks in on the scene as the flames crackle and roar furiously in the background. The chanting continues off.

620. Resume on low angle MLS of the palace gateway, Oedipus standing as before, flanked by his soldiers. The chanting dies away.

621. A longer shot of the same scene with the notables of Thebes gathered on either side in blue robes.

622. MS of two guards in elaborate head-dresses and another figure in a broad-brimmed hat, by the archway leading into the palace courtyard. They suddenly sink to their knees.

623. Resume on LS of the palace entrance. The notables also fall to their knees, as do the soldiers, leaving only Oedipus standing in the doorway. Camera tracks in on him.

624. Resume on the entrance to the square in front of the palace. The boy-messenger has appeared, leading the blind Tiresias by the arm. He rings his bell. Camera tracks out in front of them and the people fall to their knees, then rise again as they pass.

625. MLS tracking in on Oedipus as the notables and soldiers rise to their feet on either side of him.

626. High angle MCU tracking out in front of the youth and Tiresias. (Still on page 114) They stop and Tiresias mops his forehead while the youth looks up at Oedipus off-screen.

627. Low angle MCU of Oedipus as he looks down at Tiresias.

628. High angle MCU tracking sideways with the youth as, holding his hat over Tiresias's forehead to protect him from the sun, he leads him along. Camera tilts down as Tiresias suddenly falls. He crawls along and sits down in the shade of some palm branches.

629. MCU of Oedipus watching.

TITLE: Tiresias! You are here. I have summoned you and from you I shall know everything.

630. High angle MS of Tiresias seated under a small tree with the youth standing behind him and a flock of sheep in the background. TIRESIAS :¹⁰⁶, ¹⁰⁷

631. Low angle MS of Oedipus standing in front of the door of the palace. OEDIPUS :¹⁰⁸

632. High angle MCU of Tiresias as he continues. TIRESIAS :¹⁰⁹

633. Low angle CU of Oedipus. OEDIPUS :¹¹⁰

634. Resume on Tiresias. TIRESIAS :¹¹¹ He moves aside into the shade of the tree. OEDIPUS off :¹¹²

635. Resume on CU of Oedipus. OEDIPUS :¹¹³ TIRESIAS off :¹¹⁴

636. Resume on Tiresias. TIRESIAS :¹¹⁵

637. Resume on Oedipus. OEDIPUS :¹¹⁶

638. High angle CU of Tiresias. He nods faintly as Oedipus continues off. OEDIPUS off :¹¹⁷ TIRESIAS :¹¹⁸

639. CU of Oedipus. OEDIPUS angrily :¹¹⁹

640. Resume on high angle CU of Tiresias. TIRESIAS :¹²⁰

641. Resume on Oedipus. OEDIPUS :¹²¹

642. High angle CU of Tiresias. TIRESIAS :¹²²

643. MS of Oedipus. Camera tracks in as he stands and shouts at Tiresias angrily. OEDIPUS :¹²³

644. High angle MCU of Tiresias. He rises to his feet saying: TIRESIAS :¹²⁴ Camera tilts up with him.

645. Resume on low angle CU of Oedipus. TIRESIAS continues off :¹²⁵

646. Low angle shot of the façade of the palace with the window of the royal bedchamber on the right. TIRESIAS off: ¹²⁶
647. CU of Jocasta listening. TIRESIAS: ¹²⁷, ¹²⁸ As he continues, Jocasta looks away, pressing her hand to her mouth. Then she turns back towards the window again, with a proud smile.
648. High angle CU of Tiresias sitting under the tree. TIRESIAS: ¹²⁹
649. Low angle MCU of Oedipus who replies angrily. OEDIPUS: ¹³⁰
650. High angle CU of Tiresias. TIRESIAS: ¹³¹
651. Low angle MCU of Oedipus. OEDIPUS: ¹³² TIRESIAS off: ¹³³
652. High angle CU of Tiresias. TIRESIAS: ¹³⁴
653. Resume on CU of Oedipus. Camera tracks back as he replies. OEDIPUS: ¹³⁵
654. High angle MCU of the youth, who lowers his head sadly as Oedipus continues off. OEDIPUS: ¹³⁶ The youth puts his hat under his arm, picks up his flute and starts to play. ¹³⁷
655. Low angle MCU of Oedipus. Camera tracks slowly in on him. OEDIPUS: ¹³⁸
656. High angle extreme CU of Tiresias. TIRESIAS: ¹³⁹ The youth's flute sounds mournfully off as he continues.
657. MCU of Oedipus. Camera tracks in on him. TIRESIAS off: ¹⁴⁰, ¹⁴¹
658. High angle CU of Tiresias. TIRESIAS: ¹⁴²
659. Low angle MCU of Oedipus. He starts forward angrily and snatches off his crown.
660. Low angle MS of Oedipus. Several youths run forward; one of them takes his crown, while another takes his false beard which he snatches off and hands to him. OEDIPUS: ¹⁴³
661. High angle MCU of the boy-messenger. He starts in alarm and stops playing his flute. OEDIPUS off: ¹⁴⁴
662. Low angle MCU, tracking and panning with Oedipus as he rushes down the steps, biting his knuckles with rage. OEDIPUS: ¹⁴⁵ He seizes Tiresias by the shoulders and shouts: ¹⁴⁶ He throws Tiresias to the ground. TIRESIAS: ¹⁴⁷ OEDIPUS picking him up and shoving him on again: ¹⁴⁸ He throws Tiresias to the ground again. The youth picks him up and, looking back over his shoulder in alarm, gently guides Tiresias away. Tiresias stops and turns.
663. MCU of Tiresias with the youth standing beside him. TIRESIAS: ¹⁴⁹
664. MCU of Oedipus standing facing him, the guards and notables in front of the palace doorway in the background. (Still on page 114) OEDIPUS: ¹⁵⁰
665. CU of Tiresias. TIRESIAS to the boy: ¹⁵¹ He turns and walks away. OEDIPUS off: ¹⁵²
666. Resume on MCU of Oedipus. OEDIPUS: ¹⁵³
667. MS of Tiresias as he passes out of the courtyard, past the prostrate guards. He turns back and says: TIRESIAS: ¹⁵⁴
668. CU of Tiresias. TIRESIAS: ¹⁵⁵, ¹⁵⁶
669. MCU of Oedipus. He turns with an expression of disgust and walks away as Tiresias continues off: TIRESIAS: ¹⁵⁷
670. CU of Tiresias. TIRESIAS: ¹⁵⁸, ¹⁵⁹, ¹⁶⁰
671. Low angle shot of the sun blazing down from the sky. Camera pans slowly round across the towers of the palace and holds on Jocasta's window. TIRESIAS off: ¹⁶¹
672. CU of Jocasta listening, in the bridal chamber. She throws her head back and gives a scornful exclamation. She gets up.
673. Reverse angle shot with the window in the background. Camera pans with Jocasta as she gets up and runs out of the room, followed by her women. They all laugh.

Scene 35.

674. LS of the palace garden. Camera tracks right, following Jocasta and her women as they run across the garden. They halt in a group in the centre, laughing.*

675. LS of a corridor in the palace leading to the entrance. Several soldiers stand to attention as Oedipus appears round a corner at the far end.

676. Low angle MCU of Oedipus. He looks up as a woman's voice is heard singing off. Camera tracks out in front of him as he walks along the corridor, then pans to follow him from behind as his eyes widen and he suddenly rushes off into the dimness.

677. High angle MS of the gateway leading into the garden. Camera tracks to the right as Oedipus comes through the gateway and halts looking at Jocasta who is seated, singing, with her women around her, some way away. He walks towards her; she rises and leaves her women, coming back towards camera with him. (Still on page 115)

678. MCU of the two of them; camera tracks out, then pans left as Oedipus, holding her by the arm, leads her out through the gateway.

679. MLS. Oedipus and Jocasta advance towards camera along a corridor beside the atrium. Suddenly Oedipus seizes her and presses her back against a pillar, kissing her passionately.

680. MCU of Jocasta pressed up against the pillar. Oedipus, in back view, kisses her again and again. Then he seizes her by the arm and camera pans left as he hurries her off up the corridor.

681. MCU. Camera pans left as he throws himself on her again, pressing her up against the wall. He kisses her furiously, then turns and leads her towards camera.

682. MS of the two of them from behind. Camera tracks in on them as they halt at the entrance to the bedchamber. Jocasta turns Oedipus round, takes his head in her hands and kisses him.

683. A closer shot of the two of them. Jocasta, in back view in the foreground, kisses Oedipus tenderly, then draws away. He looks at her and puts his hand up to her cheek.

684. Reverse angle shot, Oedipus in back view, his hand to Jocasta's cheek. He turns and looks toward camera.

685. Reverse angle shot as previously. Oedipus turns, puts his arm round his wife and guides her past the curtain into the bedchamber.

Scene 36.

686. General shot of the bedchamber. Camera pans left as Oedipus slowly leads his wife over to the bed. She sits down and looks up at him, then lies back.

687. High angle CU of her head, lying back on the bed. She looks up at him. Oedipus's head and shoulders cover her as he leans over her.

688. MS from the end of the bed. At the other end, Oedipus lies on top of Jocasta, kissing her passionately. Then he grabs her blue robe and tears it off her, throwing it onto the end of the bed, just in front of camera, hiding Jocasta from view. He leans over her again.

Scene 37.

689. Fade in to LS of the city of Thebes at dawn. Camera pans and tracks slowly to the left along the city walls. Sounds of music, mingled with lamentations, off. (Still on page 115)

690. MLS of a procession of notables walking along outside the gates of Thebes.

* End of reel four, 450 metres approximately.

Some townspeople bow their heads to the ground as they pass. (Still on page 115)

691. Slightly high angle LS of the atrium of the palace, the notables crowded together in the background. (Still on page 115)

692. MCU of one of the notables. It is Creon.

TITLE: *The fact is, Oedipus refuses to face up to his guilt, and he is making me and his people suffer the consequences.*

693. MS of the royal bed, seen from the foot. Camera tracks in on it as we see Oedipus's naked back. He is lying on top of Jocasta, entwined in her arms.

694. High angle MCU of their faces as Oedipus moves on top of her. He finishes and they lie still for a moment. Then he slowly raises his head and looks down at her. He kisses her tenderly on the mouth and camera tilts up, panning with him as he gets up, takes his cloak from the side of the bed and moves away, looking at Jocasta.

695. High angle CU of Jocasta's head on the pillow, her hair loose. She looks up at him, silently.

696. MS of Oedipus as seen by her, standing at the foot of the bed, as he pulls his tunic down over his head and stands watching her.

697. MCU of Oedipus standing at the foot of the bed. Camera pans as he comes back towards her again, tilting down as he sits on the bed.

698. High angle MCU of Jocasta's head on the bed. Oedipus puts his hand tenderly to her cheek. She strokes his hand.

699. CU of Oedipus gazing silently down at her.

700. MCU of Oedipus looking down at Jocasta, whose legs can be seen beside him. Camera tilts up slightly as he gets up again and walks out through the curtain at the back of the chamber without looking back.

701. Low angle MS of Oedipus as he comes out into the atrium. He halts, looking down at Creon and the elders off-screen, then comes forward again as he speaks, camera tilting to hold on his face. OEDIPUS nastily:^{162, 163}

702. Reverse angle MS of Creon and the elders; they remain silent.

703. CU of Oedipus as he continues. OEDIPUS:¹⁶⁴

704. LS of the atrium from Oedipus's point of view. Creon and the elders begin to advance slowly from the far end.

705. CU of Oedipus. OEDIPUS:¹⁶⁵

706. Reverse angle LS; the blue-cloaked elders move to one side as Creon advances straight towards Oedipus.

707. Resume on Oedipus. OEDIPUS:¹⁶⁶

708. Reverse angle shot. Creon has almost reached the near side of the atrium. He breaks in. CREON:¹⁶⁷

709. Resume on Oedipus. OEDIPUS:¹⁶⁸

710. Reverse angle MLS of Creon, who has now reached the step leading up to where Oedipus is standing. CREON:¹⁶⁹

711. CU of Oedipus. Camera tilts down as he leans forward. OEDIPUS:¹⁷⁰

712. CU of Creon. CREON:¹⁷¹

713. CU of Oedipus, leaning forwards. OEDIPUS:¹⁷²

714. CU of Creon. CREON:¹⁷³

715. CU of Oedipus. OEDIPUS:¹⁷⁴

716. CU of Creon. CREON:¹⁷⁵

717. CU of Oedipus. OEDIPUS:¹⁷⁶

718. CU of Creon. CREON:¹⁷⁷ OEDIPUS off:¹⁷⁸

719. CU of Oedipus. Camera tilts up with him as he straightens up again. OEDIPUS:¹⁷⁹ A woman can be heard singing off. CREON off:¹⁸⁰

720. MS of Creon with the atrium in the background. He steps up towards Oedipus while the notables move forward on the left. CREON:¹⁸¹ OEDIPUS off: *Your sister?*
721. CU of Oedipus as he shouts furiously. OEDIPUS:¹⁸²
722. MCU of Creon. CREON:¹⁸³
723. CU of Oedipus, bellowing. OEDIPUS:¹⁸⁴
724. MCU of Creon. CREON:¹⁸⁵
725. CU of Oedipus. He smiles.
726. Resume on Creon. (Still on page 115) CREON:¹⁸⁶
727. CU of Oedipus. He smiles scornfully as Creon continues. (Still on page 115) CREON off:¹⁸⁷
728. CU of Creon. CREON:¹⁸⁸
729. Resume on Oedipus. CREON off:¹⁸⁹
730. Resume on Creon. CREON:¹⁹⁰
731. Resume on Oedipus. CREON off:¹⁹¹
732. Resume on Creon. CREON:¹⁹²
733. CU of Oedipus. OEDIPUS:¹⁹³
734. MLS of Jocasta sitting on the bed in the bridal chamber, stroking her hair. It hangs on her naked shoulders. OEDIPUS screaming, off: *Death!*
735. MCU of Jocasta plaiting her hair. (Still on page 115) She listens, frowning as the altercation continues off-screen. CREON off:¹⁹⁴ OEDIPUS off:¹⁹⁵ CREON shouting, off:¹⁹⁶ OEDIPUS shouting, off:¹⁹⁷ CREON off:¹⁹⁸ OEDIPUS off:¹⁹⁹ CREON off:²⁰⁰ OEDIPUS desperately, off:²⁰¹ CREON off:²⁰² Jocasta still listens, frowning and plaiting her hair.
736. CU of Oedipus. He turns to face camera, suddenly calm. OEDIPUS:²⁰³
737. MCU of Creon. CREON:²⁰⁴
738. CU of Oedipus. (Still on page 115) He bursts out angrily: OEDIPUS:²⁰⁵ He turns and moves away.
739. MCU of Creon standing silent, pensive. He looks up.
- Scene 39.*
740. LS of the palace garden. A long way away, in the centre, sits Jocasta, with Oedipus at her feet.
741. High angle CU of Oedipus's head as he lies with his head on Jocasta's robe.
742. Low angle CU of Jocasta looking down at him. JOCASTA:²⁰⁶ Music.
743. Resume on Oedipus. He looks up at her. OEDIPUS:²⁰⁷
744. Resume on Jocasta. JOCASTA:²⁰⁸
745. High angle MCU of his head resting on Jocasta's lap. He looks up at Jocasta as he speaks. OEDIPUS:²⁰⁹
746. Resume on low angle CU of Jocasta, as seen by him. JOCASTA:²¹⁰ Music as she continues to speak.²¹¹
747. High angle MCU of Oedipus as before, biting his hand. Jocasta caresses his head as she continues. JOCASTA off:²¹²
748. Low angle CU of Jocasta. JOCASTA:²¹³
749. High angle CU of Oedipus, his head on Jocasta's lap. OEDIPUS:²¹⁴ He turns and leans his cheek on Jocasta's thigh. Fade out.
750. LS of the garden as seen previously; the sun is beating down more harshly now. In the distance Jocasta gets up and stands over Oedipus.
751. MCU of Oedipus lying at her feet. He looks up at her, then camera tilts up as he gets up and stands facing her.
752. CU of Jocasta looking at him. JOCASTA: *But what are you afraid of?*

753. MCU of Oedipus. OEDIPUS :²¹⁵
 754. CU of Jocasta. JOCASTA :²¹⁶
 755. MCU of Oedipus. OEDIPUS :²¹⁷
 756. CU of Jocasta. JOCASTA :²¹⁸
 757. MCU of Oedipus. He is silent. Then he says: OEDIPUS :²¹⁹
 758. CU of Jocasta. JOCASTA :²²⁰
 759. MCU of Oedipus. He raises his eyes to look at her.
 TITLE :²²¹
 760. CU of Jocasta. She smiles slightly. JOCASTA :²²²
 761. MCU of Oedipus as he replies. OEDIPUS :²²³
 762. CU of Jocasta. JOCASTA :²²⁴
 763. MCU of Oedipus. Camera tracks in as he says:²²⁵ Fade out.
764. Another LS of the garden. It is dusk. Oedipus and Jocasta walk slowly, side by side, towards camera, which tracks out slowly in front of them. JOCASTA : *Why are you so horrified at the idea of being your mother's lover? Why? Who has not dreamed of making love to his mother? And does he live in horror because of this dream?*
 765. CU of Oedipus, camera tracking with him as he walks. OEDIPUS : *And yet I must seek the truth . . . I'm stricken with the fear that Tiresias may really be seeing the truth.* He turns to her briefly.²²⁶
 766. MCU, tracking out in front of Jocasta as she walks. JOCASTA :²²⁷
 767. CU, tracking with Oedipus. OEDIPUS :²²⁸
 768. Resume on Jocasta, tracking as she walks. JOCASTA :²²⁹
 769. CU, tracking with Oedipus. OEDIPUS :²³⁰
 770. Resume on Jocasta. JOCASTA :²³¹ *Why are you asking me all these questions about him?*
 771. Resume on Oedipus as he walks. OEDIPUS :²³² He halts and camera does likewise, and he says: *And even that I am afraid of having said . . .* He looks down as he starts walking again.
 772. MCU of their two hands side by side as they walk. Oedipus grips Jocasta's hand in his. Fade out.
773. MS of the two of them in the royal bedchamber. Jocasta is lying back on the bed, her head towards camera. (Still on page 116) Oedipus, leaning over her, shouts wildly. OEDIPUS :²³³ Jocasta tries to get up but he pushes her back.
 774. High angle CU of Jocasta's face, Oedipus's head partly visible in the foreground. He shakes her. OEDIPUS :²³⁴
 775. MCU of Oedipus, shouting, looking towards camera, Jocasta's hand pressing against his shoulder. OEDIPUS :²³⁵ Camera tilts with him as he jerks his head up and down. Jocasta puts her hand over his mouth, trying to stop him. (Still on page 116) OEDIPUS :²³⁶ Jocasta tries to shut him up again.
 776. High angle CU of Jocasta's head. She claps her hands over her ears and shakes her head wildly. (Still on page 116) JOCASTA : *I don't want to hear . . . I don't want to hear!* OEDIPUS partly visible in the foreground: *But I have to speak!* Jocasta presses her hands over her eyes, sobbing. JOCASTA : *May you never know who you are!*
 777. CU of Oedipus leaning over her; her two hands grip his arm as he continues. OEDIPUS :²³⁷ JOCASTA screaming: *Be quiet!* OEDIPUS :²³⁸ He stops and looks down at her, starts to remove the clasp from her robe.
 778. High angle CU of Jocasta as previously. She looks up at him in astonishment; his head is back to camera in the foreground. He takes off the brooch

and throws it aside, then seizes her by the shoulders and starts to kiss her violently.

779. MCU of the two of them on the bed, their heads towards camera. Tilt up with Oedipus as he raises his head, looks down at her and says: OEDIPUS: *Mother!* . . . Camera tilts down as he leans down and kisses her violently on the neck again.

780. High angle MCU of the two of them on the bed. She puts her arm round him and holds him close to her, her eyes closed.

781. Low angle shot of the ceiling from below as seen by Jocasta; it is made of painted reeds supported by crossed beams.

Scene 40.

782. Shot of some of the notables in the atrium, almost obscured from view by several pillars in the foreground.

783. Another similar shot; a flame can be seen burning amongst some small shrubs in the middle of the atrium on the left.

784. Low angle MLS of Jocasta standing at the edge of the atrium, surrounded by her women. She is clad in a long white robe and cloak. (Still on page 116)

JOCASTA: ²³⁹

785. Slightly low angle CU of her. JOCASTA: ²⁴⁰

786. MCU of Creon standing amongst the notables, wearing a crown, his head bowed. JOCASTA off: ²⁴¹

787. Resume on low angle CU of Jocasta. JOCASTA: ²⁴² Sounds of chanting; she looks off.

788. MS of what she sees. A man is brought into the atrium through an entrance flanked by soldiers. He kneels down. It is the shepherd of Corinth. (Still on page 116)

789. CU of Jocasta. She looks down at him, almost in horror.

790. MS of the shepherd kneeling. SHEPHERD: ²⁴³

791. CU of Jocasta. SHEPHERD off: ²⁴⁴ JOCASTA: ²⁴⁵

792. High angle CU of the shepherd. He smiles. Camera tilts up as he gets up, facing her. SHEPHERD: ²⁴⁶

793. Reverse angle MCU of Jocasta. She smiles. JOCASTA: ²⁴⁷

794. MCU of the shepherd: ²⁴⁸

795. CU of Jocasta's face. JOCASTA: ²⁴⁹ SHEPHERD off: ²⁵⁰

796. MCU of him. SHEPHERD: ²⁵¹

797. CU of Jocasta. JOCASTA: ²⁵² SHEPHERD off: ²⁵³

798. MCU of him as before. SHEPHERD: ²⁵⁴

799. CU of Jocasta. She looks at him, not knowing what to say.

800. MCU of the shepherd. He smiles.

801. Resume on CU of Jocasta, speechless.

Scene 42.

802. High angle LS of the countryside around Thebes: green fields and stretches of water with blue hills in the background. Camera pans right across the scene.

803. High angle MCU of a man building up the banks of a ditch with mud. It is Laius's slave. He looks up; camera tracks in on his face.

804. LS of the green and fertile fields. A group of people are advancing towards camera in the background.

805. MS of the slave as he climbs out of the ditch.

806. Resume on the group in MLS, coming towards camera.

809. MS tracking sideways with the slave as he walks anxiously towards the oncoming group.

808. Slightly high angle MLS of Oedipus approaching, accompanied by the shepherd, with a number of armed soldiers behind. In the background is the boy-messenger, carrying his hat and ringing his bell. Camera tracks briefly sideways with them. OEDIPUS : ²⁵⁵ SHEPHERD : ²⁵⁶

809. MCU of the Theban slave watching nervously as the group approaches. Camera tracks in on his face as he peers forward.

810. MCU of Oedipus who has halted, the soldiers behind him. He looks hard at the slave and says : OEDIPUS : ²⁵⁷

811. Reverse angle CU of the slave. He nods nervously and says : ²⁵⁸

812. Resume on Oedipus. OEDIPUS : ²⁵⁹

813. Resume on the slave. SLAVE : ²⁶⁰

814. Resume on Oedipus. OEDIPUS : ²⁶¹

815. Resume on the slave. (Still on page 117) SLAVE : ²⁶²

816. Resume on Oedipus. SLAVE off : ²⁶³ OEDIPUS : ²⁶⁴ SLAVE off : ²⁶⁵

817. MCU of Oedipus. Camera pans left as he throws himself on the shepherd, shouting : OEDIPUS : ²⁶⁶ (Still on page 117)

818. CU of the slave. SLAVE : ²⁶⁷

819. MCU of the shepherd. He comes forward, looking intensely at the slave off-screen. SHEPHERD : ²⁶⁸

820. CU of the slave. SLAVE : ²⁶⁹

821. MCU of the shepherd in profile as he advances towards the slave. Camera tracks left with him as he halts in front of the latter. SHEPHERD : ²⁷⁰ SLAVE angrily : ²⁷¹

822. MCU of the shepherd as he says : SHEPHERD : ²⁷²

823. CU of the slave. He shrugs. SLAVE : ²⁷³

824. MCU of Oedipus advancing towards him. Camera tracks out in front of him. He bursts out angrily. OEDIPUS : ²⁷⁴

825. MCU of the slave. Camera tracks in to CU. SLAVE : ²⁷⁵

826. CU of Oedipus. OEDIPUS : ²⁷⁶

827. CU of the slave. SLAVE : ²⁷⁷

828. CU of Oedipus. Camera tracks in on his face as he shouts. OEDIPUS : ²⁷⁸

829. CU of the slave : SLAVE : ²⁷⁹

830. MCU of Oedipus. Camera pans left to include the soldiers as Oedipus turns towards them shouting. OEDIPUS : ²⁸⁰ Camera pans back again as Oedipus turns back and shouts towards the slave.

831. MCU of the slave. He is terrified. SLAVE : ²⁸¹

832. CU of Oedipus. Camera tracks in to extreme CU of his face.

833. Resume on CU of the slave. OEDIPUS off : *Well . . .*

834. MCU of Oedipus. OEDIPUS : ²⁸²

835. MCU of the slave. SLAVE : ²⁸³

836. MCU of Oedipus. He pauses, looking down. OEDIPUS : ²⁸⁴

837. CU of the slave. He shakes his head. SLAVE : ²⁸⁵

838. CU of Oedipus. OEDIPUS : ²⁸⁶

839. CU of the slave. SLAVE : ²⁸⁷

840. CU of Oedipus. He claps his hands to his forehead and bellows. OEDIPUS : ²⁸⁸

841. CU of the slave. SLAVE : ²⁸⁹

842. CU of Oedipus's face. OEDIPUS : ²⁹⁰

843. CU of the slave. SLAVE : ²⁹¹ He bows his head.

844. CU of Oedipus's face. OEDIPUS : ²⁹²

845. Resume on the slave. He looks up again. SLAVE : ²⁹³

846. CU of Oedipus. OEDIPUS : ²⁹⁴

847. Resume on the slave. SLAVE :²⁹⁵
 848. CU of Oedipus. OEDIPUS :²⁹⁶
 849. Resume on the slave. SLAVE :²⁹⁷
 850. CU of Oedipus. OEDIPUS :²⁹⁸
 851. CU of the slave, his head bowed. SLAVE :²⁹⁹
 852. CU of Oedipus. OEDIPUS :³⁰⁰
 853. Resume on the slave. SLAVE :³⁰¹
 854. CU of Oedipus. OEDIPUS :³⁰²
 855. CU of the old slave's face. He looks Oedipus in the eye and speaks.
 SLAVE :³⁰³

856. LS of the palace garden. In the distance Jocasta runs to and fro with her women, laughing and playing.
 857. A closer shot of the same scene. Camera pans to and fro as they run around.
 858. A slightly longer shot of the same scene. Jocasta runs away from her women.
 859. High angle MLS of Jocasta running towards camera, pursued by her women. She runs round a clump of greenery.
 860. LS of the garden, the women running around. They disappear behind the clump of bushes and reappear.
 861. High angle MCU: Jocasta sinks to the ground, panting, as the women run past behind her. She turns and looks up towards camera as a voice is heard chanting, off. (Still on page 118) Fade out.*

862. MCU, tracking out in front of Oedipus as, followed by his soldiers, he enters Thebes. He glances up at the palace, off-screen.
 863. Shot of what he sees: camera tilts slowly up over the façade of the palace, to show the window of the royal bedchamber.
 864. MS of Oedipus, seen from behind, as he walks towards the entrance to the palace. His soldiers follow, their armour clanking. (Still on page 118)
 865. MCU of Oedipus as he stops and turns, just in front of the doorway. He glances up at Jocasta's window again.
 866. Low angle LS of the window. (Still on page 118)
 867. Resume on Oedipus. OEDIPUS :³⁰⁴

Scene 44.

868. General shot of the royal bedchamber with the bed in the background; something blue is just visible, hanging from the ceiling.
 869. Low angle MCU of Jocasta, who has hanged herself from the ceiling. Oedipus comes into shot as he throws himself on the body with a great cry.
 870. LS of the city of Thebes, the barren hills in the background. Camera pans slowly left along the walls as Oedipus's cry rings out endlessly, off.
 871. CU of Oedipus, staring up at the body, wild-eyed.
 872. Low angle MCU of the body hanging from the rope. Camera tilts up slightly towards the face. (Still on page 118)
 873. MCU of Oedipus gazing up at Jocasta's body; her legs swing slightly in the foreground. (Still on page 118) He fingers her blue robe, which he dragged from her body when he first found her. He looks down at the robe in his hands.
 874. High angle MCU of his hands holding the robe with the golden clasp. He removes the long pin holding the clasp and raises it. There is a terrible cry.

* End of reel five, 600 metres approximately.

875. MCU of Oedipus from behind, Jocasta's legs hanging in the background; he plunges the pin into first one eye, then the other. Camera pans with him as he staggers across and falls against the end of the bed, blood streaming through his fingers. OEDIPUS: 305, 306, 307, 308

876. MCU, tracking out in front of Oedipus, blinded, as he wanders through the corridors of the palace. The blue-clad notables stand behind him, watching. Two dark figures come up behind him and wrap a cloak around him. Camera tracks out away from him, pans as he rounds a corner, then tracks after him as he moves on into total darkness.

Scene 45.

874. MCU of the door to the palace. It opens and Oedipus's blood-stained hands appear from the darkness inside.

878. High angle MCU of the youth anxiously watching in the crowd outside. Camera pans right with him as he moves slightly to one side. (Still on page 119)

879. LS of the scene. In the background, Oedipus emerges from the open door, clad in a black cloak, while a crowd stands watching, back to camera in the foreground. The bells on the youth's hat ring as he slowly mounts the steps towards Oedipus.

880. MS of Oedipus standing at the palace entrance, blood running down his face. (Production still on page 119) The youth's hand appears, holding out his flute as he comes into frame, offering it to Oedipus. He places the flute in Oedipus's hand.

881. CU of the youth looking up anxiously at Oedipus, off-screen. He takes back the flute, puts it to his mouth and starts to play softly.

882. Resume on MS of the two of them, the youth leaning forward, playing the flute. The bells on his hat jingle as he stops and gives the flute to Oedipus again. Then camera tracks out in front of them as the youth leads Oedipus slowly away, glancing at him nervously from time to time.

Scene 46.

883. LS of a covered way leading through a twentieth century square. The youth leads Oedipus, who has his hand on his shoulder, slowly towards camera.

884. CU of Oedipus, bearded, camera tracking out in front of him as he walks along.

885. CU of the youth, Angelo, as he walks along, Oedipus's hand on his shoulder. He starts to whistle as he walks, camera tracking out in front of him.

886. Reverse angle LS: Angelo whistles as the two of them walk slowly away from camera.

887. Low angle LS of the steps leading up to a great cathedral. Oedipus is seated on the steps in the centre of shot, playing a mournful tune on his flute. (Still on page 120)

888. MCU of Oedipus playing his pipe.

889. MS of Angelo crouching down at the foot of the steps, feeding some pigeons. A car passes in the background.

890. Resume on Oedipus as he continues to play his pipe, an expression of intense sadness on his face. (Still on page 120) Camera pans slowly away across the façade of the cathedral, to show the square beyond.

891. General shot of the side of the square. Camera pans to the left as several tourists pass. People stand around talking in the background.

892. MLS of some people seated in a café, seen from the street. The sound of Oedipus's flute continues over.

893. MS of a group of people (three men and a girl) chatting by a car.

894. MCU, panning right with some obviously American tourists.

895. Another MCU panning with a similar group of tourists.
896. Resume on Oedipus playing his pipe. He stops and lowers it, staring sightlessly ahead. He whispers. OEDIPUS: *Angelo!*
897. Slightly high angle MLS of Angelo from his point of view, gaily leaping up and down, running around in circles, chasing the pigeons in the square. (Still on page 120)
898. Resume on CU of Oedipus. Camera tilts up with him as he gets up and calls out. OEDIPUS: *Angelo!* He calls again louder.
899. LS of the square. Angelo hears him and comes running towards camera.
900. Low angle LS of Angelo running up the steps of the cathedral towards Oedipus. Oedipus puts his hand on Angelo's shoulder and they walk on up across the steps. The pipe starts to play again.
- Scene 47.*
901. LS of a railway yard.
902. CU of Oedipus sitting at the roadside, playing his pipe.
903. LS of Angelo, some distance away, playing football with several youths in the road. The sound of the pipe, now a flute, continues over. (Still on page 120)
904. Resume on CU of Oedipus playing the pipe, staring sightlessly in front of him.
905. Low angle shot of factory buildings, a large hopper looming against the sky. Camera pans slowly round to the left as the sound of the flute continues off. We hear a train chuffing loudly.
906. General shot of more factory buildings. A shunting engine moves slowly past in the foreground, camera tracking left with it then panning away to show a factory chimney.
907. General shot of the factory yard; workers are walking across it or riding on bicycles. A man walks along with a red flag in front of the engine, which is off-screen. Camera pans slightly left with him.
908. A similar shot of the yard; a worker comes towards camera, walking beside another one on a bicycle as the engine passes in the background.
909. Shot of workers riding away from work on bicycles, coming towards camera and going off to the right. Camera pans briefly left again.
910. Resume on CU of Oedipus, sitting, playing his pipe. He lowers the pipe then suddenly bites his knuckles.
911. MCU of Angelo. Camera moves with him as he leaps around, heading a ball in the air. He loses it and catches it again, camera panning to show a couple of his fellow players.
912. Resume on CU of Oedipus, still gnawing at his hand. He suddenly calls out desperately: *Angelo!* Camera tilts up with him as he gets up, looking up sightlessly to the sky.
913. MLS of the boys and youths playing football, Angelo in their centre, heading the ball. He drops it immediately and runs towards camera.
914. LS of the road by the factory yard. Oedipus stands by an iron lattice pole carrying electric wires on the right, as Angelo runs towards him. Oedipus puts his hand on his shoulder and they walk slowly off up the road. Music.
- Scene 48.*
915. General shot of the square in Sacile seen at the beginning of the film. Angelo passes slowly across the screen, guiding Oedipus past the house where he was born. (Still on page 120)
916. MS of the road outside the barracks where we saw the mother wheeling her child at the beginning of the film. Angelo comes along the road, Oedipus

with his hand on his shoulder. Camera pans briefly left.

917. Very LS of the two of them as they walk through the barracks yard.

918. CU of Oedipus walking with head bowed, a sad expression on his face, camera tracking out in front of him. He halts and camera tracks out to include Angelo, who looks off to the left.

919. MLS of what he sees: the house at the end of the square with the rose bushes in front, where the mother wheeled her baby such a long time before. The flag is no longer hanging from the upstairs window and all the shutters are closed.

920. LS of the field where the mother and her women came with the baby, Angelo and Oedipus walking across it in the distance.

921. MCU of the lower half of their bodies as Angelo guides Oedipus across the field. Camera pans briefly left.

922. CU, tracking out in front of Oedipus, as he walks along through the field where the mother carried her baby. He halts and camera tracks away from him slightly. He closes his eyes.

923. Low angle shot panning across tree-tops and sky, like that at the beginning of the film.

924. Resume on CU of Oedipus standing. OEDIPUS: *Angelo, where are we?*

925. CU of Angelo who proceeds to describe the scenery around. ANGELO: *We are in a place with big trees, with the mist rising, in a meadow covered with green.*

926. CU of Oedipus, slightly low angle as before. Tears run down his cheeks. OEDIPUS: *Oh light which I could no longer see, which before was in some way mine, now you return to me for the last time. I have come back. Life ends where it begins.* The military music heard at the beginning of the film is heard again faintly, off. Oedipus advances towards camera.

927. Another low angle shot of trees and sky. Camera pans round and tilts down to show the broad expanse of grass in the meadow. The music fades away as the picture cuts and the words THE END appear on the screen.

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